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IRANIANS ON EDGE

‘Whole civilization will die tonight’, Trump warns as Iran calls threat ‘psychopath’s’ rant

ASSOCIATED PRESS

TEHRAN: Iranian officials on Tuesday urged young people to form human chains to protect power plants, as US President Donald Trump warned that a “whole civilization will die tonight” if Tehran does not meet his latest deadline for the Islamic Republic to agree to a deal that includes reopening the crucial Strait of Hormuz.

“A whole civilization will die tonight, never to be brought back again,” if a deal isn’t reached, Trump said in a post Tuesday morning, while keeping open the possibility of an off-ramp, saying that “maybe something revolutionarily wonderful can happen.”

Meanwhile, Iran replied to Trump, saying, “You and your allies will suffer an unforgettable hit from the ancient civilization of Iran.”

The Iranian Embassy in



An excavator removes rubble at the site of a strike that, according to a security official at the scene, destroyed half of the Khorasanha Synagogue and nearby residential buildings in Tehran, Iran, on Tuesday

Turkiye said on X that a “psychopath’s threat” will not end what time could not.

The post read, “Alexander

burned it. The Mongols ravaged it. History tested it. Iran is still here. A psychopath’s threats won’t end what time couldn’t.”

Russia, China veto UN resolution on reopening Strait of Hormuz

UNITED NATIONS: Russia and China on Tuesday vetoed a UN Security Council resolution on reopening the Strait of Hormuz, a vital maritime chokepoint through which a fifth of the global oil passes, blocked by Iran.

The 15-nation UN Security Council voted on the resolution proposed by Bahrain, which got 11 votes in favour, two against and two abstentions. See P8

Airstrikes hit two bridges and a train station in Iran, and the US struck military targets on the Iranian oil hub of Kharg

CLOSER LOOK

» Deadline set for 8 pm Washington; Trump hinted at a possible last-minute breakthrough

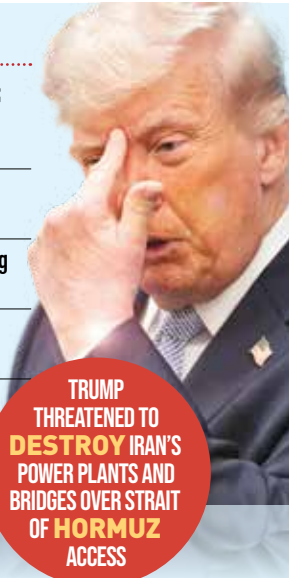
» Iran warned US and allies of an “unforgettable hit” in response

» US struck military targets on Kharg Island for the second time

» Airstrikes hit Iranian bridges and a train station linked to rail networks

» Israel said it targeted infrastructure used by Iran’s Revolutionary Guard

» Fears of nuclear escalation rose after JD Vance’s remarks; White House denied nuclear plans



INTERNET SHUT, CURFEW IMPOSED

Manipur: Two protesters killed in CRPF firing after 2 children die in blast



People block a road in protest after two children were killed and their mother was injured in a bomb attack, in Bishnupur district, Manipur, on Tuesday

MPOST BUREAU

HIGHLIGHTS

» Bomb attack kills two children in Bishnupur’s Moirang Tronglaobi at around 1 am

» Victims include a five-year-old boy and a six-month-old girl

» State hands over probe to National Investigation Agency

» Massive combing operation launched with police, CRPF, Assam Rifles, helicopters

IMPHAL: Fresh violence erupted in Manipur on Tuesday after a deadly bomb attack in Bishnupur district killed two young children, triggering widespread protests that escalated into clashes with security forces, leaving at least two more people dead and several injured. Authorities responded with an indefinite curfew in multiple districts and a temporary suspension of internet services, as the state government moved to hand over the probe to the National Investigation Agency.

The initial attack took place around 1 am in Moirang Tronglaobi when suspected militants hurled an explosive at a residence. A five-year-old boy and a six-month-old girl were killed on the spot, while their mother sustained injuries. Police said the victims were asleep when the explosion ripped through their bedroom. The injured woman was admitted to a private hospital in Imphal.

Chief Minister Y Khemchand Singh described the

incident as a “barbaric act” and an “assault on humanity,” stating that those responsible would be identified and punished under the law. He later announced that the investigation would be transferred to the NIA after consultations with the state home minister and legislators. The chief minister said the attack appeared to be the work of elements seeking to disturb peace and confirmed that a large-scale combing operation involving the police, CRPF and Assam Rifles was underway, supported by aerial surveillance.

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Rahul Gandhi

In today's paper

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Quick News

IN SC, CENTRE BACKS BAN ON WOMEN’S SABARIMALA ENTRY

NEW DELHI: The Centre on Tuesday told the Supreme Court that restricting entry of women aged 10 to 50 at Sabarimala is a matter of faith and denominational autonomy, beyond judicial review. Before a nine-judge bench led by Chief Justice Surya Kant, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta said courts may intervene only if practices breach public order, morality or health. The court said it can test social ills. Mehta objected to calling the practice untouchability and termed the temple restriction sui generis.

See P6

URGENT CASES TO BE MENTIONED ONLY BEFORE CJI-LED BENCH: TOP COURT

NEW DELHI: In a significant procedural directive, the Supreme Court has said that “exceptionally urgent matters” that cannot wait for the listing process have to be mentioned only before the Chief Justice of India, even if he is busy presiding over a constitution bench.

According to the usual practice, urgent matters are mentioned for listing and hearing before the seniormost judge of the apex court if the CJI is either unavailable or busy heading a constitution bench.

In a circular issued on April 6, the top court said, “Mentioning of exceptionally urgent matters, which cannot await listing before the Hon’ble Court as per circular dated November 29, 2025, is permitted before Court No 1, even when the Hon’ble Chief Justice is presiding over a constitution bench.” The circular said that the mentioning of such matters is not permitted before any other bench.

MPOST

SOUMITRA NANDI

KOLKATA: Data released late Monday by the Election Commission of India on district-wise voter breakup shows that of around 60 lakh names placed “under adjudication” before nearly 700 judicial officers, 27,16,393 have been struck off—taking total deletions to 90,83,345 as of April 7.

Earlier, 63,66,952 names were removed in the final electoral roll published on February 28. With over 27 lakh more deletions during adjudication, the cumulative figure has crossed 90 lakh.

Murshidabad recorded the

Nandigram: 95% of dropped names are from Muslim community

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: A recent study based on the data released by the Election Commission of India (ECI) has revealed that in the supplementary voter list of the Nandigram Assembly Con-

stituency, the highest number of deleted names belong to the Muslim community. Suwendu Adhikari is the BJP nominee from the high-profile seat and is pitted against his one-time close aide, Pabitra Kar.

Continued on P4

highest deletions from the adjudication list alone, with 4,55,137 names removed. Added to

2,93,822 deletions in the February 28 list, the district’s total exclusions stand at 7,48,959.

Delhi plans to legalise 1,511 unauthorised colonies

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Centre’s decision to formalise unauthorised colonies in Delhi marks a major policy shift, Union Housing and Urban Affairs Minister Manohar Lal Khattar said on Tuesday, calling it a “pivotal moment” that grants legal rights to long-settled residents. The move covers 1,511 of Delhi’s 1,731 such colonies under the PM-UDAY scheme launched in 2019, removing the earlier requirement for detailed layout approvals.

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said nearly 45 lakh residents

will benefit, gaining “relief, dignity, and legal recognition”. Applications will open on April 24 via the MCD SWAGAM portal. GIS-based surveys will take up to one week, followed by a two-week correction window and ownership documents issued within six weeks.

The reform allows legal construction after approval, aligning development with city norms. It also ties into Transit Oriented Development Regulations, 2026, covering 207 sq km, where 65 per cent of space is reserved for housing near metro and RRTS corridors, aiming for better connectivity and planned growth.

See P3

PASSPORTS ROW

Assam police search Khera’s residence following FIR by Himanta’s wife

‘Witch hunt,’ says Congress; Be ready to face consequences, says Bjp

VINAY KUMAR

NEW DELHI: Assam police on Tuesday conducted searches at the Delhi residence of Congress leader Pawan Khera, days after he levelled serious allegations against Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma’s wife Riniki Bhuyan.

The Assam police team formally informed the Delhi Police upon arrival, following which a local police team joined and assisted in the proceedings.

Khera was not present at his residence when the police



An Assam Police team and others leave the Delhi residence of Congress leader Pawan Khera after questioning, in New Delhi, on Tuesday

team led by Deputy Commissioner of Police Debajit Nath conducted the searches.

The police action came days

after Khera, at a press conference on Sunday, alleged that the Assam CM’s wife possessed passports of

Continued on P4

India eyes strategic balance as Foreign Secy Misri heads to US amid West Asia crisis

SIMONTINI BHATTACHARJEE

NEW DELHI: The Ministry of External Affairs said on Tuesday that Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri will be visiting Washington, DC, for three days. The visit will take place from April 8 to April 10. Amid extreme geopolitical change, his visit to the US is noteworthy. The visit coincides with rising tensions in West Asia, where the ongoing conflict has caused major worries about marine routes, oil security and regional stability.

The government communique also mentioned that Misri’s meetings with high-ranking US officials are expected to focus

Meanwhile, the diplomatic corridor highlights the economic front in India, volatility in global oil prices and its implications for India

on both strengthening strategic ties and collaborating to address new global challenges. The MEA also said that the talks during the visit will cover important areas like trade, defence cooperation, and working together in science and technology. At the same time, officials indicated

Continued on P4

Govt doubles 5-kg LPG cylinder quota

May push for electric stoves to reduce LPG dependence

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The government is stepping up efforts to manage cooking fuel availability and accelerate alternatives as supply disruptions linked to tensions in West Asia ripple through domestic markets. The government has doubled the daily quota of market-priced 5-kg LPG cylinders for migrant workers, while also exploring financial support mechanisms to expand access to electric cooking solutions, reflecting a dual strategy to address immediate shortages and reduce long-term import dependence.

The Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas said the increased allocation of 5-kg free trade LPG cylinders is aimed at easing access for migrant labourers who often lack formal domestic connections. These smaller cylinders, sold without the need for address proof, are priced at Rs 549 in Delhi, compared with Rs 913 for the standard 14.2-kg household cylinder. Officials said the revised quota, communicated through

Continued on P4



NO ROOM FOR LAPSE: SPEAKER ORDERS SECURITY REVAMP

Delhi Assembly to install road blockers, boost access control

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Following a recent security breach within the Delhi Legislative Assembly premises, Speaker Vijender Gupta has ordered a comprehensive upgrade of security systems, stressing that “the security of the Delhi Legislative Assembly cannot admit of the slightest lapse.”

Chairing a high-level review meeting with senior officials from the Ministry of Home Affairs, Delhi Police, Intelligence Bureau, PWD and other agencies, Gupta said the incident highlighted the urgent need for stronger coordination and rapid response mechanisms. He directed the installation of hydraulic road blockers at all entry gates, reinforcement of access control systems, and deployment of a more responsive on-ground security framework.

Emphasising accountability, the Speaker called for a unified command structure between Delhi Police and CRPF to ensure seamless coordination during emergencies. He noted that delays in communication weaken response capability and instructed that real-time information shar-



Forensic team inspects after an SUV driven forced its way through one of the boundary gates of the Delhi Assembly premises, in New Delhi

ing be made mandatory across agencies. Gupta also ordered stricter access management, directing that all entry and exit points be strengthened with improved infrastructure and protocols. Each gate will be manned by at least two trained personnel, and no vehicle will be allowed entry without proper verification.

To enhance on-site response, the Speaker proposed the deployment of a dedicated mobile patrol unit capable of swift intervention. “Reliance on static deployment alone is insufficient,” he observed, stressing the importance of mobility in modern security

frameworks.

Officials also recommended regular monthly mock drills and installation of an integrated alarm system for quicker response during emergencies. The Public Works Department suggested reinforced gate structures and collapsible barriers to prevent forced entry.

Gupta commended Delhi Police for swiftly apprehending the accused and reiterated that security reviews would be conducted periodically. He underscored that maintaining a secure Assembly environment is a shared responsibility requiring vigilance and strict adherence to protocols.

Man acted alone, cited nephew’s disappearance in breach case: Police

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The probe into the Delhi Assembly security breach has revealed that the man who allegedly forced his way into the complex in an SUV wanted to draw the attention of police and other authorities towards the disappearance of his nephew, officials said on Tuesday.

According to the police, his nephew has been missing since April 1 and a missing persons report had been lodged at Hari Nagar police station in west Delhi.

A senior police officer, requesting anonymity, said Sarabjeet Singh believed that senior officers would understand his grievance about his nephew’s disappearance and ensure action.

“While the family has claimed that he is mentally disturbed and undergoing

treatment, (police) teams are not fully convinced by this theory at this stage. He is physically fit and we are also checking all the claims by his family members.

Sarabjeet is also financially stable and purchased the SUV in February,” the police source said.

Another senior police officer said that he was produced before a city court and the court granted eight days police custody of the accused.

During remand, police will analyse routes, CCTV footage and reconstruct events. Officials said Sarabjeet acted alone, with no accomplices found so far. Though unarmed, his driving was deemed deliberate and dangerous. He was arrested hours after the breach, and investigators are examining his movements, call records and motive.

Cook killed in hit-and-run, teen driver nabbed

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: A 41-year-old cook was killed in a road accident after being hit by a car in south Delhi’s Greater Kailash-I area, with police arresting a 19-year-old driver in connection with the case.

Police said a PCR call was received at the Greater Kailash-I police station on March 31, reporting that an unknown silver-coloured Maruti Ciaz had struck a motorcycle rider and fled the spot.

The injured rider was rushed to the National Heart Institute, where doctors declared him brought dead. He was later identified as Surendra Das (41), a resident of B-246, Greater Kailash-I, who worked as a cook and domestic help in the area.

A case was registered under relevant sections 281 and 106(1) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), and an investigation was launched to trace the vehicle and its driver.

During the probe, police analysed CCTV footage from multiple routes near the accident site and surrounding areas. Details of suspected vehicles were also obtained from the Transport Office, followed by physical verification at registered addresses. Vehicle owners were called in for questioning



As part of the investigation.

After extensive analysis, the offending vehicle was identified as a silver-coloured Maruti Ciaz. It was later traced and recovered in an accidental condition, seized, and deposited in the malkhana as per procedure.

The driver was identified as Ruhaan Chadha (19), while the car was registered in the name of his mother, Niharika Chadha. During questioning, the accused allegedly admitted that he panicked after the incident and fled the spot, driving in a rash and negligent manner.

Police said the vehicle had been concealed after the accident and attempts were made to get it repaired. The owner has been booked under Section 238 of the BNS for concealing evidence, along with additional charges related to harbouring the accused despite having knowledge of the incident.

Police said the investigation is at an advanced stage and further proceedings are underway.

Biker killed in hit-and-run in outer Delhi

NEW DELHI: A 19-year-old man was killed after a speeding truck hit his motorcycle and attempted to flee in outer Delhi’s Paschim Vihar East area, an official said on Tuesday.

According to the police, a PCR call was received on Monday night at Paschim Vihar East police station regarding a road accident on the stretch from Punjabi Bagh towards Peeragarhi Chowk.

A police team rushed to the spot and found Krishan Mohan, a resident of Peeragarhi Camp, lying dead on the road. His motorcycle was also found damaged at the scene, the officer said.

Police said the locals and eyewitnesses intercepted the offending truck a short distance away. The driver, identified as Saurabh Kumar, 26, was apprehended on the spot and handed over to the police. Preliminary inquiry revealed that the truck had hit the motorcycle before attempting to escape, police said, adding that the impact was severe, leading to Mohan’s death on the spot. During verification, it also emerged that the deceased was not holding a valid driving licence at the time of the accident.

The police have sent the body for a postmortem and informed the family. A case is being registered, and further investigation is underway to ascertain the exact sequence of events.

Son nabbed for killing father & uncle after drunken brawl

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A 22-year-old man has been arrested for allegedly killing his father and uncle following a drunken altercation at a rented house in Delhi’s Uttam Nagar area, police said on Tuesday. The accused, Ishwar, was apprehended on Monday after he had been on the run since the incident.

On April 4, after receiving information about the incident in Mohan Garden, a team rushed to the spot and found Devender Kumar, 50 and his brother Amit, 48, lying dead inside a ransacked room, with liquor bottles scattered around, a senior police officer said.

The crime team and forensic experts examined the scene and collected evidence, police said, adding that the bodies were sent for postmortem.

According to the police, the autopsy revealed that both men died due to internal injuries caused by a physical assault.

Police said Kumar, an ESIC employee, had recently moved in with his brother and son. The son, Ishwar, allegedly killed both during a quarrel and was later arrested.

Delhi court grants bail to ‘conman’ Suresh Chandrasekhar in ED case

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A Delhi court on Tuesday granted bail to alleged conman Suresh Chandrasekhar in an ED case related to the AIADMK’s “two leaves” election symbol, noting that he had undergone detention exceeding half of the maximum seven-year sentence prescribed under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act.

Special Judge Vishal Gagne said the court’s decisions cannot “preach liberty”, the most sacrosanct constitutional norm, while “playing footsie with the state upon the bogey of special legislation or economic offences”. Chandrasekhar, who has been incarcerated in the present case since April 1, 2022, will, however, remain in jail in other pending cases lodged against him. He has secured bail in 26 out of 31 cases against him.

The Enforcement Directorate’s (ED’s) case stems from a 2017 Delhi Police FIR, which alleged that Chandrasekhar acted as a middleman for AIADMK leader T T V Dinakaran and tried to bribe an Election Commission of India (ECI) official to secure the party’s “two leaves” symbol for the faction led by V K Sasikala.

The FIR alleged that Rs 1.3



crore cash was recovered from the accused, which was allegedly intended to be used for exercising undue influence with the ECI for obtaining a favourable election symbol for the Sasikala faction of the AIADMK.

According to the federal agency, Chandrasekhar coordinated with Dinakaran for the generation of proceeds of crime of Rs 2 crore and got it transferred from Chennai to Delhi, and later utilised and projected the proceeds of Rs 63.78 lakh as untainted money by making certain payments.

“Liberty being the most sacrosanct norm in our Constitution, the court cannot preach liberty from its decisions while playing footsie with the state upon the bogey of special legislation or economic offences,” Judge Gagne said.

He said while the offence of money laundering remains

“Case stems from a 2017 Delhi Police FIR, which alleged that Chandrasekhar acted as a middleman for AIADMK leader to bribe an EC official

grave in nature, a special legislation like PMLA is not a “grouse” of the state to be exacted upon the liberty of an accused through the court.

“Thus, the existence even of 31 cases (including the present case) against the accused does not defeat his right to bail in this particular case when the period of detention has crossed the threshold of half of the period of proposed imprisonment under section 4 (punishment for money laundering) of the PMLA, more so, when he is already on bail in 26 out of the 31 cases,” the judge said.

A court granted bail to the accused, noting prolonged detention and stayed proceedings made a speedy trial unlikely. Citing BNSS provisions, it imposed strict conditions, including bonds, passport surrender and no contact with witnesses.

45-yr-old held for sexually assaulting minor

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi Police has arrested a 45-year-old man for allegedly sexually harassing an eight-year-old girl in Delhi’s Rohini area, police said on Tuesday, after a video showing him being beaten by locals circulated on social media.

According to Delhi Police, the incident came to light after the video surfaced online, in which the accused was seen being thrashed by the public over allegations of sexual mis-



conduct with the minor.

In a statement posted on X, Delhi Police said a video going viral on social media is from Delhi’s Aman Vihar area, where, under the pretext of repairing a speaker, the accused lured an 8-year-old girl to his

“Incident came to light after the video surfaced online, in which the accused was seen being thrashed by the public over allegations of sexual misconduct with the minor”

home and sexually assaulted her. “The Delhi Police has taken strict action against the accused and arrested him under the relevant sections of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and Section 8 of the POCSO Act,” read the statement of the police.

Police also requested citizens not to take the law into their own hands under any circumstances and to immediately inform the police about any such criminal, so that legal action can be taken against them.

VP inaugurates studios, alumni portal at IGNOU

NEW DELHI: Vice-President C. P. Radhakrishnan presided over the 39th convocation of Indira Gandhi National Open University (IGNOU) on Monday, where degrees were awarded to over 3.24 lakh students across its regional centres, making it one of the country’s largest annual convocations.

Delhi Lieutenant Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu attended as guest of honour. The two dignitaries jointly conferred PhD degrees and gold medals on meritorious students. The ceremony was also held simultaneously at regional centres nationwide, with Goa Gover-

nor Puspapati Ashok Gajapati Raju attending in Panaji and Tripura Governor Indra Sena Reddy Nallu in Agartala. During the event, the Vice-President inaugurated 17 Swayam Prabha Studios at IGNOU centres across the country to strengthen the production and broadcast of educational content, especially for learners in remote areas.

He also launched ‘IGNOU Profile 2026’ and an alumni portal linking about 5.3 million graduates. Faculty, students and families attended convocation ceremonies held across centres.

Fraud call centre run for six months busted

PRAJYOT DEOGHARE

NEW DELHI: Delhi Police have busted a fake call centre operating in Guru Arjun Nagar and arrested two proprietors while apprehending ten tele-callers for allegedly cheating customers by selling fraudulent roadside assistance policies.

The operation was carried out on April 4 by the Anti-Narcotics Cell following specific intelligence inputs about the illegal setup functioning under the jurisdiction of Ranjeet Nagar police station. The call centre was operating from Rattan Lal Complex under the name “RD Services”.

A team led by Inspector Rohit Kumar conducted a raid under the supervision of ACP Operations Padam Singh Rana. Police found the call centre active and apprehended all those involved.

The arrested proprietors were identified as Sourabh (28) and Shah Nawaz (28). Ten tele-

“They contacted potential customers using random and targeted data, falsely offering nationwide roadside assistance

callers, all residents of Delhi, were also apprehended.

Investigations revealed that the accused contacted potential customers using random and targeted data, falsely offering nationwide roadside assistance services. Customers were persuaded to pay between Rs 3,000 and Rs 4,000 for policy cards through cash on delivery, but no services were provided and helpline calls went unanswered.

Police said the operation had been running for around six months without authorisation. Equipment, fake policy cards and customer data were seized. A case has been registered.

News at a Glance

JAMIA EXTENDS ADMISSION DEADLINE

NEW DELHI: Jamia Millia Islamia has extended the application deadline for 2026–27 admissions to April 10 following student requests. The extension covers UG, PG, diploma and certificate courses. Applicants must submit forms via the university portal within the revised timeline, as no applications will be accepted after the deadline.

JNU PG ADMISSIONS FOR 2026–27 TO BEGIN AFTER CUET-PG RESULTS

NEW DELHI: Jawaharlal Nehru University said PG admissions for 2026–27 will begin after CUET-PG results. Candidates must meet eligibility in the prospectus and appear for CUET-PG, while some courses will admit through GAT-B or CCMT. Applicants should keep documents ready. NTA is expected to release the answer key soon.

TEEN DIES AFTER FALL FROM 16TH FLOOR

GHAZIABAD: An 18-year-old girl died after falling from the 16th floor of a residential building in Indrapuram on Tuesday morning. Identified as Sandhya, she was preparing for Uttar Pradesh Police recruitment exams. Police said CCTV footage shows her reaching the floor alone, suggesting suicide, while her family alleged foul play and demanded a thorough probe. The body has been sent for post-mortem, police said.

KAUTILYANOMICS: FOR MODERN TIMES

Indigenous economic ideas in focus at policy discussion

Welfare, growth seen as complementary in Kautilya model

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A multi-dimensional approach to welfare and economic policy, drawing on classical Indian thought, was discussed at a recent session of ‘Śāstra se Samvād tak’, a discussion series organised by Bharat Ki Soch.

The session, titled “Kautilyanomics: For Modern Times”, featured Sriram Balasubramanian, a former IMF economist and author, who spoke on the contemporary relevance of Kautilya’s Arthashastra. He said Kautilya’s economic thinking was principles-based rather than prescriptive, allowing flexibility in interpretation and application across contexts.

Balasubramanian outlined what he termed “dharmic capitalism”, built on three pillars: rule-based and non-intrusive

TAKEAWAYS

» The session, titled ‘Kautilyanomics: For Modern Times’, featured Sriram Balasubramanian, a former IMF economist and author, who spoke on the contemporary relevance of Kautilya’s Arthashastra

governance, growth driven by a global outlook, and a focus on sustainability and inclusivity. He argued that this framework does not view wealth creation and welfare as competing priorities, but as complementary elements of long-term economic development.

based rather than prescriptive, allowing flexibility in interpretation and application’

» Balasubramanian outlined what he termed “dharmic capitalism”, built on three pillars: rule-based and non-intrusive governance, growth driven by a global outlook, and a focus on sustainability and inclusivity

On welfare, he said Kautilya’s approach combined support for those at the margins with systems that enable mobility, including formal labour structures and enforceable contracts. Welfare, he added, should be seen as part of a broader economic framework

that promotes both stability and opportunity.

Balasubramanian also said the erosion of access to classical Indian knowledge systems had affected contemporary economic thinking, stressing the need to engage with indigenous intellectual traditions while addressing present-day challenges.

Anil Rajput, chairman of the advisory council at Bharat Ki Soch, said economic policy must balance growth with ethics, sustainability and social stability. He noted that governance, welfare and institution-building must work together.

R.K. Pachnanda, speaking at the conclusion, said continued engagement with India’s intellectual traditions could help shape a model of development that is both sustainable and globally relevant.

UP to set up Metro Univ

DIPIKA KIROLA

NOIDA: The Uttar Pradesh cabinet, chaired by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, has approved the establishment of a Metro University on a 26.1-acre land parcel, aimed at creating a world-class education hub.

Officials said the university will feature advanced infrastructure, including smart classrooms, high-tech laboratories, digital libraries and residential facilities. The project is part of the state government’s broader push to improve the quality of higher education.

A senior official said the proposed university would align with global standards

while promoting research, innovation and skill development. It is expected to offer multidisciplinary programmes linked to industry requirements to enhance employability. Authorities added that the project would generate employment during both construction and operational phases, boosting the local economy. It is also expected to attract students from across the country.

While the proposal has been approved, details such as location, investment and timelines are yet to be finalised. Officials said the initiative reflects a long-term vision to strengthen Uttar Pradesh’s position in higher education.

‘As-is, Where-is’ relief for 1,511 unauthorised colonies in Delhi

‘HOPE, SECURITY FOR LAKHS’: CM REKHA GUPTA WELCOMES MOVE

NARESH BISWANI &
AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a landmark decision set to reshape Delhi's urban landscape, the Centre and the Delhi government have announced the regularisation of 1,511 unauthorised colonies, offering legal ownership and a pathway to planned development for lakhs of residents. The move, seen as a major policy shift, aims to bring long-neglected settlements into the mainstream while improving infrastructure and living standards.

Addressing a press conference in New Delhi, Union Housing and Urban Affairs Minister Manohar Lal Khattar described the move as transformative. He said, "Today marks a historic moment in the lives of residents of Delhi," adding that the PM-UDAY scheme, launched in 2019, was designed to confer ownership rights. Highlighting the latest decision, he stated that colonies would be regularised on an "As-is, Where-is" basis, which would "encourage residents to come forward for registration of their properties." He further noted, "This will not only provide legal ownership but also enable citizens to undertake



construction or redevelopment of their homes in accordance with MCD norms."

The minister credited the initiative to the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, saying, "Delhi is witnessing a new phase of planned and inclusive urban development, aimed at addressing legacy issues while building a future-ready city."

Welcoming the decision, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said it would bring "hope, dignity and long-awaited security to lakhs of families." The

Delhi Cabinet passed a resolution thanking the Centre, calling the move a "transformative step." Gupta added, "The Centre's decision will open a new path of self-respect, stability and growth for lakhs of citizens."

Under the plan, all plots and buildings in these colonies will be treated as residential, and regularisation will apply to existing structures without requiring approved layout plans. Convenience shops of limited size will also be regularised under specific conditions. The Municipal

Corporation of Delhi will issue Certificates of Regularisation, while the Revenue Department of the Delhi government will handle conveyance deeds and authorisation slips.

Applications under the scheme will open from April 24, 2026, through the Swagam portal. A defined timeline has been set, including 45 days for issuing conveyance deeds. Around 4.5 million residents are expected to benefit.

Gupta emphasised that the decision goes beyond legal recognition. "It offers residents a pathway to self-respect, stability and development," she said, adding that Rs 800 crore has been allocated in the 2026-27 budget to improve infrastructure in these areas.

KEY POINTS

» The Delhi Cabinet passed a resolution thanking the Centre, calling the move a 'transformative step'

» Today marks a historic moment in the lives of residents of Delhi, says Minister Khattar

» 'This will not only provide legal ownership but also enable citizens to undertake construction or redevelopment of their homes in accordance with MCD norms'

ognition. "It offers residents a pathway to self-respect, stability and development," she said, adding that Rs 800 crore has been allocated in the 2026-27 budget to improve infrastructure in these areas.

The initiative is expected to ease long-standing uncertainties, enable access to housing loans, and pave the way for comprehensive redevelopment, marking a significant step towards inclusive and planned urban growth in the national capital.



April plays winter

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Overcast skies and light rainfall all through Tuesday brought down the mercury in the national capital, which recorded its coldest April day in three years.

The maximum temperature settled at 28.8 degrees Celsius, several notches below normal. The city had previously seen the maximum temperature drop to 28.4 degrees Celsius on April 1, 2023. The weather office has forecast thunderstorms accompanied by light to moderate rain for Wednesday, with cloudy skies likely to persist. According to the India Meteorological Department data, between 8:30 am and 5:30 pm, Safdarjung recorded 3.0 mm rainfall, Lodhi Road also logged 3.0 mm, while Palam and Ridge recorded 2.1 mm each. Ayanagar recorded 2.0 mm of rainfall during the period. The maximum temperature at Safdarjung was 28.8 degrees Celsius, six notches below normal, while Palam recorded 27.6 degrees Celsius, eight notches below normal. Lodhi Road logged 28.1

degrees Celsius, six notches below normal, Ridge 27.7 degrees Celsius, seven notches below normal, and Ayanagar 27.8 degrees Celsius, seven notches below normal.

The minimum temperature at Safdarjung was 20.1 degrees Celsius, close to normal, while Palam recorded 19.6 degrees Celsius, marginally below normal. Lodhi Road logged 18.6 degrees Celsius, marginally below normal, Ridge 17.2 degrees Celsius, three notches below normal, and Ayanagar 18.1 degrees Celsius, one notch below normal. The minimum temperature on Wednesday is expected to settle at 17 degrees Celsius and the maximum temperature at 28 degrees Celsius.

Meanwhile, Delhi's air quality remained in the 'moderate' category with the Air Quality Index (AQI) of 114, according to the Central Pollution Control Board. According to CPCB standards, an AQI of zero to 50 is considered 'good', 51 to 100 'satisfactory', 101 to 200 'moderate', 201 to 300 'poor', 301 to 400 'very poor', and 401 to 500 'severe'.

DDA launches 1,944 LIG flats in Narela with 25% discount

ANAMTA FATIMA

NEW DELHI: In a fresh push to expand affordable housing, the Delhi Development Authority (DDA) has announced the launch of 1,944 additional Low Income Group (LIG) flats under the Nagrik Awaas Yojana 2026. Located in Narela, the ready-to-move units are being offered on a First Come, First Served (FCFS) basis, along with an attractive 25 per cent discount to boost demand.

The scheme is aimed at providing accessible housing opportunities to middle and lower-income families in the Capital. Officials said the decision to introduce additional flats comes amid growing interest in affordable housing segments and a steady demand for ready-to-move properties.

According to DDA, bookings have now opened through its official e-services portal, allowing applicants to secure homes without the lengthy waiting periods typically associated with housing allotments. The FCFS model is expected to ensure transparency and speed in the allocation process.

Narela, identified as a developing residential hub in North

HIGHLIGHTS

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Delhi, has witnessed increasing infrastructure development in recent years. With improved connectivity and civic amenities, authorities believe the area holds significant potential for future urban expansion.

The scheme aligns with broader government efforts to promote home ownership and reduce the housing gap in urban areas. Prospective buyers have been encouraged to apply at the earliest, as demand is expected to be high given the pricing incentives and immediate availability of flats.

LPG supply for migrant workers doubled: Minister

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has doubled the LPG supply for migrant workers, with 1,368 cylinders of 5 kg each now available daily. Food and Supplies Minister Manjinder Singh Sirsa said on Tuesday.

The quota for commercial LPG for migrant workers has been increased from 180 to 360 cylinders per day, with priority being given to the needy, the minister said. The move comes under a revised total daily cap of 6,480 cylinders (19-kg equivalent), under which essential services are being prioritised. Any surplus cylinders from one



category will be transferred to other categories after meeting primary demand, Sirsa said. The government has directed oil marketing companies, or OMCs, to strictly adhere to the daily limit of 6,480 cylinders and inform the department about any inter-category transfers.

"Under the leadership of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, our focus is to ensure there is no shortage anywhere. Keeping in mind the needs of migrant workers, the supply has been doubled," Sirsa said.

The Food and Supplies Department has also issued operational clarifications to improve LPG distribution. OMCs have been allowed flexibility in allocation across categories without fixed percentage caps, but only after meeting valid demand in all segments, the minister said. According to the statement, to ensure transparency, 5-kg free trade LPG (FTL) cylinders for migrant

workers are being distributed through authorised agencies, with Aadhaar verification made mandatory. "A centralised beneficiary database is being maintained by OMCs to prevent duplication and misuse, and a minimum gap of seven days has been fixed before the same individual can receive another cylinder," an official statement read.

The priority sectors include education and health institutions (225 cylinders), government institutions/PSUs/subsidised community kitchens/industrial canteens (225 cylinders), hotels, restaurants, dhabas and food processing units (3,375 cylinders), caterers/banquets

(225 cylinders), labour-intensive industries such as automobile, textile, dye, chemical, plastic, glass, power and pharma (1,800 cylinders), and sports facilities/stadiums (270 cylinders).

"We are fully committed to fair distribution. There is no place for rumours. Intensive inspections are underway across Delhi, and strict action will be taken immediately against those involved in hoarding or black marketing," the minister said.

Sirsa termed reports of gas shortage "completely baseless" and advised people to book cylinders through authorised OMCs and consider PNG connections as a long-term solution.

Govt to expand newborn screening to 2.5L infants annually under Mission ‘ANMOL’

NEW DELHI: The Delhi government has approved an expanded newborn screening programme under Mission ANMOL, increasing annual coverage from around 1.5 lakh to 2.5 lakh infants to ensure early detection of congenital disorders, officials said on Tuesday.

The decision, cleared by the Rekha Gupta government, aims to move towards near-universal screening at government health facilities and outreach centres, according to an official statement. Health Minister Pankaj Kumar Singh said the scale-up

would enable early identification and management of metabolic, endocrine, functional and visible congenital conditions, improving long-term health outcomes.

The programme will cover key conditions such as congenital hypothyroidism, congenital heart defects, hearing impairment and retinopathy of prematurity, with a focus on timely intervention and follow-up care.

Officials said Mission Advanced Newborn Monitoring for Optimal Lifecare (ANMOL) adopts a technology-

driven and integrated approach aligned with national guidelines to make comprehensive newborn screening a standard practice across Delhi's public health system.

To support implementation, the government has approved 148 positions under the programme, including continuation of 73 existing staff and addition of 60 staff nurses and 15 optometrists, according to officials.

The nurses will assist in sample collection, especially for pre-term and critically ill infants, and help coordinate care

and transport, while optometrists will support screening for retinopathy of prematurity, they said. The initiative will also strengthen coordination among hospitals, laboratories and programme units to ensure all newborns are screened before discharge, with special emphasis on high-delivery-load hospitals and neonatal intensive care units. Singh said the expanded programme reflects the government's commitment to strengthening neonatal healthcare and ensuring that no child is left behind.

IFFD 2026 success puts Delhi on global film map: Minister

AIMAN FATIMA

NEW DELHI: The successful conclusion of the first International Film Festival, Delhi (IFFD) 2026 has marked a major milestone in the Capital's journey towards becoming a global film hub, with Tourism Minister Kapil Mishra highlighting its impact on the city's cultural and creative landscape.

Addressing the media, Mishra said, "Successful organization of IFFD-2026 marks a significant step towards making Delhi a global film hub." He added that under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, "Delhi will emerge as the 'Art Capital' of New India." The inaugural edition of the festival received an overwhelming response, with 2,187 film entries from over 100 countries. More than 125 films from 47 nations were screened across 15 venues in the city, including Bharat Mandapam, drawing appreciation from audiences and filmmakers alike. Spain was featured as the "Country of Focus," while the Singapore International Film Festival participated as an official partner, adding an international dimension to the event.

According to the minister, the festival recorded over 30,000 registrations, reflecting its wide reach and popularity. He noted that the event went beyond film screenings, serving as a platform for "learning, dialogue, and creative expression," with active participation from filmmakers, artists, and youth.

Mishra also highlighted that an MoU was signed between the Delhi Tourism Department and Prasar Bharati to boost film tourism and broadcasting opportunities. He said the festival "contributed meaning-

‘Namo Bharat’ corridor in Delhi gets CISF cover

NARESH BISWANI

NEW DELHI: The Central Industrial Security Force (CISF) has been formally inducted to take over security of the Delhi section of the 'Namo Bharat' Regional Rapid Transit System (RRTS) corridor, following approval from the Ministry of Home Affairs.

Though quietly implemented, the change reflects a calculated upgrade in operational oversight. With federal forces stepping in, monitoring protocols along the corridor are expected to align more closely with national standards.

Ahead of heightened security, authorities approved the assignment of 251 CISF members to duty in the national capital. While focused on transit hubs, their presence will cover Anand Vihar, New Ashok Nagar, and Sarai Kale Khan RRTS stations.

These units will safeguard both travellers and critical structures. Underneath the operational shift lies a broader effort to reinforce urban transport resilience.

A section through Delhi belongs to Phase I of the RRTS initiative, linking 22 stops between Delhi and Uttar Pradesh. Although CISF takes charge within Delhi, locations in Uttar Pradesh fall under protection by the UPSISF, showing joint planning across regional lines.

CISF likely introduces focused knowledge into urban transport safety – think smart entry checks and methods for scanning travellers, alongside smoother movement during busy times. With proven experience guarding vital hubs like airports and subway lines, its presence adds weight where protection matters most.

Beginning at Delhi Metro sites, CISF guided UPSISF staff through preparation focused on watch procedures and crisis actions because consistency matters along the transit route. Sessions covered how to manage large crowds while responding to urgent situations, since unified methods support smoother operations across RRTS lines.



TAKEAWAYS

» The inaugural edition of the festival received an overwhelming response, with 2,187 film entries from over 100 countries

» Over 125 films from 47 nations were screened across 15 venues in the city, including Bharat Mandapam, drawing appreciation from audiences and filmmakers alike

fully towards strengthening the creative and orange economy of Delhi."

The event featured masterclasses, workshops, and discussions on emerging areas such as artificial intelligence and OTT platforms. An AI Filmmaking Hackathon was also organised, offering new insights to aspiring creators. Emphasising the future vision, Mishra stated that the goal is to develop Delhi as a sustainable film hub, adding that "IFFD stands as a symbol of Delhi's creative energy and cultural richness" and will be expanded further in the coming years.

City Briefs

DELHI BJP FILES POLICE COMPLAINT AGAINST CONG CHIEF KHARGE

NEW DELHI: A Delhi BJP delegation led by Union minister Harsh Malhotra submitted a complaint to the police commissioner against Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge over his remark against the party and the RSS. In an election rally in Assam's Sribhumi district on Monday, citing the Quran, Kharge said that if a poisonous snake is passing in front of someone who is offering namaz, that person should leave the namaz and kill that poisonous snake. "I would say that breaking the namaz does not matter. The RSS and the BJP are that poisonous snake. If you don't kill this snake, you will not survive," he said. The Congress president's statement is not only an attempt to spread "hatred and violence" among the Muslim community against the BJP but also a blatant violation of election campaign rules, said a Delhi BJP statement.

DELHI BJP PRESIDENT VIRENDRA SACHDEVA'S FATHER PASSES AWAY

NEW DELHI: Delhi BJP president Virendra Sachdeva's father Shyam Lal Sachdeva passed away at the All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS) on Tuesday. His mortal remains will be cremated at Nigam Bodh Ghat on Wednesday morning, said a statement. Sachdeva, around 94, is survived by his wife Krishna Sachdeva, a daughter and five sons, including the Delhi BJP chief, it said.

Delhi plans to construct watch towers in Central Ridge area

NEW DELHI: The Irrigation and Flood Control Department of the Delhi government plans to construct watch towers in the Central Ridge area near Vandematram Marg in the New Delhi area, officials said on Tuesday.

Along with this, the government plans a stormwater pipeline project in the ridge area for Rs 2 crore.

The officials said the initiative is part of the Delhi government's broader efforts to enhance green cover and strengthen infrastructure in the ridge, which serves as a vital ecological buffer and one of the city's primary green lungs. "The work is aimed at improving surveillance and managing water flow in the Central Ridge forest area. A tender has been floated in this regard," an official said. According to the officials, the proposed work includes the construction of multiple watch towers to enhance surveillance in the area.

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

NEW DELHI: Over 225 acres of forest land in the national capital has been made encroachment-free across multiple forest divisions, according to official data, with the bulk of the clearance reported from the southern parts of the city.

Data compiled by the forest department shows that around 91.15 hectares of land, roughly 225 acres, has been cleared of encroachments since 2019-20, primarily in the South and West forest divisions, while several other areas are still in the process of reconciliation with land-owning agencies. In the South Forest Division, the highest removal was recorded in the South district, where about 77 hectares or nearly 190 acres of forest land was cleared between 2019-20 and 2024-25, though a year-wise break-up was not provided.

In the South-East district,

The figures come amid ongoing monitoring of forest conservation and efforts to remove encroachments in the national capital

about 2.92 hectares or around 7.2 acres was cleared during the same period, with year-wise removal recorded at 0.11 hectares in 2019-20, 1.85 hectares in 2020-21, 0.56 hectares in 2021-22, nil in 2022-23 and 0.4 hectares in 2023-24. In the West Forest Division, about 11.23 hectares or roughly 27.7 acres of land has been cleared of encroachments between 2019-20 and 2023-24 in parts of the Southern Ridge in the New Delhi district, including areas such as Rajokari, Rangpuri, Ghitorni and Mahipalpur.

SC: Voluntary retirement not mere act of leaving, rather distinct right of employee

Bench delivered its verdict on appeals filed by bank challenging 2 separate orders of Chhattisgarh HC

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Supreme Court said on Tuesday that voluntary retirement is not a mere act of leaving or discontinuing but is rather a distinct right of an employee that is available on completion of the requisite number of years of service.

A bench of Justices JK Maheshwari and Vijay Bishnoi delivered its verdict on appeals filed by a bank challenging two separate 2019 orders of the Chhattisgarh High Court.

The high court had issued a direction for the grant of terminal benefits to a bank employee, saying that after the completion of the three-month notice period as specified in the notice for voluntary retirement or from the date of stopping to attend the service, he be treated voluntarily retired.

The apex court noted that the employee was appointed in September 1983 and was pro-



moted as manager in April 2007.

It said that in July 2010, while working as branch manager at Raipur, some suspicious transactions in two accounts came to the knowledge of the bank. In the meantime, the employee sent a notice of voluntary retirement on October 4, 2010 to the general manager and in response, the zonal office asked for a fresh application under pension regulations.

Later, since the period specified in the notice for voluntary retirement had elapsed, the employee stopped working with the bank with effect from May 16, 2011.

Highlights

» SC noted that the employee was appointed in September 1983 and was promoted as manager in April 2007

» The top court noted that after about eight months from the date when he severed his employment with the bank, he was chargesheeted on March 5, 2012 over the allegedly suspicious transactions

The top court noted that after about eight months from the date when he severed his employment with the bank, he was chargesheeted on March 5, 2012 over the allegedly suspicious transactions.

He later moved the high court challenging the non-acceptance of voluntary retirement and consequent initiation of inquiry and dismissal.

While dealing with the appeals, the bench referred to the relevant provisions of pension and service regulations.

“Upon reading, it is quite clear, if an employee on or after 1st day of November 1993 com-

pletes 20 years of qualifying service, and furnishes a notice of not less than three months to the appointing authority, he may retire voluntarily,” the bench noted. It said the notice of three months indicating intention to retire voluntarily was given on October 4, 2010 and the period was supposed to expire on January 4, 2011, to which refusal was not ordered within the notice period.

The bench said the non-approval communicated on June 29, 2011, after expiry of the notice period and cessation of work, was of no avail. It noted that a show-cause

notice was issued by the bank on November 11, 2010 but it would not indicate the intention to institute disciplinary proceedings in terms of the service regulation.

“Nonetheless, voluntary retirement is not a mere act of leaving or discontinuing, rather, a distinct right of an employee that is available on completion of the requisite number of years of service, etc,” it said.

The bench said existence of such a show cause notice itself was not sufficient without refusal by the competent authority to stop automatic operation of the notice of voluntary retirement.

“In absence, the notice of voluntary retirement would take its course. In the present case, no such order of refusal or order of withholding was passed by the competent authority within the stipulated period,” it said.

CCTV issues in police stations to be resolved in 2 weeks: Govt to SC

Continued from Page 1
Court, which had sought his presence to facilitate effective implementation of the CCTV scheme.

The hearing was part of a batch of petitions, including a suo motu case initiated by the court over concerns about non-functional CCTV systems in police stations. During the proceedings, Justice Nath pointed out that the Union government had been represented by an under secretary in earlier discussions convened by the amicus with states and Union Territories. “Does it look nice?” the judge remarked, indicating dissatisfaction with the level of representation.

The bench referred to submissions made a day earlier, highlighting that Kerala had developed and fully implemented a robust software system for CCTV monitoring. It suggested that the Centre consider adopting a uniform model based on such existing solutions rather than allowing each state to develop separate systems. “Instead of every state creating its own software and spending money and time, there is already

a ready software which is in use,” the bench observed.

The court further noted that, according to the amicus, Kerala, Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan have already established centralised dashboards. It indicated that the Union government could issue directions or advisories encouraging all states to follow a similar framework.

Responding to these observations, Venkataramani assured the bench that discussions would be held with all stakeholders to streamline the process. Recording his statement, the court said that “within two weeks, he would make sure that all the issues are sorted out by holding regular meetings with the amicus and the other relevant officers”.

The matter has been scheduled for further hearing on April 28. The court directed the amicus curiae, senior advocate Siddhartha Dave, to submit a fresh status report before the next hearing and permitted the Centre to file an affidavit if required. It also stated that the personal presence of the home secretary would not be required in future unless specifically directed.

On Monday, Dave had informed the bench that most states had already installed CCTV cameras and were in the process of setting up centralised monitoring systems.

Earlier, on February 26, the Supreme Court had directed the Centre and other stakeholders to participate in discussions on feasibility and implementation, including the creation of a centralised dashboard and standardisation of CCTV infrastructure nationwide.

The case stems from the court’s earlier directions on police reforms. In 2018, the apex court ordered the installation of CCTV cameras in police stations to curb human rights violations. This was expanded in December 2020 to include offices of investigative agencies such as the CBI, ED and NIA.

The court has mandated that cameras cover all critical areas within police stations, including entry and exit points, lock-ups, corridors and reception areas, with no blind spots. It has also required systems to have night vision, audio and video recording capabilities, and storage capacity for at least one year.

From Page 1 Trump warns

US Vice President JD Vance warned that the US has “tools in our toolkit that we so far haven’t decided to use” against Iran.

Shortly after, the White House issued a clarification over Vance’s remark, denying the use of nuclear weapons.

In a later statement, the White House said “only the president knows” what he’ll do on Iran.

Trump has extended previous deadlines but suggested the one set for 8 pm in Washington was final, and the rhetoric on both sides reached a fever pitch, leaving Iranians on edge.

Trump threatened to destroy all of Iran’s power plants and bridges if Tehran does not allow traffic to fully resume in the strait, through which a fifth of the world’s oil transits in peacetime. Iran’s president said 14 million people, including himself, have volunteered to fight.

It was not clear if the latest airstrikes were linked to Trump’s threat to attack bridges. At least two of the targets were connected to Iran’s rail network.

Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said Israeli warplanes struck bridges and railways in Iran. In a statement released by his office, Netanyahu claimed Iran’s paramilitary Revolutionary Guard was using them to transport materials to make weapons. Israel had earlier issued a Farsi-language warning telling Iranians to avoid trains throughout the day.

Iran, meanwhile, fired on Israel and Saudi Arabia, prompting the temporary closure of a major bridge.

While Iran cannot match the sophistication of US and Israeli weaponry or their dominance in the air, its chokehold on the strait is roiling the world economy and raising the pressure on Trump both at home and abroad to find a way out of the standoff.

Officials involved in diplomatic efforts said talks were ongoing, but Iran has rejected the latest American proposal, and it was unclear if a deal would come in time to head off Trump’s threatened attacks. World leaders and experts warned that strikes as destructive as Trump threatened could constitute a war crime.

Iranians have formed human chains in the past around nuclear sites at times of heightened tensions with the West. Some images of people surrounding power plants were posted by local Iranian media Tuesday.

The Guard, meanwhile, warned that Iran would “deprive the US and its allies of the region’s oil and gas for years” and expand its attacks across the Gulf region if Trump carries out his threat.

In Tehran, the mood was bleak. A young teacher said that many opponents of Iran’s Islamic system had hoped Trump’s attacks would quickly topple it. Now, as the war drags on, she fears US and Israeli strikes will spread chaos. “If we don’t have the internet, and if we don’t have electricity, water, and gas, we’re really going back to the Stone Age, as Trump said,” she told The Associated Press, speaking anonymously for her safety.

French Foreign Minister Jean-Noël Barrot joined a growing chorus of international voices and calling for restraint, saying attacks targeting

civilian and energy infrastructure “are barred by the rules of war, international law.”

“They would without doubt trigger a new phase of escalation, of reprisals, that would drag the region and the world economy into a vicious circle,” the minister said on France Info television.

UN Secretary-General António Guterres also warned the US that attacks on civilian infrastructure are banned under international law, according to his spokesperson. Such cases are notoriously difficult to prosecute, and Trump told reporters he’s “not at all” concerned about committing war crimes.

A series of intense airstrikes pounded Tehran, including in residential neighbourhoods. Such strikes in the past have targeted Iranian government and security officials.

Israel’s military said it attacked an Iranian petrochemical site in Shiraz, the second day in a row it hit such a facility. Iranian officials later said that a railway bridge, a train station and a highway bridge were among targets hit in airstrikes.

Details of the US strikes on Kharg Island were not immediately available. A US official, who spoke on condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive military operations, described the strikes overnight as hitting targets previously struck and not directed at oil infrastructure.

Saudi Arabia said it intercepted seven ballistic missiles and four drones launched by Iran. Saudi Arabia temporarily closed the King Fahd Causeway, the only road connection between Bahrain, home to the US Navy’s 5th Fleet, and the Arabian Peninsula. Iran also fired on Israel.

More than 1,900 people have been killed in Iran since the war began, but the government has not updated the toll for days.

In Lebanon, where Israel is fighting Iran-backed Hezbollah militants, more than 1,500 people have been killed, and more than 1 million people have been displaced. Eleven Israeli soldiers have died there.

Iran choked off shipping through the strait after Israel and the US attacked on Feb. 28, starting the war. That stranglehold and Iran’s attacks on the energy infrastructure of its Gulf Arab neighbours have sent oil prices skyrocketing, raising the price of gasoline, food and other basics far beyond the Middle East.

In spot trading Tuesday, Brent crude, the international standard, was above USD 108 per barrel, up around 50 per cent since the start of the war.

Manipur

“We have instructed security forces to apprehend the perpetrators at the earliest, even today if possible,” Singh said, while urging residents to remain calm and cooperate with authorities.

The killings sparked immediate outrage across Bishnupur and Imphal Valley. Residents took to the streets, burning tyres and blocking roads in several areas including Pangei, Khurai and Langthabal. Protesters also torched two oil tankers and a truck near a petrol pump in Tronglaobi, attacked a makeshift police outpost and staged demonstrations outside the Moirang Police Station.

As tensions mounted, a large group of protesters, including women and youths, marched towards a CRPF camp near Gelmol, located a short distance from the blast site. Despite appeals from State Home Minister Govindas Konthou-

jam to allow security forces to focus on tracking down the attackers, the crowd forced its way into the camp premises, set vehicles on fire and damaged infrastructure.

Security personnel opened fire during the confrontation. According to the home minister, two people were killed in the firing, while initial reports indicated five sustained bullet injuries. Police later updated the total number of injured in the incident to 20. Officials said the injured were admitted to various hospitals.

Konthoujam said the firing occurred either in self-defence or amid heightened tensions as the situation spiralled. He added that the protesters appeared to be angered by what they saw as a lack of action against militant groups.

In response to the unrest, district administrations in Imphal East, Imphal West, Bishnupur and Kakching imposed an indefinite curfew, prohibiting movement outside homes except for essential services and law enforcement duties. The government also suspended internet and mobile data services, including broadband and VPN access, across five valley districts for three days to prevent the spread of misinformation.

Police warned that legal action would be taken against individuals circulating false information on social media.

Meanwhile, political leaders across the state condemned the attack. Local MLA Th Shanti Singh termed it an “act of terrorism” and paid tribute to the victims, calling the killings inhuman and unacceptable. He extended condolences to the bereaved family.

Officials noted that Moirang Tronglaobi lies close to the hills of Churachandpur, an area that witnessed repeated gunfire during earlier phases of ethnic violence. An additional explosive device was recovered from a nearby location on Tuesday, raising concerns about further threats.

Manipur has remained volatile since ethnic clashes between the Meitei and Kuki Zo communities broke out in May 2023, leaving more than 260 people dead and thousands displaced. The state has been under President’s Rule since February 2025.

Authorities said efforts were ongoing to restore order even as security forces intensified operations to track down those responsible for the bombing that set off the latest cycle of violence.

ECI roll

for a significant share of deletions—have an estimated Matua population of around 40 per cent. Political observers believe the scale of deletions in these areas may affect sections of refugee communities who migrated from Bangladesh and could potentially impact the BJP’s vote base.

Other districts with notable exclusions include East Midnapore, where total deletions stand at 1,65,345. Kolkata alone accounts for 6,97,160 deletions across both phases, reflecting the scale of revision in urban as well as border districts.

The poll body said over 58 lakh names were deleted as absent, shifted, dead and duplicate (ASDD) voters in the draft list published on December 16, 2025, during the Special Intensive Revision (SIR). This was followed by nearly five lakh removals in the February 28 final list, after which 60,06,675 voters were placed under adjudication.

Of these, data for 59,84,512 voters has been released. While cases of the remaining 22,163 have been disposed of, they are awaiting electronic signatures from judicial officers. Once completed, deletions may rise further, even as some names could be added in the second phase.

The 27,16,393 voters deleted during adjudication can approach the appellate tribunal seeking inclusion. However, sources indicated their chances of being restored before the forthcoming Assembly elections are slim unless directed otherwise by the apex court.

Nandigram

According to an interpretation by research organisation Sabar Institute, although Muslims constitute only 25 per cent of Nandigram’s total population, nearly 95.5 per cent of the voters deleted from the supplementary list are from this community.

Sabar Institute is a Calcutta-based research organisation studying religion and gender patterns in the ongoing revision of voter rolls in poll-bound Bengal.

The data shows that in the December 2025 draft electoral roll, a total of 10,604 names were deleted, of which 66.7 per cent were non-Muslims and 33.3 per cent were Muslims. However, the supplementary list presents a dramatically different picture.

A total of 2,826 voters have been newly deleted, out of which 2,700 are Muslims—accounting for about 95.5 per cent of the deletions. In contrast, only 126 non-Muslim voters, or roughly 4.5 per cent, have been removed. The deleted voters include 51.1 per cent men and 48.9 per cent women.

Sheikh Sufian, vice-president of the Trinamool Congress’s East Midnapore district unit and a key Nandigram leader, alleged: “Minority voters have been selectively removed at the BJP’s behest because they are not BJP supporters.”

Sufian further claimed that despite the Supreme Court’s direction to open appellate tribunals for redressal of the deleted voters, no such mechanism has yet been made operational. “We have started preparations to move the High Court,” he said.

Meghnad Pal, secretary of the BJP’s Tamuk organisational district unit, said: “We are also aware of the data. But where does the BJP come into this? The SIR process was not conducted by the BJP; it was done by the Election Commission.”

During the last assembly election in 2021, the biggest electoral duel was fought in Nandigram between Mamata Banerjee and Suwendu Adhikari, where Adhikari had won by a slender margin.

However, the TMC supremo alleged that a deliberate, temporary power cut during the 2021 election counting allowed BJP’s Suwendu Adhikari to reverse her lead. The incident created a high-profile controversy, prompting calls for an investigation, as the TMC labelled it a “conspiracy” or “load-shedding victory”. The TMC had moved the Calcutta High Court challenging Adhikari’s victory, but the case is still pending.

Political observers believe that the deletion of such a large number of names from one specific community could potentially influence the electoral outcome.

Whether this will have any decisive impact on the Nandigram result has now become the biggest political question.

Assam police

three countries: the UAE, Egypt, and Antigua and Barbuda.

Speaking with reporters outside the Congress leader’s house, Assam police DCP Debajit Nath said that Khera was not found at his residence. However, he said, a search was carried out and electronic devices were seized.

Some “incriminating material” was found but its details cannot be disclosed at this stage, he said, adding the case had been registered at the Crime Branch Police Station in Guwahati.

Sarma had warned of legal action against Khera, who had in a press conference on Sunday alleged that the chief minister’s wife, Riniki Bhuyan Sharma, has multiple passports and foreign property, which were not declared in the CM’s election affidavit.

Sources said that over a dozen police personnel descended on Khera’s house in Nizamuddin in central Delhi at around 11 am and left after around two hours.

The Congress hit out at Sarma, alleging that he was “disturbed and rattled” due to “imminent” defeat in the April 9 polls and was using state machinery to muzzle the opposition’s voice, but the chief minister said the police will hunt down Khera from “pataal (netherworld) to question him on the “false documents” that he had used to target his family.

Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh said the deployment of a “full array of police officials” to arrest Khera “for asking basic questions in the public interest” proves that the Assam CM is “disturbed, desperate, and rattled”.

“This is not due process but instead a witch hunt, a bully using state machinery to muzzle and silence the voice of the Opposition that is exposing his many black deeds. Those who intimidate are the ones who are afraid and have much to hide,” Ramesh said on X.

It also proves that the CM is facing imminent defeat, Ramesh claimed.

Asked about Khera’s allegations against Sarma’s wife, Congress chief Mallikarjun Kharge, who is campaigning in Assam, said all agencies are under the Central government, which should probe the charges.

“They have already filed an FIR against Khera. Let them probe the matter. We will face the case as it progresses. We have sought probes by the ED or the CBI into the allegations,” he added.

On Monday, Sarma had alleged that the Congress used “false information” sourced from a Pakistani social media group to level “baseless and malicious” allegations against his wife. The BJP leader termed it an attempt to influence the Assam elections and a punishable offence.

Meanwhile, the BJP hit out at the Congress for calling Assam Police action against Pawan Khera a “witch hunt” and said the opposition party leader must face consequences for levelling “fake” allegations against Sarma and his wife.

“They have approached the police. The police are doing their job,” senior BJP leader Ravi Shankar Prasad told reporters at the BJP headquarters while replying to queries on the issue.

Prasad said Khera made “palpably false” allegations against the Assam chief minister and his wife, and now he is “running away” when police have initiated action in the case.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Govt doubles

an April 6 directive, doubles state-level daily availability based on average supply recorded in early March.

Sujata Sharma, Joint Secretary in the ministry, said sales of these cylinders have risen sharply in recent weeks. Around 77,000 such cylinders were sold in February, with volumes increasing further in early March. Since March 23, about 7.8 lakh 5-kg cylinders have been sold nationwide, including more than 1.06 lakh units on a single day earlier this week.

The government has prioritised LPG and piped natural gas supplies for households and essential services such as hospitals, even as commercial users initially received only 20 per cent of their requirements. This allocation has now been gradually increased to around 70 per cent of pre-crisis levels. Authorities have also conducted over 4,300 enforcement raids to curb hoarding and black marketing.

Sharma urged consumers to avoid panic buying, stating that fuel supplies remain stable and retail outlets are functioning normally. She added that refinery output has been increased and alternative fuels are being promoted, while natural gas supplies for priority segments, including domestic PNG and transport CNG, remain fully protected. Additional allocations have also been made for fertiliser and industrial sectors, alongside efforts to expand city gas distribution networks.

The supply measures come against the backdrop of rising global crude prices and heavy reliance on imports. India, the world’s second-largest LPG importer, meets nearly 65 per cent of its annual demand of 33 million tonnes through imports, with about 90 per cent sourced from West Asia. The concentration of supply has heightened vulnerability to geopolitical disruptions.

Parallel to immediate relief measures, policymakers are accelerating plans to promote electric cooking. State-run Energy Efficiency Services Ltd is considering introducing interest subsidies to make induction cooktops more affordable for economically weaker households under its National Efficient Cooking Programme. Officials familiar with the discussions said the proposal involves tying up with multilateral institutions such as the World Bank and the Asian Development Bank to enable zero-interest loans. Under the model being explored, consumers purchasing cookstoves on instalments would pay only the principal, while interest costs would be covered by financial partners. However, a World Bank spokesperson clarified that it is not currently financing the programme or any such subsidy mechanism, though it is engaged in broader consultations on clean cooking initiatives.

Demand for electric cooktops has surged since the onset of the crisis. E-commerce data indicates that sales of induction stoves jumped 30 times within two days in mid-March. Prices have also risen modestly, with entry-level models increasing by around Rs 100 from a base of Rs 1,800, while premium models saw sharper hikes.

To meet rising demand, EESL is scaling up procurement. A tender for 100,000 units has recently closed, and two additional tenders covering 500,000 units are planned. As of March 25, the agency had an order book of 69,872 units, of which 16,526 had been deployed. A separate tender for 200,000 units is cur-

rently under process.

The National Efficient Cooking Programme initially targeted deployment of one million induction cookstoves by FY27, later revised to 500,000 units due to limited demand. Officials now indicate that targets may be revisited in light of renewed interest.

India eyes

that the talks will focus on the recent developments in the Gulf region, especially the unstable situation in West Asia.

Meanwhile, the diplomatic corridor highlights the economic front in India, volatility in global oil prices and its implications for India. Even small increases in crude prices could significantly impact fiscal projections, compressing timelines for stability, and putting pressure on government finances. Concerns also rise over supply-side management, including the availability of essential commodities like gas. While central directives exist, enforcement at the state level remains uneven, occasionally leading to issues such as black marketing. The instability is getting worse because the Strait of Hormuz is closed, and it is now the centre of the ongoing conflict between the US and Iran. After Iran effectively blocked the Strait in response to US-Israel strikes in February, Washington has used a mix of military pressure, coercive diplomacy, and coalition-building to reopen it.

In March, the US started a targeted campaign to take out Iran’s naval capabilities, including drones, missile systems, and ships that were threatening commercial shipping. Washington has also shown that it is willing to escalate further by threatening to attack Iranian infrastructure if the strait is not reopened. Diplomatically, the US is pushing for a ceasefire arrangement tied directly to reopening the waterway. A proposed framework involves Iran restoring shipping access in exchange for a pause in hostilities, though Tehran has so far resisted such conditions.

Roughly 20 per cent of the world’s oil and a major share of LNG pass through the Strait of Hormuz, making it the most critical energy checkpoint globally. Since the blockade, tanker traffic has collapsed sharply, at one point nearing zero. Further, global oil prices surged dramatically, triggering global inflationary pressure. Adding shipping risks, insurance costs and rerouting challenges have also escalated.

Besides, experts called it the largest energy supply shock since the 1970s crisis in India as it imports over 80 per cent of its crude oil, a significant portion of which transits through Hormuz. According to the power corridor, it is widening the current account deficit, domestic inflation, and supply chain disruption.

India’s approach, on the other hand, is in line with its long-standing policy of strategic autonomy, which means that it engages with both sides at the same time without fully siding with either. India keeps diplomatic and economic ties with Tehran and doesn’t support military escalation or rhetoric aimed at the regime. At the same time, India has high-level visits with the United States. India has strengthened its cooperation with the US in defence, technology, and geopolitics. India is backing dialogue and de-escalation instead of confrontation, which means it is not taking sides in military terms. This stance also helped India get energy from the Iranian government.

'REPRESENTATION MUST TRANSLATE INTO REAL INFLUENCE'

NDA govt always prioritised women empowerment in every form: PM

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Tuesday asserted that his government has always prioritised women's empowerment in every form, and said that with the Women's Reservation Act, India is moving towards greater women-led governance.

He was commenting on a newspaper article written by Union Minister Annpurna Devi on "Enhancing women's legislative leadership", which highlighted "how greater representation of women is key to stronger, more inclusive governance and a developed India".

In an X post, Modi said, "Representation must translate into real influence. The government has always prioritised Nari Shakti in every form. Hence, with the Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam



Prime Minister Narendra Modi addresses a public meeting PTI

Highlights

- » Modi said that with the Women's Reservation Act, India is moving towards greater women-led governance
- » The Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam, more popularly known as the Women's Reservation Act, was passed by Parliament in 2023
- » Under the law, 33 per cent reservation will be given to women in the Lok Sabha and state Assemblies

extension of the Budget session of Parliament by three days -- from April 16 to 18 -- so that the Women's Reservation Act can be amended for its implementation from 2029.

Officials said that if the proposal to implement the law even before the delimitation exercise actually materialises, another amendment to the Constitution will be required. The government is expected to amend the law in this effect in the three-day sitting of Parliament.

Modi had also urged all political parties to fully support it with an open mind and without political calculations, since "this is an issue related to women's empowerment".

He had asked them to "become partners in winning the trust of the country's mothers and sisters".

The law, brought by amending the Constitution, will come into effect after completion of the delimitation exercise.

The Prime Minister on Saturday announced an

laying the foundation, India is moving towards greater women-led governance. This is also a key pillar of Viksit Bharat!"

The Nari Shakti Vandan Adhiniyam, more popularly

known as the Women's Reservation Act, was passed by Parliament in 2023. Under the law, 33 per cent reservation will be given to women in the Lok Sabha and state Assemblies.

'Hard work, honesty & empathy embedded in Kerala's social fabric'

Hailing Kerala nurses, Congress leader Rahul Gandhi says they are the human face of medicine

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Congress leader Rahul Gandhi on Tuesday called for committing to build a healthcare system that supports, respects, and empowers nurses, asserting that their voices "must guide our priorities" as India's healthcare future depends on it.

The Leader of Opposition posted a video on his social media account of his recent interaction with nurses from Kerala and said the conversation reminded him of the quiet strength that holds the healthcare system together.

"I recently had the privilege of interacting with a group of nurses from Keralam working here in Delhi. The conversation reminded me of the quiet strength that holds our healthcare system together," Gandhi said in his post accompanying the video.

Asserting that nurses are the foundation of the healthcare system, Gandhi said their dedication, selflessness, and empathy



Congress leader Rahul Gandhi with the nurses from Kerala during an interaction, in New Delhi PTI

are what give families the courage to entrust their loved ones into someone else's care. In many ways, they are the human face of medicine, he said.

"During our interaction, I asked them a simple question: Why are nurses from Keralam so widely respected across India and the world? Their answer was equally simple: hard work, honesty, and empathy. These are not just words. These are values deeply embedded in Keralam's social fabric," Gandhi said.

The state has consistently

invested in education, healthcare, and human development, creating generations of professionals who carry these values wherever they go, the former Congress chief said.

"But there were serious concerns as well. They spoke about the shortage of trained nurses in India. In some government hospitals, around 15 nurses manage over 100 patients in a ward, far from safe global standards. This directly affects the quality of care our people receive," he said.

WARNS OF DHARNA

TMC flags 'targeted raids' in Bengal to EC, alleges observer misconduct

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA / NEW DELHI: Trinamool Congress (TMC), on Tuesday, submitted two separate memorandums, one to the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) in Delhi and the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) of West Bengal on separate issues.

In one letter, TMC told the CEC that since 05 April, the police authorities have initiated widespread, targeted, systematic and unauthorised raids at the residences of leaders, workers, and supporters of the TMC. "These actions appear to be politically motivated and selectively directed against TMC, thereby creating a climate of fear, coercion, and suppression, which is in direct contravention of the Model Code of Conduct enforced by the Election Commission of India," reads the letter.

The letter that carried an undersign of party's Rajya Sabha MP Derek O'Brien pointed out that "unlawful developments" were taking place in Nandigram, particularly within Nandigram Block-I. "These developments seriously undermine the sanctity of the electoral process and raise grave concerns regarding adherence to the guidelines and directions issued by the Election Commission of India ("ECI") to ensure free, fair, and transparent elections," letter stated.

Several key functionaries, including core committee members of Nandigram Block of TMC, such as Sheikh Abdul Alim Alrazi of the Kalicharan area, have been compelled to vacate their homes

The Allegations

- » 'Several key functionaries, including core committee members of Nandigram Block of TMC, such as Sheikh Abdul Alim Alrazi of the Kalicharan area, have been compelled to vacate their homes and remain in hiding under fear of arrest'
- » 'Families, including women and elderly members, are being subjected to intimidation and harassment'

and remain in hiding under fear of arrest. Families, including women and elderly members, are being subjected to intimidation and harassment.

"There are also a series of late-night searches without due process, coercive questioning, and threats being issued to local residents to disclose the whereabouts of leaders and members affiliated to TMC, failing which they are being threatened of arrest," it added further.

In another letter written to the CEC, TMC's Derek O'Brien alleged that the actions of Himanshu Lal, IPS, Special Police Observer in Bengal, are contrary to what he is supposed to do. His duty is to ensure free and fair elections but he is acting at the behest of "certain unknown persons" and he has "misused" his position to "harass", "intimidate" and "interfere" with the electoral process.

Congress unveils Bengal manifesto, positions itself as 'Third Alternative'



AICC president Mallikarjun Kharge among other leaders at the release of the party's manifesto for Bengal polls, in Kolkata on Tuesday PIC/GAUTAM BOSE

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: The West Bengal Pradesh Congress Committee (WBPC) on Tuesday released its manifesto for the 2026 Bengal Assembly elections, pitching itself as a "third alternative" in the state.

The document, unveiled by All India Congress Committee (AICC) president Mallikarjun Kharge in Kolkata, outlines five guarantees covering employment, education, healthcare, women's empowerment and support for farmers.

"We want to present a new alternative in Bengal. Our manifesto is not about distributing money but about rebuilding and reforming the state," Kharge said, adding that the focus would be on structural

economic reform alongside welfare measures.

The manifesto promises Rs 2,000 in monthly assistance for women aged 18 to 59 under the proposed "Durga Samman" scheme, along with free travel on government transport. It also proposes fast-track courts, a 24-hour helpline and stronger policing for crimes against women. Other promises include a Rs 5,000 crore fund for women entrepreneurs, interest-free loans, and free education for girls up to the postgraduate level.

For farmers, the party has promised Rs 15,000 in annual support along with free electricity. It also promised Rs 10 lakh health insurance cover for every family, including free cancer treatment.

'RELIGIOUS FAITH IS BEYOND JUDICIAL REVIEW'

Centre backs ban on women's Sabarimala entry in Top Court

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: Backing the restriction on the entry of women of menstruating age into Kerala's Sabarimala temple, the Centre on Tuesday told the Supreme Court that the issue falls squarely within the domain of religious faith and denominational autonomy, and lies beyond the scope of judicial review.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Centre, told a nine-judge Constitution bench headed by Chief Justice Surya Kant that if there is something unscientific, the remedy is with the legislature.

"We have to respect every denomination's practice; not everything is related to dignity or bodily freedom. If I go to a mazar or a gurudwara and if I have to cover my head, I can't say my dignity, right or choice is taken away," Mehta told the bench, also comprising Justices B V Nagarathna, M M Sundresh, Ahsanuddin Amanullah, Aravind Kumar, Augustine George Masih, Prasanna B Varale, R Mahadevan and Joy-malya Bagchi.

Mehta said if someone claims that human sacrifice is an essential religious practice and approaches the court under Article 32 of the Constitution, then the court need not examine whether it is religious or essential, and reject it on the ground that it directly violates public order, morality or health.

"It is submitted that the court should expressly decline a model of review that asks whether a practice is 'rational', 'modern', 'scientifically defensible', 'acceptable to judicial sensibilities', 'unpopular views' or based upon broad and subjective 'doctrines' of 'transformative constitutionalism' or



'constitutional morality'. Such an inquiry is not constitutional review; rather, it would be a substitution of judicial philosophy for religious self-understanding, depending upon the subjective view of the bench, which is not trained in interpreting religious texts ...

"The Constitution protects religious freedom precisely because the protected field contains convictions, rituals, disciplines, and forms of worship that may not satisfy secular

standards of reason, utility or majoritarian taste," Mehta said. The Centre submitted that there is an inherent risk in the court exercising its jurisdiction to interpret any religion.

"Apart from the fact that the court would not possess either expertise or scholarship on religious issues, holy books, scriptures, texts, et cetera, further in the context of India, which does not follow only one particular theistic religion but has a pluralistic society including

Hindus, Muslims, Christians and other religions ... each religion has its different sections or denominations, and each denomination and section has their own faith, belief and expression for worship. The founding fathers were fully conscious of this pluralism of the country and the internal pluralism amongst each religion," the Centre said.

At the outset, the top court asked counsels for the parties to adhere to the timeline, and said it will not grant more time as other urgent matters are pending.

The hearing is underway. In September 2018, a five-judge Constitution bench, by a 4:1 majority verdict, had lifted the ban that prevented women between the ages of 10 and 50 from entering the Sabarimala Ayyappa temple and held that the centuries-old Hindu religious practice was illegal and unconstitutional.

'Woman can't be treated as untouchable for 3 days'

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: A woman cannot be treated as "untouchable" for three days in a month and then cease to be considered untouchable on the fourth day, Supreme Court judge BV Nagarathna remarked on Tuesday.

The remark came while a nine-judge bench was hearing on petitions related to discrimination against women at religious places, including Sabarimala temple of Kerala, and on the ambit and scope of religious freedom practised by multiple faiths.

During the hearing, Solicitor General Tushar Mehta,

appearing for the Centre, submitted that he has strong objection to an observation in the 2018 Sabarimala judgment that the exclusion of women in the age group of 10-50 years from the temple was a form of 'untouchability', violating Article 17 of the Constitution.

In the Sabarimala case, Justice DY Chandrachud was of the opinion that exclusion of women, based on age or menstrual status, from entering Kerala's Sabarimala temple is a form of "untouchability" which places them in a "subordinate" position, perpetuated "patriarchy" and is "derogatory to their dignity."

Mehta said, "India is not

that patriarchal or gender stereotyped in the way that the West understands."

Justice Nagarathna, then said, "Article 17 in the context of Sabarimala, I don't know how it can be argued. Speaking as a woman, there can't be a three-day untouchability every month, and on the fourth day, there is no untouchability."

Mehta stated that he was not on the issue of menstruation.

He said the bar on women entry in Sabarimala temple was not related to menstruation, and said the restriction was only on the basis of age group.

TALKS WITH EAM JAISHANKAR TODAY

NSA Doval hosts B'desh Foreign Min for dinner meet, discusses ways to reset ties

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: National Security Advisor Ajit Doval hosted Bangladesh Foreign minister Khaliur Rahman for a dinner meeting on Tuesday, hours after the latter landed in New Delhi for a three-day visit aimed at repairing bilateral ties following more than 18 months of heightened diplomatic tension.

It is the first high-level visit to India by a senior member of the new Bangladesh Nationalist Party government led by Prime Minister Tarique Rahman that came to power in February following the parliamentary elections.

Various aspects of India-Bangladesh relations figured in the talks between Doval and Rahman with a focus on charting a new momentum in the ties, people familiar with the matter said. There is no official word on the meeting yet.



Khaliur Rahman FILE PIC

Foreign minister Rahman's delegation included Humayun Kabir, foreign affairs adviser to the Prime Minister. Rahman is scheduled to hold extensive talks with External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar on Wednesday. The Bangladesh foreign minister will also meet Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal and Petroleum Minister Hardeep Singh Puri.

INSIGHT

» Khaliur Rahman's three-day trip to New Delhi from Tuesday is the first high-level visit by a senior member of the new BNP govt

» The relations between India and B'desh witnessed major downturn after the interim govt headed by Muhammad Yunus came to power

Warm welcome to Foreign Minister Rahman of Bangladesh on his arrival in New Delhi today, External Affairs Ministry spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said on social media.

India and Bangladesh share warm and historic ties anchored in strong people to people relations, he said, adding Rahman's visit will "further bolster" India

Bangladesh partnership.

The relations between India and Bangladesh witnessed major downturn after the interim government headed by Muhammad Yunus came to power following the collapse of the Sheikh Hasina government in August, 2024.

The two sides initiated efforts to stabilise the relations after Lok Sabha Speaker Om Birla, accompanied by Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri, represented India at the inauguration of Tarique Rahman as the prime minister in Dhaka on February 17.

Rahman became the PM following his party's landslide victory in the parliamentary polls.

In a statement, Bangladesh's foreign ministry said that Dhaka will emphasise "stability and continuous development of bilateral relations based on dignity, mutual trust and respect, and shared interests" during Rahman's meetings with his Indian interlocutors.

MP to set up Training and Research Institute to boost financial discipline

SATYAPRAKASH SHARMA

BHOPAL: The Madhya Pradesh Cabinet, chaired by Chief Minister Mohan Yadav, on Tuesday cleared the establishment of a Financial Training and Research Institute (FTRI) in Bhopal to boost transparency and financial discipline. It approved an outlay of Rs 16,720 crore for key development and welfare initiatives across the state.

The proposed state-of-the-art institute is expected to provide structured training to personnel involved in financial administration and management, an official said.

The institute will be established within the campus of the RCVP Noronha Academy. It will



serve as a centralised hub for capacity building.

The Cabinet also approved major allocations across sectors to drive inclusive growth, including Rs 3,174 crore for the procurement of chickpeas and lentils, Rs 88.41 crore for an irrigation project, Rs 5,215 crore for forest reproduction, restoration, and conservation, and Rs 2,952 crore for the commercial tax department.

In education, Rs 3,039 crore was sanctioned for tuition fee reimbursement under RTE, Rs 693 crore for free textbooks, and Rs 940 crore for the expansion of PM-SHRI schools, and around Rs 600 crore for other schemes and projects. The meeting was attended by Deputy CMs Jagdish Devda and Rajendra Shukla, Cabinet members including Kailash Vijayvargiya, and Chief Secretary Anurag Jain.

NFR rolls out tech tools to enhance Vande Bharat Sleeper safety



MPOST BUREAU

MALIGAON: Northeast Frontier Railway (NFR) has introduced a suite of advanced, in-house developed technological tools to enhance safety and maintenance of the Vande Bharat Sleeper Express at the Kamakhya Coaching Depot.

The innovations include a smart Air Spring Monitoring System, a Portable Vibration Monitoring System for real-time diagnostics, and an indigenously developed External Pit Power Supply and Pre-cooling System. These systems are designed to improve operational efficiency, ensure passenger safety and reduce maintenance time.

India's first Vande Bharat Sleeper Express has been running between Kamakhya and Howrah since January, marking a new phase in premium rail travel. Building on this, NFR has adopted cost-effective and cutting-edge technologies aligned with global standards.

The Air Spring Monitoring System enables continuous tracking of coach conditions and early detection of faults using data-driven diagnostics. Meanwhile, the vibration monitoring system allows real-time assessment of rolling stock, helping detect potential issues before failures occur.

Chhattisgarh CM presents Bastar 2.0 development blueprint to PM

NEW DELHI: Chhattisgarh Chief Minister Vishnu Deo Sai on Tuesday met Prime Minister Narendra Modi and presented a "forward-looking vision" for the next phase of development in Bastar, amongst the regions worst affected by Naxal violence and now moving towards peace.

According to a statement, the CM expressed gratitude for the restoration of peace in the region following the decline of Naxalism and credited the continued support and leadership of the PM for it.

Highlighting the region's potential, the vision document outlines a transformative roadmap designed to accelerate economic progress and improve quality of life. In addition, the CM invited the PM to visit Bastar after the monsoon season. The proposed visit is expected to serve as a significant



Chhattisgarh CM Vishnu Deo Sai calls on PM Narendra Modi

milestone, with plans for laying the foundation stones of several major projects and inaugurating key initiatives in his presence, signalling the beginning of a new era of growth for the region, it said.

The Chief Minister said the development blueprint for Bastar is built around the core strategy of 'Saturate, Connect, Facilitate, Empower, and

Engage' and this approach aims to ensure rapid and inclusive expansion of basic infrastructure and essential services across the region.

A key focus is on integrating remote villages into the mainstream through a robust road network, alongside the completion of pending works under the Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana by 2027.

UP Cabinet hikes Shiksha Mitras' honorarium

Nod to land ownership rights for over 12K families resettled after Partition

BISWAJEET BANERJEE

LUCKNOW: The Uttar Pradesh Cabinet, chaired by Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, on Tuesday cleared a series of key decisions spanning education, welfare, and land rights, in moves seen as both administratively significant and politically timed ahead of the next electoral cycle.

In a major relief for education workers, the Cabinet approved a substantial increase in the honorarium of Shiksha Mitras and part-time instructors. Briefing reporters, Basic Education Minister Sandeep Singh said the monthly honorarium of Shiksha Mitras has been raised from Rs 10,000 to Rs 18,000, while part-time instructors will now receive Rs 17,000 instead of Rs 9,000. The revised payments will take effect from May 1.

The Cabinet also approved the purchase of 25L tablets under digital empowerment prog and setting up a medical college in Ballia

Singh noted that the honorarium of Shiksha Mitras had earlier been increased from Rs 3,500 to Rs 10,000 in 2017 after the BJP came to power, and termed the latest revision another significant step. More than 27,000 part-time instructors working in government schools are expected to benefit from the decision.

In another major welfare measure, the Cabinet approved granting land ownership rights to over 12,000 families displaced during the time of Partition and settled in the state. Finance Minister Suresh Kumar Khanna said the decision involves amendments to the Uttar Pradesh Rev-

enue Code, 2006, through the Uttar Pradesh Revenue Code (Second Amendment) 2026.

Under the revised provisions, eligible families will be entitled to ownership rights for land up to one acre, subject to conditions that the land is not under ceiling limits or classified as common-use categories such as grazing land or ponds. A total of 12,380 families across Pilibhit, Lakhimpur Kheri, Rampur and Bijnor districts will benefit, including those eligible under the Citizenship (Amendment) Act, 2019 and certain Scheduled Tribe families.

The Cabinet also approved the purchase of 25 lakh tablets

under the state's digital empowerment programme. Khanna said nearly 60 lakh smartphones and tablets have already been distributed in earlier phases, and the fresh procurement aims to widen access to digital learning tools.

Further, a new medical college will be set up in Ballia under the 'One District One Medical College' initiative. The institution will be developed on land belonging to the prison department, with the district hospital integrated into the facility. Once infrastructure is completed, the college is expected to seek approval for 100 MBBS seats.

Officials said a total of 22 proposals were cleared, reflecting the government's focus on expanding welfare measures and strengthening education and healthcare infrastructure across the state.

People of Bengal 'keen' to bring BJP in power, says Haryana CM Saini



Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini with BJP's Sreerampur seat candidate in West Bengal during nomination filing on Tuesday

CHANDIGARH: Haryana Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Tuesday claimed that people of West Bengal are keen to bring the BJP to power, alleging widespread dissatisfaction with the ruling government.

Saini made the remarks while interacting with media during his visit to the state following the filing of nomination papers by a BJP candidate from the Sreerampur Assembly constituency. He also held a roadshow in support of the party nominee, urging voters to back the BJP.

Targeting the ruling dispensation led by Mamata Banerjee, Saini alleged that the government had failed to deliver on employment, farmer welfare and women's safety. He said people had earlier placed hope in the Trinamool Congress after years of Left rule, but were now "distressed" due to alleged mis-governance and corruption.

Saini accused the state government of not implementing key central schemes due to political considerations, claiming this had adversely affected the poor.

Survey says 42.5% Indians 'deprioritise' health, 46% fail to maintain consistency

Lifestyle pressures emerges as 'key obstacles' to maintaining health

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: With as many as "42.5 per cent" of Indians admitting they sideline their health during busy periods and "57.8 per cent" saying they understand what is good for them but struggle to follow through, a survey released on Tuesday has flagged a growing gap between awareness and action.

The data-led study by wellness platform Habuild, based on responses from over 5,000 individuals across metro and tier one, two and three cities, on the occasion of World Health Day also found that "46 per cent" of respondents actively try to stay fit but fail to maintain consistency.

Nearly 90 per cent of participants were women aged 45 and above.

"While 57.8 per cent of respondents say they understand what's good for their health, they are unable to sustain it, and 46 per cent report actively trying to stay fit but failing to maintain consistency. This indicates that the challenge is no longer about awareness, but about integrating healthy habits into everyday life," revealed the report.

KEY POINTS

- » The data-led study was based on responses from over 5,000 individuals across metro and tier one, two and three cities
- » Nearly 90 per cent of participants were women aged 45 and above
- » Women were found



to be more likely to deprioritise their health due to family and household responsibilities

The findings also revealed gender-specific barriers to consistency. Women were found to be more likely to deprioritise their

health due to family and household responsibilities, resulting in irregular routines, while men, despite higher intent, struggle with discipline and follow-through.

Lifestyle pressures emerged as key obstacles to maintaining health.

According to the study, "28 per cent" of respondents cited family responsibilities as the biggest barrier, followed by "19.6 per cent" who attributed it to work-related stress and "17.5 per cent" who pointed to lack of motivation.

"Notably, one in ten Indians

reported not spending even 30 minutes a week on their health, underscoring how easily wellness is sidelined amid competing priorities," it added.

The survey also pointed to rising awareness around preventive health.

Over "51.5 per cent" of respondents believe lifestyle diseases will be India's biggest health challenge in the next decade, while "27.4 per cent" identified mental health as a growing concern, though this awareness has yet to translate into consistent behaviour.

The study further highlighted evolving preferences in how individuals approach wellness.

About "58.7 per cent" of respondents said structured programmes would help them take their health more seriously, while "71 per cent" believed that community-driven wellness improves consistency.

Additionally, over "54 per cent" expressed greater trust in structured wellness platforms over informal advice or influencers.

against each other but "spit venom" against him every day because he has "exposed" them before people.

"These are traitors who have never been loyal to the state and its people," he said.

He said: "For more than 70 long years in the post-independence era, the traditional parties mercilessly looted the state. Due to regressive and divisive policies of these parties, the state has lagged behind in the pace of development due to which the people had suffered."

However, he said, in the last four years, holistic development of the state has been ensured and for the first time, the state government has fulfilled all the promises made to people in such a short span.

"Opposition parties are hatching conspiracies to defame me as they are envious of the works being done by the state government for the well-being of the masses."

"These leaders are hand in glove with each other and play the game of musical chairs to secure interests of each other while in power..." Mann said.



EDITORIAL
TENSIONS IN
TRANSIT

The Strait of Hormuz has always been a narrow passage with an outsized presence in global affairs, but today it feels less like a shipping lane and more like a fuse. President Donald Trump has issued a blunt ultimatum: Iran must reopen the strait or face an intensified American military assault. Tehran has not formally sealed the waterway, yet the effect has been nearly as damaging. Traffic has slowed to a crawl, insurers are jittery, and global markets are bracing for aftershocks. The Strait's singular geography makes it uniquely vulnerable. It is the only maritime exit from the Persian Gulf, bordered by Iran to the north and Oman to the south, just 29 nautical miles wide at its narrowest point, with two-mile channels for inbound and outbound shipping separated by a slim buffer. In practical terms, this means that nearly every tanker leaving Gulf ports must pass through waters that Iran can observe, influence and, if it chooses, disrupt. In 2025, roughly 20 million barrels per day of crude and oil products — about a quarter of the world's seaborne oil trade — moved through this corridor to markets stretching from Europe to Asia and Australia. That volume is not an abstraction. It fuels cities, powers industries and underwrites national budgets. When Hormuz shudders, the world listens.

The first and most immediate pathway out of the crisis is a ceasefire, likely born of hard bargaining and bruised egos rather than trust. Such a truce could see Iran agree, even temporarily, to restore smoother passage through the strait in exchange for a halt to bombardment and some broader accommodation over its nuclear programme. Yet even under this comparatively optimistic scenario, the Strait would remain predominantly under Iranian control. Reports have already surfaced of tolls being extracted from ships seeking safe exit — a wartime expedient, perhaps, but one that hints at a possible post-conflict reality. Under international law, levying tolls in an international strait during peacetime is prohibited. However, laws on paper can look fragile after weeks of missiles and air strikes. Tehran may calculate that the world, eager for stability, will swallow a quasi-official fee structure as the price of calm. Shipping companies, faced with the alternative of paralysis, would likely comply and quietly pass the cost down the line. The result would be higher prices for Gulf exports and, eventually, for consumers far removed from the Gulf's heat. This scenario is the most plausible because it aligns with the visible diplomatic push to end open hostilities. But it would hinge on Iranian concessions significant enough for Washington to declare success — a tall order given the rhetoric on both sides.

The second scenario is far more combustible: an American shift from air and missile strikes to a ground operation. The United States has reportedly bolstered its regional presence by thousands of troops, bringing the total in the broader Gulf theatre to around 50,000. Such a posture suggests readiness, even if it does not guarantee intent. Analysts have speculated about the seizure of Kharg Island, through which the bulk of Iran's crude exports flow. Yet Kharg is not in the Strait of Hormuz itself and would not, by its capture alone, reopen the waterway. To secure Hormuz militarily would require an extensive naval commitment: minesweeping operations, constant surveillance and armed escorts shepherding commercial vessels in both directions. It would also demand political cover from allies. President Trump has indicated little appetite for acting entirely alone, and key partners have been cautious, if not outright resistant, to being drawn deeper into the confrontation. The military risks are obvious — Iranian asymmetric retaliation, regional escalation, attacks on US assets — but the political risks are equally stark. A prolonged ground engagement in yet another Middle Eastern conflict would test American public tolerance and strain alliances. For all its capability, Washington may conclude that reopening Hormuz by force carries costs disproportionate to the prize.

The third path is less dramatic but potentially more durable: end the war while leaving the strait's security to a broader international framework. Momentum is building for collective action. On March 11, the United Nations Security Council adopted Resolution 2817 addressing the safety of navigation in the Gulf and through the Strait of Hormuz. A subsequent resolution could explicitly authorise member states to secure the waterway, creating a legal foundation for a UN-mandated naval coalition. Such a mission would clear mines, patrol shipping lanes and escort vessels under an international flag, signalling that freedom of navigation is a shared interest rather than a unilateral demand. The United Kingdom has already convened discussions with partners, including Australia, to explore options. Other stakeholders — European states and Asian powers such as China, whose economies are tightly bound to Gulf energy flows — would have both the incentive and the naval capacity to contribute. Yet these governments are unlikely to act while missiles are still flying. They would prefer a post-conflict environment in which the United States has stepped back and the immediate risk of direct confrontation with Iran has subsided. This coalition model becomes the logical fallback if Washington declares victory, withdraws and leaves the question of maritime security unresolved.

What is beyond dispute is that the pre-war status quo will not simply snap back into place. Geography has not changed. Iran will continue to sit astride the northern shore of a narrow channel through which a significant share of the world's energy must pass. Even if hostilities cease and a broader settlement takes shape, Tehran will retain the capacity to disrupt, delay or monetise that passage. The rest of the world will have to decide whether to accommodate that reality, deter it or dilute it through collective oversight. The Strait of Hormuz has always been a chokepoint; now it is also a reminder that globalisation rests on fragile corridors controlled by sovereign states with their own grievances and ambitions. The choices made in the coming weeks — whether toward compromise, escalation or multilateral management — will determine not just the flow of oil, but the balance between power and law on one of the world's most consequential stretches of water.

BHARAT
KI SOCH



ANIL RAJPUT
THE WRITER IS
CHAIRPERSON
BHARAT KI SOCH

Vibhishan's choices show that real loyalty lies in defending principle, not power — and in knowing when dissent becomes responsibility, not betrayal

Responsibility of Loyal Leadership

In Vibhishan's counsel, dissent is not betrayal but responsibility — a lesson in leadership, moral clarity and the strategic value of insight

"No kingdom can endure when its course is set against dharma; reconsider, O King, before consequence overtakes intent."
— Valmiki Ramayana, Yuddha Kanda (Paraphrased)

In the vast narrative of the Ramayana, where duty, allegiance, and power intersect in complex ways, the figure of Vibhishan offers a nuanced reflection on the nature of loyalty in leadership. Born into the house of Lanka, he stood out as a principled counsellor in a court where loyalty to authority often outweighed principled counsel. In this environment, he advises, cautions, and persists in guiding his brother towards a path that preserves moral order and institutional balance. In doing so, he reveals that loyalty, when rightly understood, is not passive allegiance but an active responsibility.

Vibhishan appears in the Ramayana as the younger brother of Ravan, the king of Lanka, whose abduction of Sita, the wife of Ram, sets into motion a conflict that culminates in a decisive war between Ram's forces and the kingdom of Lanka. While many in the court either endorse the king's actions or remain silent, Vibhishan consistently counsels Ravan to correct his actions. He urges the return of Sita and warns that decisions influenced by personal conviction rather than broader dharmic considerations will lead to the kingdom's decline. His counsel, offered in open assembly before the senior members of Lanka's court, firmly and respectfully, is anchored not in opposition but in concern for the future of Lanka. When these efforts are dismissed, and Ravan remains adamant, he chooses to leave Lanka and align himself with Ram. His subsequent role in the conflict and his eventual stewardship of Lanka reflect the continuity between principled judgment and responsible leadership.

Leadership often demands allegiance to individuals and institutions. These bonds create cohesion and enable organisations to function with trust and clarity of purpose. Yet, such allegiance carries a deeper obligation, the responsibility to safeguard the principles that sustain the institution. Vibhishan's position within Lanka reflects this tension. As a trusted member of the inner council, he is integral to decision-making and fully aware of its consequences. He recognises that the abduction of Sita is not merely a strategic mistake, but a violation that places the kingdom itself at risk.

What distinguishes Vibhishan is the manner in which he exercises loyalty. He does not retreat into silence, nor does he concur for the sake of harmony. Instead, he chooses the more difficult path of counsel. He speaks with clarity and restraint, urging Ravan to return Sita and seek reconciliation with Ram, warning that the continued detention of Sita would inevitably draw Ram into direct confrontation with Lanka. His argument is reasoned and forward-looking. He cautions that no kingdom can endure when decisions are guided by personal desire rather than moral order. Loyalty, in this context, demands the courage to speak truth, particularly when silence would be more convenient.



For contemporary organisations, Vibhishan's actions demand a more exacting understanding of leadership

He does not offer counsel once and withdraws. He continues to engage Ravan even as resistance grows and dissent begins to surface within the court. Despite repeated warnings, Ravan chooses to remain committed to his course of action and dismisses the advice before his court. When reason is repeatedly dismissed and sound counsel begins to be viewed as a differing perspective, the limits of influence become clear. In such an environment, the role of a loyal advisor becomes constrained. Vibhishan persists until it is evident that correction from within is no longer possible.

It is at this point that his decision acquires significance. Vibhishan leaves Lanka after repeated attempts to restore alignment have failed, after being openly rejected in the royal court and denied any further opportunity to influence the decision. When he approaches Ram, he does so without assurance of acceptance, aware that his identity as Ravan's brother may invite suspicion. Yet his intent is clear. He seeks alignment with a cause that upholds dharma. This moment reflects a critical leadership insight. When internal correction is no longer possible, responsibility may require realignment. Such a decision is not a rejection of loyalty, but an extension of it towards principles that endure beyond individuals.

The response he receives is equally instructive. Ram's acceptance of Vibhishan is grounded in discernment. Despite reservations from others, he recognises the sincerity of his intent and grants him refuge. This reflects an essential leadership quality, the ability to recognise integrity beyond past association and to integrate it with confidence.

Vibhishan's value, however, does not end with his decision to realign. It is fully realised in the insight and clarity he brings with him. Having been part of Lanka's inner structure, he understands its command, its vulnerabilities, and the

mindset of its leadership. He provides critical insight into Lanka's defences, including the structure of its command and the strengths of its key warriors, anticipates strategic responses, and at a crucial moment identifies the specific vulnerability that enables Ravan's defeat. Ram's acceptance, therefore, is not only an act of trust but also one of strategic clarity. He recognises that Vibhishan brings not just intent, but insight that can shape outcomes. This reflects a powerful leadership reality that understanding the inner workings of the opposition and integrating that knowledge effectively can decisively shape outcomes. Leaders who are able to recognise and responsibly utilise such insight are better positioned to anticipate challenges, respond with precision, and convert intent into results.

In contemporary organisational contexts, this carries significant relevance. Competitive advantage often lies not only in internal capability but in the ability to understand external systems from within. Organisations that can integrate informed perspectives, when guided by discernment, strengthen both their strategic depth and execution capability. Vibhishan's contribution illustrates that a holistic approach, grounded in alignment and supported by deep understanding, creates not only clarity but effectiveness.

His role in the subsequent course of events further reinforces his leadership character. He does not remain a passive observer after his acceptance. He contributes actively to the effort to restore order, supports the larger objective with commitment, and remains aligned with the purpose he has chosen. The conflict ultimately ends with the defeat of Ravan and the restoration of value-based order in Lanka, where Vibhishan is entrusted with its leadership. Leadership, in this sense, is not defined by a single decision, but by sustained contribution.

There is a notable absence of personal ambition in Vibhishan's conduct. He does not seek the throne of Lanka as a condition for his alignment, nor does he leverage his position for advantage. The responsibility that eventually comes to him is a consequence of trust, not negotiation. This distinction matters. When decisions are guided by principle rather than personal gain, they reinforce continuity and institutional credibility. Leadership, in such instances, is not claimed. It is entrusted.

The trajectory of Lanka, in contrast, reveals what unfolds when loyalty is misunderstood. When counsel gives way to compliance, and dissent is treated as disloyalty, institutions find it increasingly difficult to recalibrate. Silence replaces judgment. Authority begins to substitute accountability. What appears as cohesion gradually becomes rigidity, and what is defended as strength ultimately exposes itself as fragility.

For contemporary organisations, Vibhishan's actions demand a more exacting understanding of leadership. Loyalty cannot be reduced to alignment with authority; it must be anchored in the responsibility to strengthen the institution itself. This requires leaders who are willing to listen, and systems that allow clarity to surface without penalty. The real test is not whether disagreement exists, but whether it can be engaged with seriousness and purpose.

At the same time, his role offers an equally important strategic lesson. Insight, when rooted in experience and understanding, becomes a decisive asset. Vibhishan does not merely realign with Ram; he brings with him a deep understanding of Lanka's internal structure, its leadership, and its vulnerabilities. It is this insight that shapes the course of the conflict. Leadership, in this moment, is not only about moral clarity, but about the ability to recognise and apply informed knowledge. Principle gives direction, but it is insight that enables execution.

Leadership, therefore, cannot be reduced to passive alignment. It must be exercised as an active discipline, one that advises with honesty, persists with conviction, and recognises when responsibility calls for a reassessment of alignment. Equally, it must be capable of identifying and integrating those who bring both integrity and understanding into the system. The ability to combine principle with insight is what allows leadership to move from intent to outcome.

The true measure of leadership lies not only in the loyalty one commands, but in the quality of insight one is able to recognise and utilise. Leaders who encourage principled counsel yet remain open to informed perspectives, even from outside their immediate systems, build institutions that are both resilient and effective. In a world defined by competition and complexity, it is this combination of integrity and understanding that ultimately determines success. Vibhishan's example, therefore, is not only a lesson in loyalty but a reminder that leadership must be both principled and perceptive, grounded in values, yet capable of acting with clarity and precision.

Views expressed are personal

STATECRAFT



RAVIKUMAR RAMANUJAM
THE WRITER IS A SENIOR JOURNALIST AND COLUMNIST

The first signs of economic stress do not appear in data sheets — they show up in factories, shifts, and wages. Tamil Nadu is already feeling that shift

Who Can Steer Tamil Nadu?

As global shocks begin to shape local livelihoods, Tamil Nadu's next vote may be less about promises and more about proven crisis leadership

Workers in the textile mills in Tiruppur can tell more about the economy before economists do. A delayed shipment, fewer overtime shifts, a pause in hiring or unsold inventory are the first signs that something is changing far beyond Tamil Nadu's borders.

The ongoing West Asia crisis has affected fuel prices, disrupted shipping lanes and affected exports and all of it eventually finds its way into factories, warehouses and workers' homes. It reaches Chennai's ports, Coimbatore's engineering units, and the industrial belts of Sriperumbudur and Hosur.

Like many states, this is also the reality of Tamil Nadu today and in such uncertain times, the next elections cannot be seen as just another contest of slogans and promises. The challenge in front of the next Chief Minister will be to steer through global tensions while ensuring that the growth trajectory of the state doesn't slow down.

This brings us to the key question: who can take up the challenge? At a time like this, Tamil Nadu does not simply need a political leader. It needs a crisis manager.

In moments of uncertainty, leadership is not measured by speeches alone. It is measured by how a government responds when the state is pushed into crisis. Tamil Nadu has been through such a time before, and it is here that Edappadi K. Palaniswami's record comes into focus.

When Palaniswami took office, the challenge was not an external shock, but an internal one. The passing of Jayalalithaa



This election in Tamil Nadu may be decided not by promises, but by crisis leadership

had left a vacuum at the heart of both the government and the AIADMK, creating a period of deep political uncertainty for the state. There was genuine concern that governance itself could slow down amid the internal struggle for control. But the state did not descend into administrative drift.

Instead, Palaniswami quietly established himself as a leader who could keep the system functioning. He secured political stability, held the party together at a fragile moment and, more importantly, ensured that government files kept moving and decisions kept being taken.

That steadiness was tested during the unprecedented Covid-19 pandemic. Hospitals were stretched, livelihoods were disrupted and fear was everywhere. Yet

what many people across the state remember from that period is the sense that the government machinery was present and active.

Testing was ramped up rapidly. Relief reached ration card holders and vulnerable workers. Welfare support was extended at a time when incomes had suddenly disappeared. At the same time, industrial corridors that form the backbone of the state's economy were carefully managed so that the economic engine did not come to a complete halt.

Crisis management is often spoken about in abstract terms. But for ordinary people, it is deeply tangible. Tamil Nadu saw that kind of governance during one of the most difficult periods in recent history.

The government had committed nearly ₹40,000 crore in relief measures, including cash transfers to ration card holders, free ration and essential commodities, and welfare support for unorganized workers.

Palaniswami's deep understanding of state topics allows for firm and swift decision making. One such example is the decision to designate the Cauvery delta as a protected agricultural zone. The issue was stuck for years despite knowing that the decision will secure farmers' long-term interests.

Today, Tamil Nadu stands at another such crossroads. The pressures may look different, but they are no less real. Global instability is beginning to shape local realities. If global demand weakens, factories here feel it. If energy prices rise, transport and production costs climb. If climate stress worsens, farmers bear the first hit.

In that sense, the coming election is not only about welfare or political identity. It is increasingly about resilience. That is why this election may ultimately be about something more fundamental than manifesto promises.

It may be about trust in administrative ability. Tamil Nadu needs leadership that can remain calm when circumstances are not. A leadership that understands that governance during stable times and governance during crisis are not the same thing.

In an uncertain world, that quality is no longer secondary. It may well be the central question before voters. Because when the next crisis comes, people will not look for rhetoric. They will need a cool head and a steady hand.

Views expressed are personal

IRAN IS HOME TO 90 MILLION PEOPLE

Prez says 14 mn Iranians, including himself, ready to secrifice their lives

DUBAI: Facing a looming US deadline, Iran's president said Tuesday that 14 million Iranians, including himself, have volunteered to sacrifice their lives in the war.

President Masoud Pezeshkian made the comment on X just ahead of US President Donald Trump's deadline to bomb power stations and bridges in Iran if it doesn't loosen its chokehold on the Strait of Hormuz.

The figure is double other figures mentioned by state media in the past about volunteers the government had been soliciting by text messages and media as the war went on.

Iran is home to 90 million people. Many remain angry at the government over its bloody crackdown on nationwide demonstrations



Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian

Highlights

- » The President made the comment just ahead of US' deadline to bomb power stations and bridges in Iran
- » I too have been, am, and will remain ready to give my life for Iran, Pazeshkian stated

and the 14 million figure likely is aimed at trying to dissuade the promised American bomb-

ing campaign.

"More than 14 million Iranian people have declared their

Iran calls for human chains to protect power plants

DUBAI: Airstrikes pounded Tehran on Tuesday, and Iranian officials urged young people to form human chains to protect power plants, hours before the expiration of US President Donald Trump's latest deadline for the Islamic Republic to reopen the crucial Strait of Hormuz or face punishing strikes on its infrastructure.

Trump has extended previous deadlines but suggested the one set for 8 p.m.

in Washington was final, and the rhetoric on both sides reached a fever pitch, leaving Iranians on edge.

Trump threatened to destroy all of Iran's power plants and bridges if Tehran does not allow traffic to fully resume in the strait, through which a fifth of the world's oil transits in peacetime.

Iran's president said 14 million people, including himself, have volunteered to fight.

AGENCIES

readiness to sacrifice their lives in the (self-sacrificing) campaign," Pezeshkian wrote.

AGENCIES "I too have been, am, and will remain ready to give my life for Iran." AGENCIES

Hungary elections: Vance says he's 'here to help' Orban's poll campaign

BUDAPEST: US Vice President JD Vance said from Hungary's capital on Tuesday that he was "here to help" Hungarian Prime Minister Viktor Orban's reelection bid, the clearest sign yet that President Donald Trump's administration is going all-in for an Orban victory when Hungarians go to the polls on Sunday.

Vance's two-day visit to Budapest is a bid to turn the tide in Orban's election campaign where the long-serving leader, a close Trump ally, is trailing in the polls.

Orban is running for his fifth-straight term as prime minister.

He and his nationalist-populist Fidesz party are facing their toughest race in two decades against a centre-right challenger, the Tiszta party led by Peter Magyar, that could bring an end to Orban's 16 years in power.

The prime minister has bristled at the slightest mention of the Hungarian election by any of his partners in the European Union,



US Vice President JD Vance during press conference in Hungary AP/PTI

"IN POWER SINCE 2010, ORBAN IS RUNNING FOR HIS FIFTH-STRAIGHT TERM AS PRIME MINISTER"

decrying any expressions of support for his opponent as a grave breach of Hungary's sovereignty and meddling in the election.

Yet speaking at a joint news conference with Orban at his headquarters in Budapest's Carmelite Monastery, Vance campaigned openly for the prime minister, saying he wanted to "help as much as I possibly can" ahead of the April 12 vote.

Vance was scheduled to appear later on Tuesday at an election rally for Orban dubbed a "Day of Friendship" event — an unusual step from a foreign leader and a break with the practice of most politicians who avoid taking an active role in the political campaigns of other countries.

Despite his clear endorsement of Orban, Vance lashed out at the EU for what he said was "one of the worst examples of foreign election interference that I've ever seen or ever even read about."

"I won't tell the people of Hungary how to vote. I would encourage the bureaucrats in Brussels to do the exact same thing," he said, adding that he was confident Orban would win the election.

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Extreme weather leaves 22 dead over past 24 hours in Afghanistan

KABUL: Afghan authorities said Tuesday that extreme weather has left 22 people dead and 32 injured over the last 24 hours, including more than a dozen who were killed when torrential rainfall caused the roofs of houses to collapse overnight in eastern Afghanistan.

Storms and heavy rainfall that have caused landslides, flooding and lightning strikes across the country over the past two weeks have left more than 130 people dead and destroyed or damaged thousands of homes, authorities have said.

The latest casualty figures from the Afghanistan National Disaster Authority come on top of dozens of deaths caused by heavy snowfall and floods earlier this year in Afghanistan, an impoverished country that is highly vulnerable to extreme weather events.

The authority said the figures could increase further.

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American journalist Shelly Kittleson has been released, says Iraqi official

BAGHDAD: American journalist Shelly Kittleson, who was kidnapped in Baghdad last week, has been released, an Iraqi official with direct knowledge of the situation said on Tuesday.

The official, who spoke on condition of anonymity because he was not authorised to comment publicly, said Kittleson was freed in the afternoon.

He did not share her current whereabouts but said that prior to her release, she had



American journalist Shelly Kittleson, who was kidnapped from Baghdad streetcorner

been held in Baghdad.

The powerful Iran-backed Iraqi militia Kataib Hezbollah said in a statement earlier in

the day that it had decided to free the journalist, and officials with the militia told The Associated Press that members of the group previously detained by Iraqi authorities would be released in exchange.

Kittleson, 49, a freelance journalist, had lived abroad for years before the kidnapping, using Rome as her base for a time and building a respected journalism career across the Middle East, particularly in Iraq and Syria.

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Over 80 migrants missing from boat that capsized after leaving Libya: UN

CAIRO: More than 80 migrants went missing after a boat that departed a Libyan coastal town capsized in the central Mediterranean, the UN migration agency said Tuesday. The bodies of at least two of them have been recovered.

About 120 people were on board when the boat departed from the town of Tajoura in northwestern Libya on Sunday. The vessel later overturned after taking on water during harsh weather conditions, according to the International Organisation for Migration, or IOM. A merchant vessel and a tugboat managed to save 32 people and the Italian coast guard transferred them to the southern Italian island of Lampedusa. Two bodies were also recovered, authorities said.

Libya has been a main transit point for migrants fleeing war and poverty in Africa and the Middle East. The country plunged into chaos after a 2011 uprising toppled and killed longtime dictator Moammar Gadhafi.

The Sunday incident comes

Closer Look

» About 120 people were on board when the boat departed from the town of Tajoura in northwestern Libya on Sunday

» The vessel later overturned after taking on water during harsh weather conditions

THE RESCUE TOOK PLACE WITH THE ITALIAN COAST GUARD

around a week after the Italian coast guard found 19 bodies and rescued 58 people when intercepting a dinghy filled with migrants about 80 nautical miles from Lampedusa.

The rescue took place with the Italian coast guard operating in the Libyan search and rescue zone during rough weather conditions. The tiny island of Lampedusa is the main entry point to Europe for migrants crossing the Mediterranean Sea from North Africa.

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UNITED NATIONS: Russia and China on Tuesday vetoed a UN Security Council resolution aimed at reopening the Strait of Hormuz that had been repeatedly watered down in hopes those two countries would abstain.

The vote — 11 in favour, two against and two abstentions — took place just hours before an 8 pm Eastern deadline set by US President Donald Trump for Iran to open the strategic waterway or face attacks on its power plants and bridges. One-fifth of the world's oil typically passes through the strait, and Iran's stranglehold during the war has sent energy prices soaring.

It's doubtful the resolution, even if it had been adopted, would have impacted the war, now in its fifth week, because it was been significantly weakened to try to get Russia and China to abstain rather than veto it.

The initial Bahrain proposal would have authorised countries to use "all necessary means" — UN wording that would include military action



Previous drafts had included adjacent waters

— to ensure transit through the Strait of Hormuz and deter attempts to close it.

After Russia, China and France, all veto-wielding countries on the 15-member Security Council, expressed opposition to approving the use of force, the resolution was revised to eliminate all references to offensive action. It would have authorised only "all defensive means necessary." A vote had been expected on Saturday.

But instead the reso-

locations. Most recently, she had been staying at a relative's residence in Dhanmondi, the report added. Deputy Commissioner (DC) of the DMP's media division, M N Nasir Uddin, said that Chaudhury is currently being interrogated, the Dhaka Tribune reported.

"As far as we know, cases have been filed against her over incidents during the July movement at Banani and Uttara police stations in the capital. There is also a case against her in Rangpur," he said.

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Pakistan issues 2,800 visas to Sikh pilgrims from India for Baisakhi

LAHORE: Pakistan has issued at least 2,800 visas to Sikh pilgrims from India to visit the country for Baisakhi festival scheduled to be held in Punjab province between April 10 and 14, an official said on Tuesday.

"On the occasion of Baisakhi and the 327th Khalsa Janam Din celebrations, Pakistan has issued more than 2,800 visas to Sikh pilgrims from India," Evacuee Trust Property Board (ETPB) spokesperson Ghulam Mohyuddin told PTI.

He said the Sikh pilgrims

Besides participating in the annual Baisakhi Mela in Pakistan, the Sikhs from India will also visit Gurdwara Janam Asthan, Nankana Sahib and Kartarpur Sahib

from India are scheduled to arrive via the Wagah border on April 10 with the main cer-

emony being held on April 14 at Gurdwara Panja Sahib in Hasan Abdal, some 400 kms from Lahore. Besides participating in the annual Baisakhi Mela in Pakistan, the Sikhs from India will also visit Gurdwara Janam Asthan, Nankana Sahib and Kartarpur Sahib.

The spokesperson said a high-level review meeting was held on Tuesday at the Punjab Home Department to finalise security and hospitality arrangements for the pilgrims arriving from India.

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the important global shipping route.

The UK's Permanent Joint Headquarters at Northwood in north-west London was named as the host of the multinational

UK hosts Strait of Hormuz military planning conference

LONDON: The UK is organising a virtual Strait of Hormuz military planning conference on Tuesday to follow up on talks held last week to address navigation concerns through

meet, expected to involve over 40 nations, including many of those who participated in online discussions led by UK Foreign Secretary Yvette Cooper on April 2.

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FUEL CRISIS



Rickshaw drivers of Pakistan protest against the recently increased fuel and gas prices by government amid surging global oil and gas prices due to Iran war, in Lahore on Tuesday

AP/PTI

Nepal: Rankings of Balen-led cabinet ministers reshuffled

KATHMANDU: Nepal President Ram Chandra Paudel on Tuesday revised the ranking of ministers in the cabinet led by Prime Minister Balendra Shah.

The order of precedence was shuffled at the recommendation of the prime minister, according to a notice issued by the President's office.

Prime Minister Shah remains at the top of the list, and in the second position is Finance Minister Swarnim Wagle.

As per the reshuffled cabinet ranking, Home Minister Sudan Gurung has moved down from third to fifth position, while Foreign Minister Shishir Khanal is now ranked third, moving up from fourth position.

Energy Minister Biraj Bhakta Shrestha, who was previously in sixth position, has been placed fourth.

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World Briefs

IRAN HAS ALLOWED 2 FRENCH FORMER DETAINEES TO LEAVE COUNTRY: PREZ

PARIS: Iran has allowed two French former detainees, Cécile Kohler and Jacques Paris, to leave the country, French President Emmanuel Macron said Tuesday. They had been holed up in French diplomatic premises there since their release from prison. "Cécile Kohler and Jacques Paris are free and on route toward French territory, after three and a half years of detention in Iran," Macron posted on X. The green light for them to leave Iran, long sought by France, signalled how Iran is differentiating between nations, treating some favourably and others as foes, in the context of the Iran war. Macron has distanced France from the conflict.

PAK-AFGHAN TALKS TO END CONFLICT CONTINUE UNDER CHINA'S MEDIATION

BEIJING: China-mediated talks between Pakistan and Afghanistan to end their current military conflict continued a week after they began, the Chinese Foreign Ministry said on Tuesday. "China has been making active mediation efforts to facilitate dialogue between Pakistan and Afghanistan. The process for talks is being implemented and advanced steadily," Chinese Foreign Ministry spokesperson Mao Ning told a media briefing here. The China-facilitated talks are the first major diplomatic engagement between the two neighbours since Pakistan launched Operation Ghalab lil-Haq in late February to target terrorist "hideouts" in Afghanistan.

Pvt banks outpace PSBs in Jan-March deposit growth

Pvt banks recorded deposit growth in range of 12-17% in Q4 FY26 against 2-14% growth among PSU banks

OUR CORRESPONDENT

MUMBAI: Private sector banks reported stronger deposit growth in the January-March quarter compared with their public sector peers, even as the broader banking system continued to face persistent challenges in mobilising deposits.

Data compiled from banks' provisional numbers disclosures showed that private sector lenders recorded deposit growth in the range of 12-17 per cent in Q4 FY26, compared with 2-14 per cent growth among public sector banks.

Banks have increasingly relied on mobilising funds through certificates of deposit (CDs) in recent quarters amid sustained pressure on low-cost deposits.

Deposit mobilisation has remained challenging, particularly on the current account and savings account (CASA) front, as relatively lower interest rates have made such deposits less attractive compared with other financial instruments.

Among private lenders, IDFC First Bank reported the highest growth, with deposits rising 17.2 per cent to Rs 2.43 lakh crore in Q4 FY26,



Among pvt banks, IDFC First Bank reported highest growth, with deposits rising 17.2% to Rs 2.43 lakh cr in Q4 FY26

followed by Kotak Mahindra Bank with 14.7 per cent growth and HDFC Bank with 14.4 per cent growth, according to provisional data.

In a note, domestic brokerage Motilal Oswal said HDFC Bank's deposit growth will continue to be at 14 per cent till FY28, and the credit deposit ratio is likely to moderate to 94 per cent by end of FY28.

In the public sector banking space, Bank of India (BoI) reported deposit growth of 14.33 per cent, followed by

Highlights

- » Kotak Mahindra Bank reported 14.7% growth & HDFC Bank posted 14.4% growth, according to provisional data
- » Among public sector banks, BoI reported deposit growth of 14.33%, followed by BoM at 14% & Central Bank of India at 13.3%
- » On the lending front, PSBs are performing relatively better than private sector banks

Bank of Maharashtra (BoM) at 14 per cent and Central Bank of India at 13.37 per cent.

A majority of the banks have shared the provisional performance data after the end of the quarter, but some like the country's largest lender SBI have not.

On the lending front, state-owned banks are performing relatively better than their private sector peers, reporting advances growth in the range of 12-22 per cent, compared with 12-20 per cent

growth recorded by private sector lenders.

Bank of Maharashtra reported an advances growth of 22 per cent year-on-year to Rs 2.92 lakh crore. Further, UCO Bank reported an advances growth of 20 per cent to Rs 2.34 lakh crore, and Central Bank of India reporting a growth of 18.90 per cent to Rs 3.45 lakh crore.

Systemic credit growth stood at 13.8 per cent as of March 15, 2026 (12.8 per cent year-to-date), with momentum remaining robust, supported by adequate liquidity buffers and a consumption-led recovery following GST cuts, Motilal Oswal said in a report.

On the profitability front, the report said that private sector lenders pre-provisioning operating profit to grow by 9.1 per cent year-on-year and 3.9 per cent quarter-on-quarter, and PAT to grow by 11.9 per cent YoY and 6.9 per cent QoQ in 4QFY26.

Public sector banks' PAT to grow by 2.1 per cent YoY (down 5.3 per cent QoQ) in 4QFY26E, amid repricing on the yields, limited reduction in cost of funds, and modest treasury gains due to a rise in bond yields, brokerage firm said.

Sebi extends IPO, rights issue approval validity till September 30

NEW DELHI: Sebi on Tuesday extended the validity of IPO and rights issue approvals till September 30 to provide companies more time to launch their offerings, amid ongoing tensions in West Asia.

The markets regulator's observation letters expiring between April 1, 2026 and September 30, 2026 will now remain valid till September 30, 2026, according to a Sebi circular.

Under the existing norms, companies are required to launch their public issues within 12 months or 18 months, as applicable, from the date of issuance of Sebi's observations.

However, the regulator said it has received representations from industry bodies highlighting difficulties faced by issuers in mobilising resources and accessing capital markets due to the prevailing uncertainty, including geopolitical tensions in West Asia and subdued investor participation.

"Considering the representation of the industry body, the prevailing uncertain market conditions due to ongoing geopolitical tensions and subdued investor participation, Sebi has decided to grant one-time relaxation to extend validity of the Sebi's observations letters, expiring between April 1, 2026-September 30, 2026 till September 30, 2026," the regulator said. PTI

Govt may seek revised bids from 2 potential buyers for IDBI Bank

'The IDBI Bank strategic sale is in the technical evaluation stage,' a senior official said

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The government may ask for revised financial bids from two potential buyers of IDBI Bank as their original bid amounts were lower than the reserve price fixed for the strategic sale of the lender, sources said.

"The IDBI Bank strategic sale is in the technical evaluation stage," a senior official said.

Amidst the West Asia crisis, the government is banking on disinvestment and asset monetisation to garner resources and create fiscal space for measures to shield the economy from the global uncertainty, officials said.

After over three years of pursuance, the strategic sale of IDBI Bank had reached the final stage of financial bid, and the government does not want to restart the process again to avoid further delay.

The government and LIC were together looking to sell 60.72 per cent in IDBI Bank and had floated an Expression of Interest (EoI) in October 2022. Financial bids came on February 6. After that, the government set the reserve price for the strategic sale. The financial bids for the IDBI Bank strategic sale, however, came in lower than the reserve price set by the inter-ministerial group on disinvestment headed by secretaries in the finance ministry.



Prem Watsa-led Fairfax & Emirates NBD are reported to have put in bids for the strategic sale of IDBI Bank

Following that, the strategic sale of IDBI Bank hit a roadblock.

Sources said that the government has now restarted work to take forward the IDBI Bank strategic sale to a logical conclusion.

Prem Watsa-led Fairfax and Emirates NBD are reported to have put in bids for the strategic sale of IDBI Bank.

Currently, the government and state-owned LIC together hold a 94.71 per cent stake in IDBI Bank. The government owns 45.48 per cent, and LIC

holds 49.24 per cent in the lender. Of this, the government and LIC are looking to sell 60.72 per cent in IDBI Bank.

In October 2022, the government and LIC had invited Expression of Interest (EoI) for selling 60.72 per cent stake in IDBI Bank. The Centre and LIC look to pare 30.48 and 30.24 per cent stake, respectively.

In January 2023, the government said it received multiple preliminary bids. Following that, the bids were sent for security clearance from the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) and for the 'Fit and Proper' assessment from the RBI. The short-listed bidders who received both the clearances later on undertook due diligence of the bank, and the government, in January, invited financial bids. In February, the government announced that it received financial bids for IDBI Bank.

India and New Zealand free trade pact likely to be signed on April 24

NEW DELHI: India and New Zealand are expected to sign a Free Trade Agreement (FTA) on April 24 here, which will provide tariff-free access to domestic exporters for their goods in the island nation's market, and will bring in \$20 billion of investment over the next 15 years, an official said.

The two countries on December 22 last year announced the conclusion of negotiations for the trade deal which aims at doubling bilateral trade to \$5 billion in the next five years.

The official said that the pact is likely to be signed on April 24 in Bharat Mandapam.

While India will get zero-duty market access on 100 per cent of its exports, the agreement will eliminate or reduce tariffs on 95 per cent of New Zealand's exports to India,



including items ranging from wool, coal, wood, wine, to avocados and blueberries.

However, New Delhi has made no duty concessions on allowing imports of dairy like milk, cream, whey, yoghurt, and cheese; onions, sugar, spices, edible oils and rubber to protect farmers and domestic industry.

Under the pact, New Zealand will also get duty-free access to goods such as sheep meat, wool, coal and over 95 per cent of forestry

and wood articles.

As regards the services sector, New Zealand will give a temporary employment entry visa pathway for Indian professionals in skilled occupations with a quota of 5,000 visas annually and a stay of up to three years.

This pathway covers Indian professions such as AYUSH practitioners, yoga instructors, Indian chefs, and music teachers, as well as high-demand sectors including IT, engineering, healthcare, education, and construction, strengthening workforce mobility and services trade.

Bilateral merchandise trade stood at \$1.3 billion in 2024-25. The total trade in goods and services reached about \$2.4 billion in 2024, with services trade alone reaching \$1.24 billion, led by travel, IT, and business services. PTI

Govt mulling options to retain 51% stake in PFC post merger with REC, says official

NEW DELHI: The government is looking at options, including issuance of preference shares or fresh equity, to maintain 51 per cent stake in the state-owned Power Finance Corporation post its merger with REC, a senior official said.

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman had in FY27 Budget announced restructuring of Power Finance Corporation (PFC) and Rural Electrification Corporation (REC) to help achieve scale and improve efficiency in the public sector NBFC space.

"The government would like to retain a majority stake in the merged entity as it would be the largest government-owned NBFC with strategic presence. Discussions are going on over the options to ensure that government stake in the merged entity does not fall below 51 per cent," the official said.

Nirmala Sitharaman had in FY27 Budget announced restructuring of PFC & REC to help achieve scale and improve efficiency in the public sector NBFC space

As per Companies Act, a 'government company' is one in which not less than 51 per cent of the paid-up share capital is held by the central government, or by any state government, and includes a company that is a subsidiary company of such a government company.

One of the options being discussed is issuance of preference shares by PFC to the promoter which is the government.

The other option on the table is issuance of fresh equity to the government. Both the options will help the government increase its stake in PFC so that the merged entity remains a state-owned company, the official said.

Currently, the government holds 55.99 per cent stake in PFC, and 52.63 per cent in REC. The remaining shareholding in both the companies is with the public. Shares of PFC were trading at Rs 407.95 a piece, while REC shares were trading at Rs 329.05 on BSE on Tuesday.

The merged entity, officials said, would have larger underwriting capacity for big ticket projects and enhanced risk

absorption appetite.

It would enhance scope for portfolio diversification in sectors like renewables and transmission and better compete with peers.

The Companies Act stipulates that a 'government company' must have at least 51 per cent of its stake held by the central or state government.

As on December 31, 2025, PFC's consolidated loan asset book was Rs 11.51 lakh crore, while REC's loan asset book was Rs 5.82 lakh crore.

Under the administrative control of the power ministry, PFC finances projects related to the power sector and holds 20 per cent market share. REC finances power sector projects involved in generation, transmission, distribution, renewable energy, and new technologies. PTI

'Certificates of origin can only be issued by authorised agencies'

NEW DELHI: The Commerce Ministry on Tuesday said certificates of product origin, a key document to seek duty concessions under a free trade agreement, can only be issued by authorised agencies.

The document is important to claim duty concessions under free trade agreements (FTAs). It is essential to prove where the goods come from.

An exporter has to submit the certificate at the landing port of the importing country.

"Certificates of Origin can only be issued by agencies authorised for the purpose. Exporters are mandated to use identical invoice numbers in certificates of origin and shipping bills to enable automated utilisation verification," the Directorate General of Foreign Trade (DGFT) said in a notification.

It also said authorised agencies for issuance of these certificates should accept and issue only from the designated electronic platform as specified by the DGFT.

India has signed free trade agreements with number of countries including the UAE, Australia, Singapore, and the United Kingdom.

Under these pacts, two countries significantly reduce and eliminate import duties on maximum number of goods traded between them. PTI

Air India CEO Campbell Wilson resigns

MUMBAI: Air India CEO and MD Campbell Wilson has resigned after leading the Tata Group-owned airline for four years marked by significant challenges, including last June's fatal AI171 crash.

The airline said its board has formed a committee to identify his successor in the coming months. Wilson had informed Chairman N. Chandrasekaran in 2024 of his plan to step down in 2026 and has since focused on ensuring a smooth leadership transition.

Wilson faced criticism following the June 12 crash of a London-bound flight from Ahmedabad that killed 241 of 242 people on board, as well as for regulatory lapses.

The Aircraft Accident Investigation Bureau has issued a preliminary report, with the final report due in June.

Chandrasekaran credited Wilson with driving progress and aligning the organisation behind a shared transformation vision.

A former Singapore Airlines executive, Wilson took charge in September 2022 after Air India's privatisation and launched the five-year "Vihaan.AI" turnaround plan. AGENCIES

Adani moves US court seeking dismissal of SEC fraud case, says lawsuit lacks jurisdiction

NEW YORK: Billionaire Gautam Adani and his nephew Sagar Adani have asked a US court to dismiss a securities fraud lawsuit brought by the US Securities and Exchange Commission, arguing the case falls outside the US jurisdiction and fails to establish any wrongdoing.

In a pre-motion letter filed ahead of a planned April 30 motion seeking dismissal of the lawsuit, Adanis through their lawyers said the SEC's claims over a 2021 bond sale by the group's renewable energy arm, Adani Green Energy Ltd (AGEL) are legally flawed on multiple grounds.

The SEC had sued the Adanis in November 2024, alleging

they misled investors by failing to disclose an alleged bribery scheme tied to Indian state officials, framing the case under US securities laws.

Adanis argued that the court lacks personal jurisdiction, saying neither had sufficient contacts with the US or direct involvement in the bond offering.

The \$750 million bond sale was conducted outside the United States under Rule 144A and Regulation S exemptions, with securities sold to non-US underwriters and only later resold in part to qualified institutional buyers, they said.

Lawyers added the complaint does not allege that Gautam Adani approved the

issuance, attended key meetings, or directed any activity at US investors.

The filing also contends the SEC's case is impermissible extraterritorial, noting the securities were not listed in the US, the issuer is Indian, and the alleged misconduct occurred entirely in India.

Citing US Supreme Court precedent, the defendants said the SEC failed to show any "domestic transaction", a requirement for applying US securities laws.

They went on to state that SEC does not allege any investor losses, adding that the bonds matured and were fully repaid with interest in 2024.

They also disputed the

underlying bribery allegations, saying there is no credible evidence supporting such claims.

The filing argues that statements cited by the SEC -- relating to ESG commitments, anti-corruption practices, and corporate reputation -- amount to non-actionable "puffery", or general corporate optimism that investors cannot reasonably rely on.

It further said the SEC failed to link either defendant to specific misleading statements or demonstrate intent to defraud.

The defendants are seeking dismissal of the case in full and said they are prepared to appear for a pre-motion conference if required. PTI

DoT extends AGR dues reassessment timeline for Vodafone Idea till June

NEW DELHI: The Department of Telecommunications (DoT) expects that AGR reassessment for Vodafone Idea -- which recently received government relief for its dues and liabilities -- will be completed by June, sources said. The reassessment was earlier targeted for completion by March 31. Sources said the review of Spectrum Usage Charge is on, following the internal licence fee reassessment by Controller of Communication Accounts.

Accordingly, the timeline has been extended to June, sources said. The Union Cabinet has given relief to Vodafone Idea Limited (VIL) based on



the Supreme Court order and 'frozen' its Adjusted Gross Revenue or AGR dues at Rs 87,695 crore for a period ranging from FY2007 to FY19. The 'frozen' dues are subject to reassessment.

The amount excludes those AGR dues of FY18 and FY 19 which stand finalised by the apex court's 2020 order and payable in accordance. PTI

JSW Group, HZL, Vedanta among 25 cos in pre-bid meet for rare earth magnet scheme

The govt will select a maximum of five entities through the bidding process

NEW DELHI: At least 25 companies, including JSW Group, Vedanta, Hindustan Zinc Ltd (HZL) and NLC India, attended a pre-bid conference for the government's Rs 7,280-crore scheme to boost domestic manufacturing of sintered rare earth permanent magnets, sources said.

The Ministry of Heavy Industries plans to select up to five entities through a competitive bidding process.

Each selected bidder can set up facilities with a capacity of

CLOSER LOOK

- » Each selected bidder can set up facilities with capacity of up to 1,200 tonnes per annum
- » Pre-bid meet held on April 7, saw strong industry participation. The bids will close on May 28

up to 1,200 tonnes per annum, taking the total planned capacity

to 6,000 tonnes.

Vedanta said the initiative aligns with its focus on critical minerals and offers expansion opportunities, given the growing importance of rare earth magnets in sectors such as electric vehicles, aerospace, defence and electronics.

The ministry had invited bids on March 20 to establish integrated manufacturing units for sintered NdFeB magnets.

The pre-bid meeting, held on April 7, saw strong industry participation. The last date

for submitting queries is April 22, while bids will close on May 28.

Technical bids will be opened the following day.

Officials said the bidding will follow a transparent, two-stage least-cost selection process conducted online via the CPP portal.

The scheme aims to strengthen domestic capabilities, reduce import dependence and build a globally competitive rare earth magnet ecosystem in India. AGENCIES

Govt plans ₹2.5L cr credit guarantee affected bizs hit by West Asia crisis

Under the scheme a credit guarantee of about 90% on loans of up to Rs 100 cr would be provided to lenders in case of default by borrowers

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NEW DELHI: The government is considering a Rs 2.5 lakh crore credit guarantee scheme to support businesses, especially MSMEs impacted by the West Asia crisis, sources said.

Under the scheme, a credit guarantee of about 90 per cent on loans of up to Rs 100 crore would be provided to lenders in case of default by borrowers due to the ongoing US-Iran conflict.

The guarantee on bank loans would be provided by the National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company (NCGTC), a wholly-owned subsidiary of the government.

The government would have to provide about Rs 17,000 crore to Rs 18,000 crore for the scheme.

Sources said the scheme was a huge success during the COVID-19 pandemic and helped many businesses across various sectors to stay afloat and clear their dues.

The government in May 2020 announced the Emer-



The guarantee on bank loans would be provided by the National Credit Guarantee Trustee Company (NCGTC), a wholly-owned subsidiary of the government

gency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) as part of the Aatmanirbhar Bharat Abhiyaan to support eligible Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (MSMEs) and other eligible business enterprises in meeting their operational liabilities and restarting their businesses

Highlights

- » The govt would have to provide about Rs 17,000 crore to Rs 18,000 crore for the scheme
- » The scheme was a huge success during the COVID-19 pandemic & helped many businesses across various sectors to stay afloat, sources said
- » The govt in May 2020 announced Emergency Credit Line Guarantee Scheme (ECLGS) to support eligible MSMEs and other eligible business enterprises

in the context of the disruption caused by the COVID-19 pandemic.

ECLGS covered almost all the sectors of the economy, and a 100 per cent guarantee was provided to Member Lending Institutions (MLIs) in respect of the credit facility extended

by them under the scheme to eligible borrowers.

The structure of the scheme permitted easy access to credit as the lenders offer pre-approved loans based on the borrower's existing credit outstanding, and there is no fresh appraisal undertaken by lenders since additional credit was sanctioned over and above the credit facilities already assessed.

Further, the interest rate was also capped with a view to lowering the cost of credit and loans are sanctioned without any processing charges, pre-payment charges and guarantee fees. The Scheme continued till March 31, 2023.

Besides, the government has taken a slew of measures in the recent past to mitigate the hardship of the common man, including slashing of excise duty on petrol and diesel.

India has reduced the excise duty on diesel and petrol, and specific exemptions were given on critical petrochemical products and SEZs to operate in the Domestic Tariff Area.

The government had on

March 26 slashed excise duty on petrol and diesel by Rs 10 a litre as it looked to shield consumers from the impact of rising global crude prices amid the ongoing war.

Global crude prices have risen by almost 50 per cent since the United States and Israel launched military strikes against Iran on February 28, triggering sweeping retaliation from Tehran.

The government also imposed an export duty of Rs 21.50 per litre on diesel and Rs 29.50 per litre on aviation turbine fuel (ATF).

Excise duty on petrol has been slashed to Rs 3 a litre, while on diesel it is zero currently.

On April 2, India exempted the import of critical petrochemical products from customs duty to ensure supply stability and provide relief to consumers of final products amid disruption in shipping routes due to the West Asia conflict.

Besides crude, India is a major importer of fertiliser and natural gas.

EV retail sales in India up 24.6% at 24.52 lakh units in FY26: FADA

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Total electric vehicle retail sales in India grew by 24.6 per cent at 24.52 lakh units in FY26 as compared to the previous fiscal, with every category delivering strong double-digit growth, Federation of Automobile Dealers Associations said on Tuesday.

While electric two-wheelers crossed 14 lakh units, electric passenger vehicle retail sales missed the 2 lakh units by a whisker but surged 83.63 per cent in FY26, FADA said in a statement.

"FY26 has been a watershed year for India's electric mobility story. Total EV retail across two-wheelers, three-wheelers, passenger vehicles, and commercial vehicles stood at approximately 24.52 lakh units, growing nearly 24.6 per cent YoY, with every category delivering strong double-digit growth," FADA President CS Vigneshwar said.

In the electric PV category, total sales were at 1,99,923 units in FY26 as compared to 1,08,873 units in FY25, a growth of 83.63 per cent.

Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles was the leader in the electric PV segment by volume at 78,811 units in FY26, followed by JSW MG Motor India at 53,089 units and Mahindra & Mahindra Ltd with 42,721 units in second and third spots,



While electric two-wheelers crossed 14 lakh units, electric passenger vehicle retail sales missed the 2 lakh units by a whisker but surged 83.63% in FY26

respectively, as per FADA data.

The electric two-wheeler category saw a growth of 21.81 per cent at 14,01,818 units in FY26, up from 11,50,790 units in FY25.

TVS Motor Company was the leader in the segment with 3,41,513 units, followed by Bajaj Auto with 2,89,349 units in second place and Ather Energy with 2,39,178 units in the third spot in FY26.

FADA said the electric three-wheeler category witnessed a growth of 18.97 per cent at 8,30,819 units in FY26 as compared to 6,98,914 units

Key Points

- » In the electric PV category, total sales were at 1,99,923 units in FY26 against 1,08,873 units in FY25, a growth of 83.63%
- » Tata Motors Passenger Vehicles was the leader in the electric PV segment by volume at 78,811 units in FY26
- » In the electric two-wheeler category, total sales were at 14,01,818 units in FY26 as compared to 11,50,790 units in FY25, a growth of 21.81%

in FY25.

Electric commercial vehicle sales zoomed 120.57 per cent at 19,454 units in FY26 as compared to 8820 units in FY25, FADA said.

Reflecting on the overall EV sales, Vigneshwar said, "This is not just an automobile industry achievement, it is a testament to India's ability to lead a mass-market energy transition, from the last-mile auto-rickshaw to the family car."

This shows that the structural momentum behind India's EV journey remains firmly intact, he added.

Rupee falls 16 paise to 93.06 against dollar



MUMBAI: The rupee depreciated 16 paise to close at 93.06 against the US dollar on Tuesday, as investors remained on edge ahead of US President Donald Trump's deadline for the opening of the Strait of Hormuz and the Reserve Bank's monetary policy review.

Forex traders said the USD/INR pair is trading under pressure, dragged down by unabated withdrawal of foreign capital, a firm dollar, and higher crude oil prices amid a volatile geopolitical situation.

Moreover, market participants will remain watchful of evolving geopolitical headlines and the upcoming RBI monetary policy decision.

At the interbank foreign exchange market, the rupee opened at 93.05 against the US dollar and touched an intra-day low of 93.12.

During the day, the rupee also touched an intra-day high of 92.86 against the greenback.

At the end of Tuesday's trading session, the rupee was quoted at 93.06, down 16 paise from its previous close.

The dollar index, which gauges the greenback's strength against a basket of six currencies, was down 0.15 per cent at 99.83.

Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, was trading lower by 1.97 per cent at \$107.61 per barrel in futures trade.

No cash payments at toll plazas on national highways from April 10

"The move is aimed at reducing long queues at toll gates and make highway travel smoother for commuters"

NEW DELHI: Cash payments at toll plazas will be discontinued for travellers on national highways from April 10, the road transport and highways ministry has said.

In a gazette notification, the ministry has said that in cases where a vehicle enters a fee plaza without a valid FASTag, users can still pay via Unified Payment Interface (UPI), but at a higher charge of 1.25 times the applicable toll fee.

A senior NHAI official said that the move is aimed at reducing long queues at toll gates and make highway travel smoother for commuters.

The official said that cash payments will no longer be accepted at the toll booths from April 10 and FASTag will



remain the primary mode of toll collection, while UPI will serve as the fallback payment option for vehicles that arrive without a valid FASTag.

"If the user of a vehicle enters a fee plaza without a FASTag or a valid functional FASTag, as the case may be, and opts to pay fee through the Unified Payment Interface (UPI), he shall pay 1.25 times of the user fee applicable to that

category of vehicle in accordance with the provisions of sub-rule (2) of rule 4."

"Provided that if the owner or driver of the vehicle does not opt to pay a fee in the manner specified under this rule, such vehicle shall be dealt in accordance with rule 14," the notification said.

Recently, NHAI also crossed 50 lakh subscribers for its FASTag annual pass, which allows users to make up to 200 toll crossings for Rs 3,000 per year. Since its launch on August 15, a total of 26.55 crore transactions have been carried out through these passes.

There are over 1,150 fee plazas on various National Highways and Expressways in the country.

'Maharashtra's \$1 tn economy vision focuses on becoming global mfg, services & innovation hub'

MUMBAI: Jishnu Dev Varma on Tuesday said Maharashtra's \$1 trillion economy vision reflects its ambition to emerge as a global hub for manufacturing, services, innovation, and inclusive growth.

Addressing the Federation of Indian Chambers of Commerce & Industry Foundation Day event, the Governor of Maharashtra highlighted the state's pivotal role in India's growth, citing its industrial strength, innovation ecosystem and contribution to direct taxes.

He noted that Maharashtra would be central to India's journey towards becoming a 'Viksit Bharat' by 2047.

Emphasising the role of states in national development, he said the success of 'Viksit Bharat' depends on building 'Viksit States', with industry playing a key



Governor of Maharashtra Jishnu Dev Varma

role in driving innovation and investment.

Varma also underlined FICCI's legacy, saying the industry body has witnessed India's transition from pre-independence regulatory systems to post-liberalisation market-led growth. Over its 99-year journey, FICCI has empowered entrepreneurs

and contributed significantly to making Mumbai the country's economic engine, he added.

The Governor urged FICCI to collaborate with the state government and universities to strengthen dialogue and partnerships across priority socio-economic areas. He also called on the industry body to study

Verma said the success of 'Viksit Bharat' depends on building 'Viksit States', with industry playing key role in driving innovation and investment

the impact of ongoing Middle East conflicts on Indian sectors, particularly on vulnerable sections, and suggest mitigation strategies. He added that his office continues to stress industry participation and innovation in addressing complex public challenges, positioning Maharashtra as a key driver of inclusive and sustainable growth.

NEW DELHI: Bank of Baroda has launched 'bob SAMVAD', an AI-powered multilingual conversational platform aimed at transforming customer interactions at its branches.

The platform was formally unveiled by M Nagaraju, Secretary, Department of Financial Services (DFS), Ministry of Finance, in Mumbai on March 28, 2026.

Positioned as an industry-first initiative, bob SAMVAD is designed to eliminate language barriers by enabling seamless communication between customers and branch staff in their preferred languages.

Developed in-house, it supports real-time, two-way conversations across 22 languages using AI-driven speech and language technologies, ensuring accuracy and natural fluency.



it supports real-time, two-way conversations across 22 languages using AI-driven speech & language tech

Nagaraju lauded the initiative, saying it would promote inclusive and accessible service delivery while enhancing customer experience. He

added that the platform sets a new benchmark for technology adoption in banking.

At branches, customers can speak or type queries in their chosen language, which are instantly translated for staff, and vice versa. The system displays conversations as text and also offers an optional voice feature for greater accessibility.

Commenting on the launch, Dr. Debadatta Chand, MD & CEO, Bank of Baroda, said, "With bob SAMVAD, Bank of Baroda (BoB) is leveraging AI to make our branches more inclusive and customer-friendly by enabling seamless real-time conversations in local languages." The platform will initially be rolled out across 250 branches in five states, followed by a phased nationwide expansion.

'Banks should cut exposure from vulnerable MSMEs, retail borrowers'

"There is a need for banks to convert early risk signals into decisive action, EY said in a report"

MUMBAI: Amid the ongoing West Asia war, a consultancy firm on Tuesday asked banks to shift exposures away from vulnerable small businesses and retail borrowers who may face the impact of lay-offs. There is a need for banks to convert early risk signals into decisive action, EY said in a report.

"This can mean shifting exposures away from vulnerable MSME segments, import-intensive borrowers, and lay-off-exposed retail cohorts, while scaling structurally stronger sectors and resilient secured portfolios," the report said. It recommended banks

to focus on intervening early by resetting covenants, enforcing liquidity buffers, tightening collections, and using preemptive restructuring where cash flow timing is stressed.

The report said multi-factor stress testing, capturing shocks from oil prices, foreign exchange movements, logistics disruptions, and demand volatility, should be used to assess rating migration risks and build expected credit loss buffers. Adopting this approach moves risk management from reactive containment to proactive control, strengthening asset quality and limiting credit costs

CLOSER LOOK

- » Export-oriented MSMEs, especially in apparel, along with chemicals, logistics, and aviation sectors, are facing more acute margin and liquidity pressure, the report said
- » In near term, bigger risk is rising liquidity use, creating latent asset quality pressure as margins remain tight

across the cycle, it said.

The report said the conflict's domestic transmission is increasingly visible in liquidity consumption across supply chains, and rising input costs and longer lead times are driving greater reliance on bank liquidity through elevated cash

credit or overdraft utilisation, stretched receivables, inventory buildups, and short-tenor rollovers. The report said lenders should embed sector-level diagnostics into underwriting and pricing, along with comprehensive borrower assessment based on key financial

indicators such as Debt Service Coverage Ratio, Interest Coverage Ratio, and working capital adequacy. Export-oriented MSMEs, especially in apparel, along with chemicals, logistics, and aviation sectors, are facing more acute margin and liquidity pressure, the report said.

In the near term, the bigger risk is rising liquidity use, creating latent asset quality pressure as margins remain tight and cash cycles extend, it said.

A prolonged conflict could lead to job losses and economic disruption in the region, dampening remittance inflows over time and pressuring remit-

tance-dependent households, particularly in states such as Kerala, Gujarat, & Maharashtra, the report said. The first-order impact is typically treasury-led, reflected in volatility in foreign exchange, interest rates, and funding costs, which can quickly affect net interest margins. The second-order impact is borrower-led, seen in margin pressures, longer operating cycles, and rising working capital utilisation, while the third-order impact is demand-led, often emerging with a lag through weaker collections, retail loan slippages, and stress in the MSME segment.

GAIL, ALPHA GAS INK PACT



GAIL (India) Ltd has entered into a long-term charter party agreement with Alpha Gas, a leading Greek shipping major, for the LNG carrier 'Energy Fidelity'. The charter party agreement was executed between GAIL and Pantheon Maritime Services Private Ltd, a Singapore based affiliate of Alpha Gas. S Bairagi, Executive Director (Mktg. - Shipping & International LNG), GAIL (India) Ltd and Anna Angelicousis, Owner of Alpha Gas, signed the agreement at the Alpha Gas' headquarters in Athens.

RAMPANT RIZVI IN FOCUS AS DC TAKE ON TITANS

DC’s R-rated factor

NEW DELHI: Delhi Capitals will be expecting runs from their KL Rahul-led top-order as they look to maintain their winning momentum against a faltering Gujarat Titans in the IPL here on Wednesday.

Delhi Capitals have had near-perfect games with the ball, while 22-year-old Sameer Rizvi has been carrying the bulk of their batting load, having come of age early in the season. If the likes of Rahul and Co. get into the groove, the Delhi Capitals will become a more formidable unit.

Rahul can't be blamed for the way he has got out in his first two innings and it is only a matter of time before he finds his consistency.

Nitish Rana would be feeling more pressure having got the opportunity to bat at number three.

Pathum Nissanka found his range in the last game here, giving him additional confidence to take on the Gujarat Titans pace duo of Kagiso Rabada and Mohammed Siraj in the powerplay. Having smashed his third IPL fifty in a row (one came last season), Rizvi is on a rampage. He always had the ability to take spinners to the cleaners but he is now able to change gears even against the fast bowlers.



DC's Sameer Rizvi is having a wonderful time in the middle so far

PTI

The first half of his innings against Mumbai Indians was rather measured before he went ballistic to script a comfortable win for his team.

Mukesh Kumar has been impressive with the ball while captain Axar Patel has been effective as ever both in the powerplay and middle overs.

Lungi Ngidi has added depth to the bowling unit which also features T Natarajan and Indian wrist spinner Kuldeep Yadav.

In contrast, Gujarat Titans are a team that is faltering on both fronts.

Titans have been struggling

DC have had near perfect couple of games with the ball while 22-year-old Sameer Rizvi has been carrying the their batting load

to shed the top-heavy tag. They should have chased 205 against Rajasthan Royals comfortably but the unproven middle-order could not cash in on the start provided by Sai Sudharsan.

The middle-order comprising Glenn Phillips, Washington Sundar and Rahul Tewatia needs to step up under pressure.

Captain Shubman Gill missed the previous game due to a muscle spasm but stand in skipper Rashid Khan said he should be fine for their crucial fixture against Delhi Capitals.

Having lost their first two games, Titans also need to be more professional in the bowling department. Both Siraj and Rabada have been a tad expensive while Prasadh Krishna has not been consistent enough.

AGENCIES

ASIAN BOXING C'SHIPS

Minakshi, Jaismine punch final ticket



Jaismine Lamboria won a hard-fought 57kg semifinal

ASIAN BOXING

ULAANBAATAR: Reigning world champions Jaismine Lamboria and Meenakshi Hooda progressed to the finals along with two others at the Asian Boxing Championships here on Tuesday, taking India's total finalists to eight.

Vishvanath Suresh (50kg) and Sachin Siwach (60kg) also registered impressive semifinal wins, while Akash (75kg), Lokesh (85kg), Narender Berwal (90+kg) and Harsh Choudhary (90kg) signed off with bronze medals.

India will thus have eight boxers -- six women and two men fighting in the final.

In the women's 48kg semifinal, Meenakshi secured a confident 4-1 win over Thailand's Thipsatcha Yodwaree to book her place in the gold medal bout, where she will face local favourite Nomundari Enkh-Angalan.

Jaismine joined her in the finals after edging past Uzbekistan's Nigina Uktamova 3-2 in a hard-fought 57kg semifinal. The 2022 Commonwealth Games bronze medallist will take on Thailand's Punrawee Ruenros in the title clash.

In the men's section, Vishvanath, who had stunned reigning world champion and world No. 1 Sanzhar Tashken-

World Cup medallist Sachin (60kg) also impressed, posting a solid 4-1 win over Ruamtham

bay of Kazakhstan in the previous round, continued his fine run with a dominant 5-0 victory over Jordan's Huthaifa Eshish to advance to the final.

World Cup medallist Sachin (60kg) also impressed, posting a solid 4-1 win over Thailand's Sakda Ruamtham in his semifinal.

Akash, however, lost 1-4 to Uzbekistan's Javokhir Abdurakhimov while Lokesh went down 0-5 against Jasurbek Yuldotshev of Uzbekistan.

Asian Games bronze medallist Narender suffered a 1-4 defeat to China's Bayikewuzi Danabieke with the bout being stopped in the first round due to a cut.

Harsh Choudhary also went down by a similar 1-4 margin to Tajikistan's Parviz Karimov, Tanvi Sharma takes on Malaysia's K. Letshanaa, and Malvika Bansod faces Thailand's Busanan Ongbamrungphan.

AGENCIES

Shami asks Rahane for to leave KKR to him

KOLKATA: Fresh from his match-winning performance against Sunrisers Hyderabad, Lucknow Super Giants pacer Mohammed Shami returns to his 'home' ground, Eden Gardens, to face Kolkata Knight Riders, sounding a quiet warning to the opposition.

Winless after three matches, embattled Kolkata Knight Riders take on Lucknow Super Giants here on Thursday, their third home game in a row.

"You always have that home advantage playing at Eden Gardens," Shami said on Tuesday, speaking alongside Kolkata Knight Riders skipper Ajinkya Rahane and his deputy Rinku



Mohammed Shami plays for Bengal in the Ranji Trophy

PTI

Singh at the unveiling of third season of Bengal Pro T20 League. "You understand the conditions, the pitch behaviour

because you've played there for a long time and spent a lot of time on that ground.

"So that benefit is always there. If I come here and play against KKR, there will be some advantage for me being a 'local'."

The fast bowler produced a stunning 2/9, including 18 dot balls, as the Rishabh Pant-led side secured their first win of the season, defeating Sunrisers Hyderabad by five wickets in their previous match in Hyderabad.

Despite his consistent performances for Bengal following his return from injury, Shami has remained out of the national team. He was among the top

six wicket takers in the recently concluded Ranji Trophy, claiming 37 scalps at an impressive average of 16.72.

Shami also played a key role in Bengal's run to the semifinals, including a standout performance of 8/90, though the team eventually lost to champions Jammu and Kashmir after taking a first-innings lead.

"Hum mazdoor aadmi hain, humein bas ball daalni hai (we are like labourers, we just have to keep bowling)," Shami quipped. "There will be ups and downs in life -- injuries and all -- but you should never forget your ground-level hard work."

AGENCIES

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the newspapers, social media platforms & website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 158-Kolkata Port

(2) Name of the candidate – Firhad Hakim

Sl.no.		
1.	Criminal antecedents	
i)	a.	Nature of the offences Offences alleged under: 1. Sections120B of IPC 1860 r/w Section 7, 13(2) r/w 13(1)(a)& 13(1)(d) Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988 2. Sections 3/4 of PMLA, 2002
	b.	Case no. 1. R.C. No. 0102017 A0010, dated 16/04/2017 (RC-10/2017), CBI, EOW, Kolkata 2. M.L. Case No. 7 of 2021, Directorate of Enforcement, Salt Lake, Kolkata
	c.	Name of the Court 1. Learned Special Judge (CBI), Court No. 1, Bichar Bhawan, Calcutta 2. Learned Special Judge (CBI), Court No. 1, Bichar Bhawan, Calcutta
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No) 1. No 2. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any Not Applicable
f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any Not Applicable	
	Any other information required to be given Not Applicable	
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere "winnability" at the polls (not more than 100 words) The candidate has built a strong foundation as a grassroots political worker, actively engaging with the public at every level. His tenure as the Mayor of Kolkata, along with his responsibility for the Urban Development portfolio, highlights his administrative experience and leadership. Known for his accessibility and deep connection with the community, he has consistently demonstrated a commitment to public service, making him well-suited to undertake legislative responsibilities.	
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words) Same as above.	

(3) Name of the Constituency – 158-KOLKATA PORT

(4) Name of the candidate: Firhad Hakim

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O'Brien
National Working Committee Member
All India Trinamool Congress

Badminton Asia C'ships: Dhruv-Tanisha only bright spot on Day 1

NINGBO: India's leading mixed doubles pair of Dhruv Kapila and Tanisha Crasto advanced to the second round, but the duo of Rohan Kapoor and Gadde Ruthvika Shivani crashed out of the Badminton Asia Championships 2026, which got underway here on Tuesday.

Kapila and Crasto won 21-14, 11-21, 21-15 over Thailand's Phuwanat Horbanluekit and Benyapa Aimsaard.

However, Rohan Kapoor and Gadde Ruthvika Shivani went down fighting against Malaysia's eighth seeds Goh Soon Huat and Lai Shevon Jemie 13-21 19-21 in a 34-minute contest at the Ningbo Olympic Centre.

The Indian duo of Kapoor and Shivani struggled to find rhythm early on, conceding the first game comfortably, but showed signs of resistance in the second before the experienced Malaysian combination shut the door in straight games.

In another match, Ashith Surya and Amrutha Pramuthesh also failed to cross the opening hurdle, losing 16-21 15-21 to Malaysia's Wong Tien Ci and

Lim Chiew Sien in 31 minutes. The focus will shift to singles competition on Wednesday with India's top stars set to begin their campaigns. Lakshya Sen will spearhead the men's singles challenge.

The country's top-ranked shuttler faces a tricky opening match against Hong Kong's Lee Cheuk Yiu, against whom the Indian has a 2-3 head-to-head record.

In the women's singles, double Olympic medallist PV Sindhu returns to action after a disrupted European leg and will open her campaign against Malaysia's Wong Ling Ching. In women's singles, double Olympic medallist PV Sindhu returns to action after a disrupted European leg and will open her campaign against Malaysia's Wong Ling Ching.

Apart from Sen and Sindhu, India will also have Kidambi Srikanth, HS Prannoy and Ayush Shetty in men's singles, while Tanvi Sharma, Unnati Hooda and Malvika Bansod will feature in the women's draw, with all of them slated to begin their campaigns on Wednesday.

AGENCIES



Dhruv Kapila and Tanisha Crasto won in three games

FILES

Asian C'ships: Grappler Lalit bags silver, bronze for Sunil

India's medal rush begins

BISHKEK: Lalit bagged India's first medal of the 2026 Senior Asian Wrestling Championships, claiming a silver in the 55kg Greco Roman category while Nitesh reached the final of the 97kg competition here on Tuesday.

Former champion Sunil Kumar added another bronze medal to his trophy cabinet to make it a fruitful day for the Indian contingent.

Former U-23 Asian Championships bronze winner Lalit, who had packed off China's Huoying Shi in the semifinals, put up a strong resistance against Ikhtiyor Botirov of Uzbekistan in the final but could not avoid a 0-9 loss.

In the 87kg bronze medal

Sunil Kumar added another bronze medal to his trophy cabinet to make it a fruitful day for the Indian contingent

match, Sunil Kumar fought back after conceding four points in the first round to beat Uzbekistan's Mukhammadkodir Rasulov 5-4 to win his second consecutive bronze in the Asian Championships.

Earlier, Nitesh ensured that he would improve on his 2025 championships performance after securing a final spot in the 97kg Greco Roman category.

The 23-year-old, who had bagged the bronze medal last year, defeated Zegang Wang of China 7-2 in the semifinals

to set up a gold medal clash against defending champion Mohammadhadi Saravi of Iran.

In the semifinal, Nitesh made the most of the par Terre (ground position) for passivity given to the Chinese in the first round by scoring six points, which included a four-point throw. He then defended astutely in the second round to win easily.

India will also have a shot at the bronze medal in 82kg Greco Roman category with Prince taking on Didar Ammanazarov

of Turkmenistan. The 20-year-old went down 10-0 against Iran's Mohammadamin Hosseini of Iran in the semifinals. However, there was heartbreak for Aman in the 77kg Greco Roman bronze medal match as he went down 14-15 against South Korea's Yeonghun Noh.

Aman fought back from a 7-12 deficit at the end of the first round but fell short by a point. Sachin Sahrawat (67kg GR) will also have a shot at the bronze medal after he managed to get in the repechage round and will face China's Ji Leng on Wednesday. Sachin Sahrawat (67kg GR) will also have a shot at the bronze medal after he managed to get in the repechage round.

AGENCIES

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tendering Notice

Sr. DEE/TRD/Agra for & on behalf of President of India invites "Open Tender" through online only (E-Tendering) for the following work:

Tender No.: AGCTRTD202607

Name of work: Modification in OHE due to "Provision for Extension of UP Loop Line at RNKA Station,"

Approximate Cost : ₹ 68,14,828.30/- **Earnest Money:** ₹ 1,36,300/-

Period of completion: Twelve months

1. For full details & submission of the bid please see the Indian Railway website www.irops.gov.in. 2. Tender can only be submitted through web portal "www.irops.gov.in" up to **15.30 Hrs.** on date **29.04.2026**

755/26 FA

North central railways @CPRONCR www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

Centre for Cultural Resources and Training

(Under the aegis of Ministry of Culture, Govt. of India)
15-A, Sector-47, Dwarka, New Delhi - 110075

CCRT/11011/01/2026/
08/04/2026

CORRIGENDUM

Advertisement for the post of Director, CCRT Level-12, GP-7600

With reference to CCRT advertisement No. CCRT/11011/01/2026/01 dated 07th - 13th February, 2026, inviting applications for the post of Director on Composite Method: Deputation (including short-term contract) plus promotion; failing which by Direct Recruitment basis, published in the Employment News (07th - 13th February, 2026) and in other newspapers on 7th February, 2026 on a PAN-India basis, it is hereby notified that the last date for submission of applications has been extended up to **20/04/2026 (17:30 hrs.)**

2. All other Terms & Conditions shall remain the same.

cbcc09101/11/0001/2627

Sd/-
Dy. Director (Administration)
CCRT, New Delhi

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Tapendra Bohra@Parvin Thapa S/o Ram Bahadur Bohra R/o D-5 Ground Floor Near Firdaus Masjid Shaheen Bagh Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 234/2025 U/s 137(2)332(C)/62/3(5) BNS PS: Shaheen Bagh, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Tapendra Bohra@Parvin Thapa** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Tapendra Bohra@Parvin Thapa** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Tapendra Bohra@Parvin Thapa** accused of **FIR No. 234/2025 U/s 137(2)332(C)/62/3(5) BNS PS: Shaheen Bagh, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.05.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Chhavi Bansal
DP/4478/SE/2026 JMFC-11, Room No. 09, Main Building Saket Court, New Delhi
(Court Matter)

NORTHERN RAILWAY

(E-Auction Notice)

Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/PS, Northern Railway, Delhi Division invites bids through e-Auction through IREPS (<https://irops.gov.in/>) for the allotment of under mention contracts at following Railway stations/locations:-

E-Catalogue No.	Date & Time of bidding	Railway Stations/Locations/Lots
Parking-12-2026	23.04.2026 at 11:00 Hrs	Delhi Sarai Rohilla (Cycle-Scooter), Delhi KishanGanj, Garhi Harsaru, Jakhhal (1 st Entry) = Total 04 Sites

Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen <https://irops.gov.in/>

All contractors who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfill following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids:

- Registration on IREPS for E-Auction Leasing module -Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module.
- Payment of One Time Registration Fee 3. Current Account in State Bank of India 4. Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account 5. Lien Marking of Funds 6. Updation of Turnover Details 7. Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender/E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query	Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi 110055. Email: pkg.delhidivision@gmail.com Tel: 011-23743084
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No. 23AC/393/E-Auction/PKG/2026 Dated: 07.04.2026 1156/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Limited

(A Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking)
(ISO 9001 : 2015 Certified)
1st Floor, Udyog Bhawan, Ring Road No. 1, Tefibandha, Raipur (C.G.) - 492005
CIN : U45203CT1981SG001853, PAN : AABCM628N, GST Reg. No. 22AABCM628N52ZY
Phone : 0771-6621000 Fax : 0771-2583794
Website : www.csidc.in, Email address: csidc.cs@nic.in, csidc_raipur@yahoo.com

NOTICE INVITING TENDER (2nd Call)

(Through e-Procurement Portal Only)

NIT No. 01/CSIDC/E.E./Division-III/2026-27 Raipur, Dated 07/04/2026

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation Ltd., Raipur (CSIDC), a Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking constituted under the Companies Act, engaged in Industrial Infrastructure Development & Other Related Activities in the State invites online tender in "Form-B" (Item Rate Basis) for the following work :-

NIT No.	Name of work	Registered Contractor in CGFWB or in appropriate class in other dep't.	Time Allowed (Including Rainy Season)	Probable Amount of Contract (PAC) (INR Lacs)	EMD (INR Lacs)	Cost of Tender Document (including GST 18%)
01	Construction of Flatted Factory Complex (Gr-04) at Furniture Production Unit of CSIDC at Village-Abhanpur, District-Raipur (C.G.)	Open to All	18 Months	2849.62	14.25	3,540/-

The tender document containing detailed terms & conditions, scope of works and other details can be downloaded from the web portal (website) <https://eproc.csidc.in> from **08/04/2026** Time 17:01 and shall be submitted online only. Amendment in tender, if any, will only be uploaded on the website and shall not be published in any newspaper.

NOTE: The interested tenderers for online submission of tender may contact CG e-Proc Helpdesk. Operated by Mjunction Services Limited, they may reach Helpdesk using 18004199140 (from 9 AM to 11 PM) (toll-free press 2 for CG e-Proc) or you can email them at Helpdesk.eproc@cgswa.gov.in samvad 47409/3

Executive Engineer (Division-III)
कार्यालय एवं दफ्तार हेतु स्थान उपलब्ध, वेबसाइट देखें www.csidc.in

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF ENGINEER (CIVIL) AU & PC, CSPGCL

Shed No. 2, Dangania, Raipur-492013 Phone No. 0771-2576320 & 0771-2576324, website : www.cspc.co.in E-mail: cecivlaupc@gmail.com

No.03-15/W/08 Raipur, date 06.04.2026

SHORT TERM E-TENDER NOTICE

Online bids are invited through CSPCL e-bidding system (SAP SRM) from eligible bidders fulfilling the eligibility criteria as mentioned below and having experience in Govt./Public Sector Undertaking/Local bodies/Power Generating Companies in India only for the following work :-

Sl. No.	Tender Specification No.	Description	NIT value i/c GST (Rs.)	EMD (Rs.)	Completion period (incl. Rainy season)	Rfx No.
1	CEC/AU&PC /HTPS-KW/ W/2025/143	Utilization of ash in eco friendly manner in abandoned quarry/minesand low laying area from ash dyke Jhabu/silo of 4x210 MW Extn. HTPS, CSPGCL, Korba West.	466.97 Lacs	4,67,000/-	02 Months	81000 50428
2	CEC/AU&PC /HTPS-KW/ W/2025/144	Ash utilization by disposal of ash in eco-friendly manner in low laying area (Govt./ Private land), abandoned mines/Quarries, and any others as required from ash dyke Jhabu / Silo at 4x210 MW HTPS CSPGCL, Korba West.	471.22 Lacs	4,71,300/-	02 Months	81000 50427

Cost of tender form is Rs. 1180/- (Rs.1000/- + 18% GST). The due date & time for submission of bids, Tender Cost & EMD is 20.04.2026 (up to 15:00 Hrs) and bid opening date (Techno commercial bids) is 22.04.2026 (up to 16:00) Hrs respectively. The tender document can be viewed and downloaded online from our e-bidding portal <https://ebidding.cspcl.co.in>: 50724/irj/portal.

Note:- (i) The L-1 bidder shall be decided on overall cost to company basis including GST.(ii) In case, the rate quoted by the bidder is on abnormally lower side, a performance guarantee @5% of contract value i/c GST in addition to Security Deposit shall have to be deposited by the bidder.(iii) Maintenance period for the work shall be 12 (Twelve) Months.(iv) Subletting of contract will not be allowed.

Chief Engineer (Civil) AU & PC, CSPGCL, Raipur
//Save Electricity// samvad 47421/2

UCL: Liverpool seek Champions League solace against holders PSG

Reds not riding good



Liverpool coach Arne Slot and Virgil Van Dijk during training AP

PARIS: Out of the Premier League title race. Routed in the FA Cup. Mounting questions over the manager's future. A star striker set to leave. A disgruntled captain saying his team gave up.

Liverpool head into the first leg of their Champions League quarterfinal against Paris Saint-Germain on Wednesday in disarray. A far cry from when the sides met in the last-16 last year.

Back then, Liverpool were romping to the Premier League title, new manager Arne Slot was the toast of the city and Mo Salah was at his brilliant best. By contrast PSG had struggled to get out of the Champions League group stage and observers were questioning coach Luis Enrique's methods.

PSG scraped through on penalties against Liverpool after an intense battle over two legs.

"Arne Slot has spoken about what an incredible match it was," PSG midfielder Vitinha said Tuesday at a pre-match news conference. "They didn't have a chance (in the first leg) apart from the goal they scored and (goalkeeper) Allison was

man of the match."

Knocking the six-time champions out — away at Anfield, no less — gave PSG the belief they could finally win the Champions League. By contrast, Liverpool's agonizing defeat marked the start of Salah's

4

Four of the last five defending champions have been eliminated in the quarterfinals

decline as Liverpool's aura took a hit.

Liverpool then began the current campaign poorly as Salah's goals dried up and he clashed with Slot.

PSG are closing in on another French title but Liverpool is fifth in the Premier

League, a hefty 21 points behind leader Arsenal. Following a crushing 4-0 defeat to Manchester City in the FA Cup quarterfinals on Saturday, captain Virgil van Dijk said his side "gave up" and he apologized to fans.

Slot called it a humbling loss. The Dutchman is reportedly clinging onto his job. Salah will be gone next season and, if PSG knocks out Liverpool, a trophy-less season may cost Slot his position.

But PSG is blocking out any talk about being the favorite this time.

"Favorite according to you (the media). The same way you said last year that Liverpool was," said Vitinha, who finished third in the Ballon d'Or standings in 2025. "Even if Liverpool are not in their best form they remain a great team with great players." Liverpool forward Hugo Ekitike returns to face his old side as a player transformed.

AGENCIES

Shooters Palak and Mukesh shatter WR to win gold

GRANADA: Indian shooters Palak and Mukesh Nelavalli shattered the world record on way to winning a gold medal in 10m air pistol mixed team competition at the ISSF World Cup for rifle and and pistol here on Tuesday.

The Indian duo aggregated 487.7 to clinch the top prize, which is also a junior world record.

The pair showcased strong form in the qualification round too, securing a spot in the medal match with a score of 581-17x. China's Qianxun Yao and Kai Hu bagged the silver medal with 484.8, while Hungary's Veronika Major and Akos Karoly Nagy settled for bronze with a combined total of 414.9 in the final.

AGENCIES

BKJC: India's fate hangs in balance

BANGKOK: Debutant Vaishnavi Adkar cracked under a barrage of unforced errors, slumping to a shock straight-set defeat against Aunchisa Chanta, as rain left India's opening Asia/Oceania Group I tie of the Billie Jean King Cup against Thailand hanging in the balance here on Tuesday.

With Sahaja Yamlapalli locked in a gritty second singles against Patcharin Cheapchandej, the hosts' fate remained uncertain when persistent rain forced play to halt.

anked 73 places above her Thai opponent at 383, Vaishnavi went down 1-6, 3-6 in one hour and 13 minutes on the DLTA Centre Court after more than three hours of delay due to drizzle and unusually cool conditions.

The onus then shifted to Sahaja (384), who was trailing 4-6, 6-1, 3-4 against world No. 449 Patcharin when the skies opened up again.

The match will now resume at 11am on Wednesday ahead of India's next fixture against New Zealand at 3pm. Sahaja fought hard and struck the ball cleanly but lacked variation, allowing Patcharin to dictate key



Vaishnavi Adkar returns a shot to Thailand's Aunchisa Chanta AP

exchanges, especially by targeting the Indian's backhand on serve. The Thai held her nerve better in crunch moments. Serving to stay in the opening set at 4-5, Sahaja faltered under pressure, committing a string of errors to hand Patcharin the lead.

The Indian responded strongly in the second set, breaking early and racing to a 5-1 lead before sealing it with a crisp backhand volley to restore parity.

However, Sahaja was broken early in the decider during a baseline-heavy contest. She squandered

three break-back chances at 0-40 in the sixth game before finally leveling at 3-3 with successive backhand winners. She had just dropped serve again when rain interrupted play.

Earlier, Vaishnavi endured a shaky start, dropping serve in the opening game amid a flurry of errors. She fought through a lengthy third game, saving three break points and extending it over seven deuces, but ultimately fell to a down-the-line backhand winner, putting her at a 0-3 deficit.

Aunchisa, a left-hander with a rare double-handed forehand and a penetrating backhand, dictated play from the baseline to race to a 4-0 lead. Vaishnavi briefly steadied to get on the board in the fifth game, but the momentum firmly remained with the Thai player. Under sustained pressure, Vaishnavi soon faced two set points and surrendered the opener in just 23 minutes, sending a forehand long before pushing a backhand wide. She began the second set on a brighter note with an early break, only to hand the advantage straight back with another loose service game.

AGENCIES

Moya brace powers Inter Kashi win

CHENNAI: A double strike from Alfred Moya in the second half ensured Inter Kashi FC beat Chennaiyin FC 2-1 to secure their second win in the Indian Super League 2025-26 here on Tuesday.

Inter Kashi moved to eighth place in the table with eight points from seven matches while Chennaiyin FC remained in 11th place with five points from six games. Alfred Moya was adjudged the Player of the Match.

Chennaiyin FC head coach Clifford Miranda made four changes to his starting XI, with Inigo Martin, D. Vignesh, Irfan Yadwad and Mohammed Ali Bemammer coming in to replace Elsinho, Mandar Rao Desai, Maheson Singh and Daniel Chima Chukwu.

Meanwhile, Inter Kashi head coach Antonio López Habas also made four changes, with Shubham Dhas preferred in goal over Luis Tarrés Campos, Narenred Gahlot replacing Sumet Passi, Ashish Jha coming in for Nauris Petkevicius, and Mohammed Asif starting ahead of Tomba Singh.

Both sides began cautiously, understanding each other's tactics in the early exchanges, but it was Chennaiyin who enjoyed the greater share of possession, with Bemammer and Alberto Noguera dictating play in midfield.

Inter Kashi, to their credit, were organised in defence, protecting the penalty area and denying Chennaiyin any clear openings, forcing the hosts to resort to long-range efforts that did not trouble Shubham in goal.

At the other end, Rohit Danu looked lively down the left flank for the visitors, delivering a couple of inviting crosses into the box, both of which were dealt with well by the Chennaiyin defence. Alfred Moya too tried his luck from distance just before the drinks break, but his effort curled wide of the post. Inter Kashi came closest to scoring in first-half added time from a set piece. Wayne Vaz got on the end of a corner, but his initial effort was blocked, and the follow-up was saved by Mohammad Nawaz.

AGENCIES

KIND ATTENTION RAIL PASSENGERS! IMPORTANT INFORMATION

RUN OF MORE SUMMER SPECIAL TRAINS-2026

In order to clear extra rush of passengers during the upcoming Summer Season, Railways have decided to run the following additional Summer Special Trains as per details given below:

05101/05102 Gorakhpur-New Delhi-Gorakhpur Special (Weekly)				26 Trips
Train No. 05101	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 05102
---	16:00	---	Gorakhpur	01:00
04:20	04:30	---	Moradabad	12:50
07:30	---	---	New Delhi	09:45

Days of run : 05101 Ex. Gorakhpur from 11.04.2026 to 11.07.2026 (Saturday) Except 23.05.2026 and 05102 Ex. New Delhi from 12.04.2026 to 12.07.2026 (Sunday) Except 24.05.2026.

Composition: 3 Tier AC Economy, Sleeper & General

Stoppages: Anand Nagar, Siddharth Nagar, Barhni, Tulsiapur, Balrampur, Gonda Jn., Sitapur, Shahjahanpur, Bareilly & Ghaziabad Stations.

05193/05194 Chhapra-Pathankot-Chhapra Special (Weekly)				30 Trips
Train No. 05193	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 05194
---	14:00	---	Chhapra	09:15
22:15	---	---	Pathankot	00:30

Days of run : 05193 Ex. Chhapra from 06.04.2026 to 13.07.2026 (Monday) and 05194 Ex. Pathankot from 08.04.2026 to 15.07.2026 (Wednesday).

Composition: 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, 3rd AC Economy, Sleeper & General

Stoppages: Chhapra Kacheri, Dighwa Dubauli, Thawe Jn., Tamkuhi Road, Padrauna, Kaptanganj Jn., Gorakhpur, Basti, Gonda Jn., Sitapur, Shahjahanpur, Bareilly, Moradabad, Laksar Jn., Roorkee, Saharanpur, Yamunanagar Jagadhri, Ambala Cantt., Ludhiana & Jalandhar Cantt. Stations.

07621/07622 Nanded-Hazrat Nizamuddin-Nanded Special (Weekly)				16 Trips
Train No. 07621	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 07622
---	08:45	---	Nanded	00:35
14:00	---	---	Hazrat Nizamuddin	21:40

Days of run : 07621 Ex. Nanded from 11.04.2026 to 30.05.2026 (Saturday) and 07622 Ex. Hazrat Nizamuddin from 12.04.2026 to 31.05.2026 (Sunday)

Composition: 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General

Stoppages: Purna Jn., Parbhani Jn., Selu, Partur, Jalna, Aurangabad, Manmad, Jalgaon, Bhusawal, Khandwa, Itarsi, Bhopal, Bina, Virangana Laxmibai Jhansi, Gwalior, Agra Cantt. & Mathura Jn. Stations.

05017/05018 Mau Jn.-Valsad-Mau Jn. Special (Weekly)				10 Trips
Train No. 05017	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 05018
---	06:00	---	Mau Jn.	22:45
08:20	08:30	---	Varanasi Jn.	20:30
12:35	---	---	Valsad	15:10

Days of run : 05017 Ex. Mau Jn. from 11.04.2026 to 09.05.2026 (Saturday) and 05018 Ex. Valsad from 12.04.2026 to 10.05.2026 (Sunday)

Composition: 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General

Stoppages: Aunrihar Jn., Gyanpur Road, Prayagraj Jn., Kanpur Central, Tundla Jn., Idgah Agra Jn., Bayana Jn., Gangapur City, Kota Jn., Ramganj Mandi, Bhawani Mandi, Nagda Jn., Ratlam Jn., Vadodara Jn. & Surat Stations.

04624/04623 Amritsar-Kolkata-Amritsar Reserved Special Express (Weekly)				24 Trips
Train No. 04624	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 04623
---	20:10	---	Amritsar	00:40
15:00	---	---	Kolkata	05:00

Days of run : 04624 Ex. Amritsar from 13.04.2026 to 29.06.2026 (Monday) and 04623 Ex. Kolkata from 16.04.2026 to 02.07.2026 (Thursday).

Composition: 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General

Stoppages: Beas, Jalandhar City, Phagwara Jn., Dhandari Kalan, Ambala Cantt., YamunanagarJagadhri, Saharanpur, Moradabad, Bareilly, Shahjahanpur, Sitapur, Gonda Jn., Gorakhpur, Kaptanganj, Narkatiaganj, Bettiah, Sagauli Jn., Bapudham Mothari, Muzaffarpur Jn., Samastipur Jn., Barauni Jn., Kiul Jn., Jhajha, Jasidih Jn., Madhupur Jn., Chittaranjan, Asansol Jn., Durgapur, Bardhaman, Bandel Jn. & Naihati Jn. Stations.

01073/01074 Lokmanya Tilak(T)-Banaras-Lokmanya Tilak(T) Special (Bi-Weekly)				42 Trips
Train No. 01073	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 01074
---	12:15	---	Lokmanya Tilak(T)	16:40
22:45	22:50	---	Varanasi	05:45
23:30	---	---	Banaras	05:30

Days of run : 01073 Ex. Lokmanya Tilak(T) from 06.05.2026 to 15.07.2026 (Wednesday, Thursday) and 01074 Ex. Banaras from 08.05.2026 to 17.07.2026 (Friday, Saturday).

Composition: 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General

Stoppages: Thane, Kalyan, Igatpuri, Nashik Road, Jalgaon Jn., Bhusawal Jn., Khandwa, Itarsi, Rani Kamalapati, Bina, Rani Laxmibai Jhansi, Orai, Govindpur, Fatehpur & Subedarganj Stations.

01431/01432 Pune-Ghazipur City-Hadapsar Special (Bi-Weekly)				44 Trips
Train No. 01431	ARR.	DEP.	STATIONS	Train No. 01432
---	06:40	---	Pune	---
---	---	---	Hadapsar	16:20
15:30	15:40	---	Varanasi	08:20
19:05	---	---	Ghazipur City	04:20

Days of run : 01431 Ex. Pune from 01.05.2026 to 14.07.2026 (Friday, Tuesday) and 01432 Ex. Ghazipur City from 03.05.2026 to 16.07.2026 (Sunday, Thursday).

Composition: 2 Tier AC, 3 Tier AC, Sleeper & General

Stoppages: Daund Chord Line, Ahilyanagar, Kopargaon, Manmad Jn., Jalgaon Jn., Bhusawal Jn., Khandwa, Itarsi Jn., Pipariya, Narsinghpur, Madan Mahal, Katni, Maihar, Satna, Manikpur, Prayagraj Cheoki, Jaunpur Jn. & Aunrihar Jn. Stations

For any kind of information and detailed time-table etc., passengers are requested to contact RailMadad Helpline No. 139 or may visit Indian Railways website <https://enquiry.indianrail.gov.in> or NTES App.

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NORTHERN RAILWAY

Your Convenience-Our Concern

Visit us at: www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

1159/2026



CENTRAL SANSKRIT UNIVERSITY
56-57, Institutional Area, Janakpuri, New Delhi-110058
Website: www.sanskrit.nic.in



Notification No.-CSU/36014/Advt./2026-27/S-1
Date:- 01.04.2026

ONLINE APPLICATIONS ARE INVITED FOR FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE FOR THE YEAR 2026-27 UNDER "SCHEMES FOR SANSKRIT PROMOTION "

Central Sanskrit University, Delhi is the nodal agency for implementing Central Schemes of Ministry of Education, Government of India for the Promotion of Sanskrit Language. Accordingly, applications are invited from interested NGOs/Voluntary Organizations/Universities/Institutions/Publishers/Individuals/Students, through online as applicable under the following **Schemes for Sanskrit Promotion:**

Sl. No.	Name of the Scheme
1	Sanskrit Teaching – Engagement of Sanskrit or Modern Subject Teachers for teaching in Traditional Sanskrit Pathshalas/Mahavidyalayas/Government Schools/Guru-Sishya Parampara Institutions and Residential Scholarships.
2	Samman Rashi - Annual grant to Eminent Sanskrit Pandits living in Indigent Circumstances.
3	Publication, Bulk Purchase and Re-print of Rare Sanskrit Books
4	Shastra Chudamani - for utilization of Services of Eminent Shastric Scholars or Retired Sanskrit Scholars.
5	Programmes & Activities for Promotion of Sanskrit.
6	Vocational Training - Conduct of Vocational Training in Registered Traditional Sanskrit Institutions.
7	Ashtaadashi – Eighteen Projects for sustaining the Growth of Sanskrit.
8	Scholarships - Award of Scholarships to the students regularly studying Sanskrit/Pali/Prakrit languages from 9 th class to Ph.D level in Traditional/Modern Stream.

Online Registration Starting date – 01.04.2026
Online Registration Closing date – 30.06.2026 and for Scholarship scheme closing date will be 31.08.2026
Note:- However, Portal will be open in the entire year for application.

i) Before filling the application form, it is advised that the scheme guidelines be referred of each scheme, remuneration, required documents, how to apply in online and application forwarding process etc., please visit the Central Sanskrit University's website www.sanskrit.nic.in/schemes.

ii) In each scheme, automatic renewal shall not be considered. Hence, it is mandatory for all grantee institutions of previous years to apply afresh for each scheme, as per schematic norms.

iii) Further, consideration or rejection of the application for financial assistance will depend upon the availability of funds and approval of the GIAC etc., as per schematic norms. Therefore, it is mandatory to apply every year on scheme-to-scheme basis separately for financial assistance.

Sd/-
Registrar I/c

cbc21212/12/0001/2627

**OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER,
MINOR IRRIGATION DIVISION, HAZARIBAG.**
e-Procurement Tender Notice
Two Envelope System

Tender Reference No. :- DMFT/MID/HAZARIBAG/F2-01/2026-27
Letter no - 274 Date :- 07.04.2026

1.	Name of the work	Development of Basic Structure, Renovation and Miscellaneous Work in +2 High School Digwar, Block-Daru, Dist-Hazaribag.
2.	Estimated Cost (Rs.)	Rs.- 1,39,36,650.00
3.	Time of Completion	11 Months
4.	Date of Publication of e-Tender on website	22.04.2026 at 1:00 P.M (e-Procurement Portal- http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
5.	Last date/Time for Submission of e-Tender bids Online	30.04.2026 up to 5:00 P.M
6.	Last Date for Online Submission of Tender Fee and EMD	30.04.2026 up to 5:00 P.M
7.	Date of opening of e-Tender	02.05.2026 at 03:00 P.M
8.	Name & address of office Inviting tender	Executive Engineer, Minor Irrigation Division, Hazaribag
9.	Contact no. of e-Procurement officer	06546-270485
10.	E-mail of e-Procurement officer	ceemidhbg-cemr-jhr@nic.in

Notes: 1.) Only e-Tender will be accepted.
2.) Published Estimated Cost may be increased or decreased.
3.) Further details can be seen and Mode of Submission of Online Tender/Tender Fee/EMD through <http://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>

Executive Engineer,
Minor Irrigation Division,
Hazaribag.

PR 376834 (Minor Irrigation) 26-27 (D)

**GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB**
GREATER MOHALI AREA DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
PUDA Bhawan, Sector 62, SAS Nagar, Punjab
Tender Notice No. 665-671 dated 07-04-2026

Divisional Engineer (H-1), GMADA invites online bids for the work of “ **Request For Proposal for panenlment of Consultant firms for designing of horticulture and landscaping works of parks, green belts and roads in SAS Nagar (Mohali)."**

Closing date & time: **24-04-2026 at 12:00 Noon**

For details log on to: <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>

Note: Any corrigendum(s) to the tender notice shall be published on the above website only.

RO No PR-Advt. No :- 1324/12/2026-27/10262

**NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY**

Tender Notice No. 74-W-SP-26-27-01 Dated : 03.04.2026

E-Tender Notice

Dy. Chief Engineer/Concrete Sleeper Plant, North Central Railway/Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite e-TENDERS for the following works up to 15.00 hrs. of the due date of tender opening. The details of the Tenders are as under:-

Tender No. : 74-W-SP-26-27-01 | Approx. Cost of work (In Rs. Lakh) : 202.03

Name of Work : Supply of Coarse Aggregate 20 mm & 10 mm nominal size of granite stone and Fine aggregate (Coarse River sand) to Concrete Sleeper Plant, Subedarganj, Prayagraj.

Earnest Money (Rs.) : 404100.00	Completion Period : 06 Month
---------------------------------	------------------------------

Date of Opening of tender : 27.04.26

Similar work : Supply of machine crushed stone ballast/machine crushed coarse stone aggregate.

Note : 1. The complete information along with tender document of above E-Tender will be uploaded and shall be available up to 15:00 hrs. on the due date of tender opening on Website www.irops.gov.in 2. Bids other than in the form of E-Bids shall not be accepted against above tenders. For this purpose, vendors are required to get themselves registered with IREPS website along with Digital Signature Certificate issued by CCA under IT Act-2000. 3. Rates entered into Financial Rate page and duly signed digitally shall be considered. Rates and any other financial entity in any other form/letter head if attached by vendors shall be straightaway ignored and shall not be considered. 4. Document being attached should be signed by the tenderer on its body. Tenderers are required to submit **Annexure-V** online on IREPS Module. 5. For detailed information, please refer the tender document uploaded on website www.irops.gov.in 6. Payment of Earnest Money Deposit/Bid Security in respect of e-tendering shall be accepted through net banking or e-payment gateway only. 7. In case of any difficulty/helpdesk on the website of IREPS may be approached. 8. Tender can be submitted online up to 15:00 hrs on the due date of tender opening and will be opened after 15:00 hours. 9. Suppliers of Goods and/or services would be subject to GST Act, and Rules as applicable from time to time. 10. The Railway reserves the right to amend/postpone/cancel any tender/s without assigning any reason thereof. 11. Tenderer should watch the website for the corrigendum/addendum to the NIT/Tender document, if any that may be uploaded prior to tender opening (inclusive) as there will not be any separate communication for that. 745/26 (C)

North central railways  www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in  @CPRONCR

NORTHERN RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE

The Chief Project Manager, HTS & Construction, Northern Railway, Kashmere Gate, Delhi-06, for and on behalf of the President of India invites Open e-tender under Two Packet System of the under noted work :

1	Full Name of work	Up-gradation/Development of Maintenance Infrastructure at Bijwasan (BWSN) as Maintenance cum Workshop Depot for Vande Bharat Sleeper Trains including all provisions as per contract condition of WTA-S27 for the provisions of M&P, simulators & training facility etc.
2	Approx. Cost of work:	Rs. 208,27,97,625/-
3	Completion period of the work	30 (Thirty) months
4	Earnest Money to be deposited	Rs. 4,16,56,000/-
5	Site/availability of tender document on railway website	Tender documents will be available on IREPS web site i.e. www.irops.gov.in from 02/04/2026 to 20/06/2026 upto 15:00 hrs.
6	Pre-Bid Conference -I	28/04/2026 at 11:00 hrs at CAO/C Office, N. Rly., Kashmere Gate, Delhi and through online VC Link.
7	Pre-Bid Conference -II	19/05/2026 at 11:00 hrs at CAO/C Office, N. Rly., Kashmere Gate, Delhi and through online VC Link.
8	Last date of receipt of pre-bid queries	28/04/2026 upto 18:00 hrs.
9	Authority response to queries	Pre-Bid Conference -I 08/05/2026 up to 18:00 hrs. Pre-Bid Conference -II 29/05/2026 up to 18:00 hrs.
10	Last date/Time of upload of tenders	30/06/2026 up to 15:00 hrs. Tender Documents can be uploaded by the tenderer on IREPS website i.e. www.irops.gov.in w.e.f. 16/06/2026 to 30/06/2026.
11	Date and time of opening of tender	06/07/2026 at 15:00 hrs. The detailed tender notice can also be seen on the notice board of the above office.

Tender Notice no. 74-W-4-1-484-WA-RS-INF Dated:-02/04/26 1137/26

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

GOVERNMENT OF MAHARASHTRA
EXECUTIVE ENGINEER, PUBLIC WORKS DIVISION, ASHTI
E-TENDER NOTICE ASHTI/ 01 OF 2026-27

E-Tenders for (20) Works in B-1/B-2 form is invited by the Executive Engineer, Public Works Division Ashti from the registered Contractors in appropriate class of Public Works Department of Govt. of Maharashtra for the roads/repair of roads/repair of buildings/construction of new buildings in Tal. Ashti/Patoda/Shirur Dist. Beed. Right is reserved to reject any or all tenders without any reason thereof.

The details can be viewed and downloaded from following website.
www.mahapwd.com
<https://maharashtra.etenders.in>

Executive Engineer
Public Works Division, Ashti
Dgipr/2026-27/97

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Vineet Kumar
Civil Judge (Junior Division), Jhajjar
Andhra Bank
Vs.
Sandeep

THAT PASS A DECREE IN FAVOUR OF THE PLAINTIFF AND AGAINST THE DEFENDANTS
CNR NO. HRJR02-001021-2019
NEXT DATE:- 29-05-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO: Sandeep

Father:- :Suresh Kumar
Sakuntala w/o Suresh Kumar
Vill Dubaldhan Kirman Tehsil Beri Distt Jhajjar

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 29-05-2026 at 10:00 a.m. For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district> Notice&district=Jhajjar

Sd/-Sh. Vineet Kumar
Civil Judge (Junior Division)
date 03.04.2026 Jhajjar

IN THE COURT OF MS. NIRJA BHATIA, LD. DISTRICT JUDGE (COMMERCIAL COURT-07), SOUTH-EAST DISTRICT ROOM NO.30, NEW BLOCK-02, SAKET COURTS, NEW DELHI.
PROCLAMATION REQUIRING ATTENDANCE OF DEFENDANT
(Order 5, Rule 20 of the Code of Civil Procedure)
SUTT NO: CS/COMM/655/2025
Contrans Cargo Pvt. Ltd.
V/S
Indo Office Solutions Pvt. Ltd.

To,
Indo Office Solutions Pvt. Ltd. Unit no. 407, Part H World Trade Centre Barakamba Lane, Connaught Place Central Delhi, New Delhi-110001

WHEREAS you are intentionally evading service of summons it is hereby notified that if you shall not defend the case on the 13.04.2026 the day fixed for the final disposal, it will be heard and determined ex parte. Given under my hand and the seal of the Court, this 02.04.2026.

DISTRICT JUDGE (COMMERCIAL COURT-07), SOUTH-EAST DISTRICT ROOM NO.30, NEW BLOCK-02, SAKET COURTS,

**EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY**
E-TENDER NOTICE

E-Tender Notice No.- TM/Works/Chord Transducer/2026, Date: 02.04.2026.

Online (through e-tendering) Tender for the following work is invited by Dy. Chief Engineer (Track Machine), Plant Depot, East Central Railway, DDU for and on behalf of the President of India, from reputed Firms.

E-Tender Closing Date : 23.04.2026.

1. Name of the work with its Location : TM_Chord_Transducer_2026- Repairing of Roller Chord Transducers (Part No. ELT-903.00001-U/1000)-03 Nos.: Roller Chord Transducers (Part No. ELT-906.00001-U/1000)-04 Nos.: Proportional Transducer (Part No. ELT-904.00005LU-U/170)-01 Nos.: ALC CPU-02 Nos. of machine UNI-8430 & DUO-8123 and Pendulums (Part No.-ELT-12111.00B)-02 Nos. Tender Cost - Nil.

2. Approx. Cost of the work : ₹35,63,475.39.

3. Earnest money : ₹71,300.00, 4. Date and time for submission of e-tender : 23.04.2026 up to 16:00 hrs. 5. Website particulars of e-tendering : www.irops.gov.in.

Dy. Chief Engineer/TMC/PD/
ECRP/T, Deen Dayal Upadhyaya
PR/0024/DDU/Engg./T/26-27/36

**millenniumpost**
CLASSIFIEDS
CHANGE OF NAME

I, ANKITA AWASTHI
W/O ASHISH KALIA R/O D-603, 6th Floor, Tower-D, Civitech Stadia, Sector-79, Noida, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh: 201301 have changed the name of my minor son namely ATTHARVA KALIA age 05 years and he shall hereafter be known as KARTIK KALIA.

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Sh. Vineet Kumar
Civil Judge (Junior Division), Jhajjar
CANARA BANK through Mohan Singh
Vs.
Dolip Singh S/o Mahender Singh
CNR NO. HRJR02-001614-2023
NEXT DATE:- 06-05-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO: Mahabir Singh S/o Ghasi Ram :-

Ward No. 2 behind Indane Gas Godam, Beri gate Jhajjar near Village Gudha(Jhajjar)

In above titled case, the defendant(s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 06-05-2026 at 10:00 a.m. For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district> Notice&district=Jhajjar

Sd/-Sh. Vineet Kumar
Civil Judge (Junior Division)
date 03.04.2026 Jhajjar

COURT NOTICE
(U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC)
IN THE COURT OF
Ms. Anuradha
Civil Judge (Senior Division), Hisar
Canara Bank
Vs.
Suresh Kumar
Suit for recovery of Rs. 1616235/- (Rs. 1589459/- in CC Limit plus Rs. 26776/- in FITL) and future interest at 16.25 percent n CC Limit and 11.95 percent n FITL per annum with monthly rest from 01.02.2024 till realization with cost and other expenses.
CNR NO. HRHS02-000354-2024
Next Date:-28-04-2026
PUBLICATION ISSUED TO: Suresh Kumar
Son :-Sadana
House no.512/13, Mohalla Kasaban, Gوبindgarh Bazar, Hisar Being Prop. Of M/S Dimple Food Products, Gobindgarh Bazar, Hisar

In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on 28-04-2026 at 10:00 am. For details logon to <https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district> Notice&district=Hisar

Sd/- Ms. Anuradha
Civil Judge (Senior Division), Hisar,
Dated 30-03-2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Namely **Anil Dahiya@Bhalu S/o Ram Kishan R/o 325 Gali No. 10A, Swatantra Nagar Narela, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 923/2014 U/s 420/120B IPC PS: K.N. Katju Marg, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Anil Dahiya@Bhalu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Anil Dahiya@Bhalu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Anil Dahiya@Bhalu** accused of **FIR No. 923/2014 U/s 420/120B IPC PS: K.N. Katju Marg, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **28.07.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Himanshu Sehloth
JMFC-03, Room No. 213
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/4494/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Danish S/o Md. Koshar R/o F-197, Gali No. - 05, Maujpur, Jagrabad, Delhi** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.429/2020 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Danish** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Danish** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Danish** of case **FIR No.429/2020 U/s 33 Delhi Excise Act, P.S. Welcome, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **19.05.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Court No. 19, Shahdara
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/4096/NE/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Deepak Nain S/o Shobh Ram R/o Village Rolad Latifpur, 147, Rolad Latifpur, Sonipat-131001 also at Megamentis Infotech Pvt. Ltd., 25 M C Market, First Floor, Subhash Chowk, Sonipat 131001** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC No. 5802/2017 U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Moti Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Deepak Nain** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Deepak Nain** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Deepak Nain** of **CC No. 5802/2017 U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Moti Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.05.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Poonam Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class (West), NI Act-04
Room No. 04, Annexe-1
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/4513/WD/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Pratibha Bhardwaj W/o Brijesh Kumar Bhardwaj R/o Flat No. 18, F-451, Durga Vihar, New Delhi-110062** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **Case Regd. No. 193/2021 U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Keshav Puram, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Pratibha Bhardwaj** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Pratibha Bhardwaj** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Pratibha Bhardwaj** of **Case Regd. No. 193/2021 U/s 138 NI Act, P.S. Keshav Puram, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **11.05.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Aakanksha
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
North West, Court No. 107, 1st Floor
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/4240/NW/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED
See Section 82 Cr. P.C. / 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Nakul Sangwan @ Deepak S/o Rohtash Kumar R/o H. No. 3, Gali No. 2, East Krishna Vihar, Najafgarh, Delhi and Permanent Address: VPO Sarohi Bahali, P.S. Nangal Chaudhari, Distt. Mahendergarh, Haryana** has Committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **SC No. 135/2022 & FIR No. 409/2021 U/s 25/27 Arms Act & 302/34 IPC, P.S. Chhawla, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Nakul Sangwan @ Deepak** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Nakul Sangwan @ Deepak** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Nakul Sangwan @ Deepak** of case **SC No. 135/2022 & FIR No. 409/2021 U/s 25/27 Arms Act & 302/34 IPC, P.S. Chhawla, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.05.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Ravinder Singh
Additional Session Judge-05
South West, Court No. 511, 5th Floor
Dwarka Courts, Delhi

DP/3888/DW/2026 (Court Matter)

**ICICI Bank**
Branch Office: ICICI Bank Ltd., BP-4, Technopolis Building, 4th Floor, Sector V, Salt Lake City, Kolkata West Bengal- 700091
CIN No: L65190GJ1994PLC021012. www.icicibank.com

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice.

Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken symbolic possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Symbolic Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Rohit Sharma/ Satish Kumar Sharma/38A, A Block, Kiron Garden, Uttam Nagar, Gali No. 12, South West Delhi, Near Hanuman Mandir, West Delhi Delhi - 110059/ TBCAL00006837243	Dharitri Titanium", Flat No K2, 3rd Floor, Block 1st, Holding No. 17, Methopara Road, C.S. Dag No. 1266, Khatian No. 903, R.S. And L.R. Dag No. 1268, Khatian No. 904, R.S. /L.R. Dag No. 1262, 1263 And 1265, R.S./L.R. Khatian No. 25, J.L. No. 45, RE. SA. No. 132 And 139, Touzi No. 146, Mouza Doharia, Village Methopara, P.S. Borasat, Madhyamgram Municipality, A.D.S.R. Borasat, District North 24 Parganas, West Bengal (Admeasuring An Area of 891 Sq. Ft. Super Built Up Area More or Less With Garage Along With All The Proportionate Undivided Invisible Share In The Land Comprised In The Plinth of The Flat North:20 Feet Wide Municipal Road South: R.S. Dag No. 1261 East: Part of R.S. Dag Nos. 1264, 1265, 1266 And 1267. West: Part of R.S. Dag Nos. 1269, 1270, 1271 And 1262. / Date of Symbolic 04/04/2026	November 24, 2025 Rs. 35,23,095.00/-	Delhi/ Kolkata/ Mumbai

The above-mentioned borrower(s)/guarantor(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: April 08, 2026
Place: Delhi

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

NORTHERN RAILWAY
E-TENDER NOTICE No. ELS-SRE-25-26-T-15 dtd. 06.04.2026

Open tender through E-tendering are invited by Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/ TRS, Electric Loco Shed, Khanalampura Yard, Northern Railway, Saharanpur (Ambala Division) for and on behalf of the President of India from the registered tenderer on website www.irops.gov.in for the following work upto 11:00 hrs. on the date of closing shown against the work and will be opened thereafter:-

Open Tender No. : ELS-SRE-25-26-T-15

Name of work : Comprehensive repair/renewal of E-70 brake system in 3-phase electric locos.

Date of Closing/Opening : 29.04.2026

Approx. Cost : Rs. 2,38,62,343.49

Earnest Money : Rs. 4,77,300/-

Completion period : Eighteen (18) Months

Validity period : 60 days

Cost of tender form : 'Free of cost' for downloading from IREPS & Rs. 10,000/- for obtaining from Sr.DEE/TRS/SRE office.

1. Tenderer(s) should have Class-III Digital Signature Certificate to participate in E-Tendering of Works Tenders. 2. Tenderer are required to upload self-attested scanned copies of all related eligibility documents as per conditions. 3. Taxes & Charges will be applicable as per extant rule. 4. For details, please log on IREPS website www.irops.gov.in 1141/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 82 CrPC / 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Raj Kishor S/o Shiv Shankar, R/o: D-1/181, Sultanpuri, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 398/25, U/S 318(4)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, PS South Rohini, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Raj Kishor** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Raj Kishor** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Raj Kishor** the said accused of **FIR No. 398/25, U/S 318(4)/3(5) Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023, PS South Rohini, Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **14.05.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Gaurav Katariya
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07,
North-West Distt., Court No.-208,
2nd Floor, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/4500/RD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person, namely, **Uruakpa Ahmed @ Baba Don, S/o: Uruakpa, R/o: H. No. 25, Oldoi Suruloei, Lagos, Nigeria and Presently Residing at H.No. C-1, Plot No. RZI-19-20. Mahavir Enclave, Old Shom Bazar Road, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.: 45/15, U/s: 20/22/29/61/85 NDPS ACT**, registered at **P.S.: SPL, CELL, DELHI**, and the warrant has been returned writing upon that the said accused person, **Uruakpa Ahmed @ Baba Don**, cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person, **Uruakpa Ahmed @ Baba Don**, has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said, accused person, **Uruakpa Ahmed @ Baba Don, FIR No.: 45/15, U/s: 20/22/29/61/85 NDPS ACT**, registered at **P.S.: SPL, CELL, DELHI**, is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **20.05.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Jitendra Pratap Singh, LD
Special Judge, NDPS,
P. Building, Room No. 35
Patiala House Court, New Delhi

DP/4473/Spl Cell/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Munesh S/o Shimbudayal R/o N 82/81, Cigarette Wala Bagh, Model Town, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 293/2023, U/S 33/38 Delhi Excise Act, PS Model Town, North-West Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Munesh** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Munesh** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Munesh** the said accused of **FIR No. 293/2023, U/S 33/38 Delhi Excise Act, PS Model Town, North-West Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **12.05.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Himanshu Sehloth
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03,
North Distt., Court No.-213,
Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/4403/NW/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON
See Section 84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person **Maya Devi W/o Raj Kumar R/o: D-2, Gali No.-5, Rajiv Nagar, JJ Colony, Bhalswa Dairy, Delhi. Also at: Jhuggi No. A-48, A-Block near Durga Mandir, Shahabad Dairy, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **E-FIR No. 0856/19, U/S 411 IPC, PS Shalimar Bagh, North-West Distt., Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Maya Devi** cannot be found, and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Maya Devi** has absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant);

Proclamation is hereby made that **Maya Devi** the said accused of **E-FIR No. 0856/19, U/S 411 IPC, PS Shalimar Bagh, North-West Distt., Delhi**, is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **12.05.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Gaurav Katariya
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07,
North-West Distt., Room No.-208,



ZENDAYA SAYS 'EUPHORIA' COULD END WITH SEASON THREE

'That closure is coming,' says the Hollywood actress

Zendaya hinted that the upcoming third season of the HBO drama series 'Euphoria' could be its last, describing the show as one that 'cracked my heart open'.

Appearing on "The Drew Barrymore Show" ahead of the season three premiere, Zendaya said she believed the new season would bring closure to the series.

"That closure is coming," she told host Drew Barrymore, adding that her character Rue 'taught me so much about life... about empathy and about redemption'.

"I owe so much to that show," Zendaya said.

The eight-episode third season premieres on Sunday on HBO and Max after a four-year gap.

Creator Sam Levinson used the hiatus to reimagine the show's setting, moving the ensemble cast out of high school and into young adulthood, with the story picking up five years later.

Zendaya's Rue is now reportedly on the run from drug lords



In the third season, Zendaya's character Rue is now reportedly on the run from drug lords in Mexico

The returning cast includes Sydney Sweeney, Jacob Elordi, Maude Apatow, Hunter Schafer,

Alexa Demie, Eric Dane, Chloe Cherry, Dominic Fike, Nika King and Colman Domingo. New additions this season are Sharon Stone, Danielle Deadwyler, Natasha Lyonne, Eli Roth, singer Rosalia, NFL star Marshawn Lynch, Sam Trammell and Asante Blackk.

The new season will also mark the first episodes since the death of Angus Cloud, who played fan-favourite character Fezco and passed away in July 2023.

Andy Serkis to return as butler Alfred in DC's 'The Batman II'

Actor-filmmaker Andy Serkis is all set to return as Alfred Pennyworth, the butler and mentor to Robert Pattinson's Bruce Wayne/Batman in Matt Reeves follow-up to the 2022 hit.

Pattinson is also returning as the Caped Crusader and Colin Farrell will play The Penguin in the drama that will feature Sebastian Stan as Harvey Dent and Scarlett Johansson in an undisclosed part, reported 'Deadline'. The production of the movie will start in June.

Serkis, known for his roles in the 'Lord of the Rings' franchise, 'Black Panther' and many others, confirmed his return to the 'Batman' franchise while promoting his latest animated film 'Animal Farm'.

"I'm pretty certain it's all going to work out. Yeah, we're working on it, but I think it's all looking good," he told 'Collider' when asked about 'The Batman II'.

He further assured that Animal Farm's release and his work on the 'Lord of the Rings: The Hunt for Gollum' will not hinder his role as Alfred.

Reeves' version of Gotham and its guardian has been widely praised for its different approach to the DC franchise. "The Batman" has also led to the making of HBO



Actor Robert Pattinson is also returning as the Caped Crusader

Max' series 'The Penguin', which won nine Emmys, including one for Cristin Milioti.

Serkis is also reprising his most famous role in the 'Lord of the Rings: The Hunt for Gollum', which is set to release on December 17, 2027.

'Dangal' screenwriter Nikhil Mehrotra to make directorial debut

'Taiyyari' stars Rajshri Deshpande and Chandan Roy Sanyal

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Does the name Nikhil Mehrotra ring a bell? Well, it might not. But what if we tell you that he wrote films like 'Dangal', 'Chhichhore' and 'Gunjan Saxena: The Kargil Girl'? Known for writing heartwarming stories, Nikhil is all set to make his debut as a director.

Titled 'Taiyyari', the film explores the tender, unspoken layers of family, love and emotional readiness, promising a sensitive and deeply resonant portrayal of human relationships. Starring Rajshri Deshpande, known for her remarkable performances in 'Trial by Fire' and 'Sacred Games' and Chandan Roy Sanyal, the film is a slice-of-life narrative.

Talking about the film, Nikhil said, "With 'Taiyyari', I wanted to explore the emotional rhythm of family life, its silences, conflicts and moments of grace. It's not a loud story, but it's a deeply felt one."

For Rajshri, it's the script that compelled her to say yes to the film. "The script moved me. It's a beautiful story about relationships that find power in silence, in love that doesn't need to be spoken aloud," she said.

"Kaminey" actor Chandan doesn't want to give away the plot. However, he can't stop talking about his character in the film. "My character Sid is flawed, vulnerable and driven by passion, yet deeply rooted in his love for his daughter. What I found compelling is that he doesn't fit the conventional idea of a



'perfect' parent, but his emotional honesty and presence make him incredibly real and relatable," he said.

Meanwhile, the casting for other key characters will be announced soon, with the film also set to run across international film festivals. Produced by 'Mud and Joy Films' and 'One Media Entertainment' and co-produced by Jayanta Gupta and Kavya Gupta, the film is currently under production.

'We are a little anchorless'

Seth Rogen, the co-creator and lead actor of popular drama 'The Studio', said the shock of losing actor Catherine O'Hara permeates throughout the new season.

O'Hara, known for her roles in 'Home Alone', 'Beetlejuice', 'Schitt's Creek' and many other Hollywood hits, died in January at the age of 71.

'Lionsgate Television' and Apple TV's production received numerous awards for its behind-the-scenes portrayal of how big studios operate in Hollywood.

In an interview with 'The Times', Rogen said O'Hara's death made them anchorless.

"It has been an unbelievable challenge, obviously emo-



Seth Rogen opened up about shooting 'The Studio 2' without Catherine O'Hara

tionally, dealing with the loss, but also when it comes to the show itself. We wrote it for her to be there. We had it all set and the shock waves permeated throughout the entire new season. It's been difficult. You worded it better than we could -

she was the anchor and now the anchor is gone," he said.

Rogen added, "If anything, we're acknowledging the idea that we are a little anchorless. But honestly, that is a part of life and what we all experience. And so, while we try not to dwell too much on heavy themes in this show, they will be there in this second season. We are not ignoring it."

Rogen and Evan Goldberg's 'The Studio' portrays O'Hara as the eccentric former head of 'Continental Studios' and Matt Remick's (Rogen) mentor, Patty Leigh, as she deals with the fallout of being fired while still trying to maintain her influence on Hollywood.

AKSHAY KUMAR ON HIS REUNION WITH TABU

Kumar went down memory lane and said he and Tabu have known each other for over 39 years



'Bhooth Bangla' was right film for both of us'

His last collaboration with her was Priyadarshan's cult film 'Hera Pheri'

Superstar Akshay Kumar said his upcoming film 'Bhooth Bangla' is the right film for him to reunite with his actress friend Tabu after 25 years. His last collaboration with her was Priyadarshan's cult film 'Hera Pheri', which was released in 2000.

"This was the right film for both of us. We couldn't get the film till now because she was busy in her place, I was busy in my place and Priyan sir was busy somewhere else. So, now you have got a chance. But now I will request Tabu ji and Priyan sir, that you won't have this complaint," Kumar told reporters here at the trailer launch of the film.

Both actors attended the trailer launch event in Mumbai recently, where they were accompanied by the filmmaker, co-star Paresh Rawal and producer Ekta Kapoor.

Kumar went down memory lane and said he and Tabu have known each other for over 39 years. "She is a very dear and old friend of mine. I have been in this industry for about 35 years. But I have known Tabu for 39 years. Tabu and I used to go to the dance academy



together to dance. Very few people know this," he said.

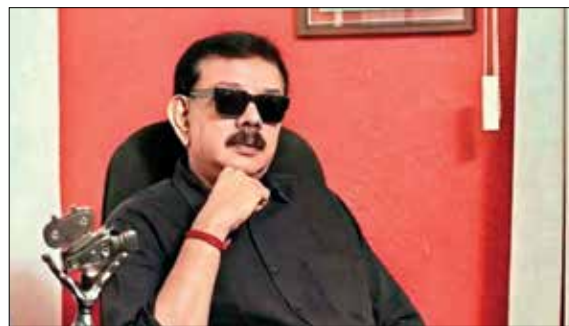
"Yes, he used to pick me up on the bike," Tabu added.

'Bhooth Bangla' is a horror-comedy about a quirky yet fearless man who finds himself entangled in a mysterious haunted mansion on the outskirts of a quiet town. The film also reunites Kumar with Priyadarshan, who made films such as 'Garam Masala', 'Bhool Bhulaiyaa' and 'Khatta Meetha' among others.

Kumar said working with the filmmaker again felt like a homecoming. "I am working with Priyan sir after 14 years. I feel like after completing my 'vanvas' (exile), I got a chance to work with him again; it felt like homecoming. He makes very clean, family-oriented films. His film doesn't have any kind of dirt. I enjoy working on such films with him. That is why I was very happy. Plus, with Tabu ji, after a long time, we worked together. She is a very dear and old friend of mine. With Paresh ji, we get up and go for work together," the actor said.

PRIYADARSHAN ON 'BHOOTH BANGLA' SONG DEBATE

'I respect Satyajit Ray like God'



He dismisses 'Goopy Gyne Bagha Byne' song copy row ahead of film release

OUR CORRESPONDENT

Acclaimed director Priyadarshan is set to return to Hindi cinema after an eight-year hiatus with 'Bhooth Bangla', starring Akshay Kumar. However, even before its release, the film found itself at the centre of a controversy over alleged similarities between its song 'Ram Ji Bhala Karein' and the iconic 'Bhoot Raja Dilo Bor' from Satyajit Ray's cult classic 1969 film 'Goopy Gyne Bagha Byne'.

The comparisons have sparked debate among critics and audiences, particularly in Bengal, given the cultural significance of the original composition by Ray. Addressing the issue at an event, Priyadarshan dismissed the allegations, stressing that repetition of words and themes is common in cinema.

"I have huge respect for him because he's one of the masters from whom I learned cinema. The word you are telling is 'bhoot' - 'yahan bhoot wahan bhoot'. There are hundreds of movies that have used the word 'deewana' in Indian cinema. Does that mean the first person who used the word 'deewana' has the right to use it? So, it's only a word. The tune has nothing to do with that song," he said.

Known for cult classics like 'Hera Pheri', 'Bhool Bhulaiyaa' and 'Hungama', the director

reiterated his deep admiration for Ray, calling him the 'god of Indian cinema'.

"The lyricist has written those (words) and that is why we were so confident. There's nothing wrong with it because our film is 'Bhooth Bangla'. You should also understand that there is another film called 'Bhoot Bangla' before, which is with Mehmood and R D Burman. So natu-

'Bhooth Bangla' is scheduled to hit theatres on April 17

rally, that title is repeated now. These things get repeated. Of course, as I've already told you, I respect Satyajit Ray like the God of Indian cinema," he added.

Singer Aarvan, who has lent his voice to 'Ram Ji Bhala Karein', also acknowledged the sensitivity around the comparison, especially among Bengali audiences. "The music of 'Goopy Gyne Bagha Byne' is iconic and anything tied to Satyajit Ray carries deep cultural weight. That said, compositionally and scale-wise, both songs are different. The only real similarity is the use of the word 'Bhoot' at the end, which ties into 'Bhoot Bangla,' he told 'Millennium Post'.

'Bhooth Bangla' is scheduled to hit theatres on April 17.



Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers,
social media platforms& website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates

(As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL
(1) Name of the Constituency - 100- Habra Assembly Constituency
(2) Name of the candidate – Jyoti Priya Mallick

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: Sections 3/4/70 of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002.
	b.	Case no.	M.L Case No. 16/2023 (arising out of ECIR/KLZO-I/04/2022, dated – 10.04.2022, Kolkata)
	c.	Name of the Court	Learned Special Judge CBI(1), CMM Court, Bichar Bhawan.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	no
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is a legal expert deeply committed to community welfare, he has consistently championed the cause of the underprivileged, leveraging his expertise, strong communication skills, and accessibility to drive meaningful change and effectively represent the community’s interests.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 100- HABRA ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCY

(4) Name of the candidate: Jyoti Priya Mallick

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O’Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the newspapers,
social media platforms & website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates

(As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL
(1) Name of the Constituency - 169- Bally Assembly Constituency
(2) Name of the candidate – Kailash Kumar Mishra

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1. Sections 341/323/325/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 2. Sections 341/323/325/326/427/435/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 3. Sections 341/324/326/427/435/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 Section 27 of Arms Act 1959
	b.	Case no.	1. FIR No. 23/21, dated 23/01/2021, Belur Police Station 2. FIR No. 22/21, dated 23/01/2021, Belur Police Station 3. FIR No. 21/21, dated 23/01/2021, Belur Police Station
	c.	Name of the Court	1. Learned C.J.M, Howrah 2. Learned C.J.M, Howrah 3. Learned C.J.M, Howrah
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No 3. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 169- BALLY ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCY

(4) Name of the candidate: Kailash Kumar Mishra

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O’Brien
National Working Committee Member
All India Trinamool Congress

Format C-7

(for political parties to publish in the newspapers, social media platforms & website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates
(As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS**

*Name of the Election: **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026**

Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**

(1) Name of the Constituency - **17- Jalpaiguri (SC) Assembly Constituency**

(2) Name of the candidate – **Krishna Das**

Sl.no.		
1.	Criminal antecedents	
i)	a.	Nature of the offences Offences alleged under: 1. Sections 341/325/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 2. Sections 341/323/325/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 3. Sections 448/427/379/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 4. Sections 341/323/325/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 5. Sections 143/447/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 6. Sections 143/186/341/353/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 7. Section 326 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 8. Sections 448/506/171C/171E/171F/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 9. Sections 329(3)/329(4)/316(2)/115(2)/303(2)/351(2)/3(4)of Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita , 2023 10. Sections 329(4)/115(2)/117(2)/118(2)/74/109/351(2)/3(5) of Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita Act, 2023 11. Sections 115(2)/126(2)/127(2)/351(2)/3(5) of Bhartiya Nyaya Sanhita , 2023
	b.	Case no. 1. G.R. Case No. 2316 of 08 (arising out of FIRNo. 145/ 08, dated 11.05.2008, Kotwali Police Station) 2. G.R. Case No. 4960 of 10 (arising out of FIR No. 996/ 10, dated 29.12.2010, Kotwali Police Station) 3. G.R. Case No. 3768 of 08 (arising out of FIR No. 206/ 08, dated 08.02.2008, Kotwali Police Station) 4. G.R. Case No. 2581 of 09 (arising out of FIR No. 481/ 09, dated 06.08.2009, Kotwali Police Station) 5. G.R. Case No. 2912 of 07 (arising out of FIR No. 513/ 07, dated 09.09.2007, Kotwali Police Station) 6. G.R. Case No. 653 of 01 (arising out of FIR No. 155/ 01, dated 08.05.2001, Kotwali Police Station) 7. G.R. Case No. 3795 of 10 (arising out of FIR No. 210/ 10, dated 04.10.2010, Kotwali Police Station) 8. G.R. Case No. 1677/24 (arising out of FIR No. 260/ 2024, dated 08.04.2024, Kotwali Police Station) 9. G.R. Case No.5895/24 (arising out of FIR No. 803/24, dated 22.11.2024, Kotwali Police Station) 10. G.R. Case No. 4771 of 24, (arising out of FIR No. 640/24, dated 23.09.2024, Kotwali Police Station) 11. Case No. 41 of 26, dated 28.01.2026, Kotwali Police Station)
	c.	Name of the Court 1. Learned J.M First Court, Jalpaiguri 2. Learned C.J.M Court, Jalpaiguri 3. Learned C.J.M Court, Jalpaiguri 4. Learned C.J.M Court, Jalpaiguri 5. Learned J.M Second Court, Jalpaiguri 6. Learned J.M Third Court, Jalpaiguri 7. Learned J.M Second Court, Jalpaiguri 8. Learned C.J.M Court, Jalpaiguri 9. Learned C.J.M Court, Jalpaiguri 10. Learned C.J.M Court, Jalpaiguri 11. Learned C.J.M Court, Jalpaiguri
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No) 1. Yes 2. Yes 3. Yes 4. No 5. No 6. No 7. No 8. No 9. No 10. No 11. No 12. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words) The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.	
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words) Same as above.	

(3) Name of the Constituency – **17- JALPAIGURI (SC) ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCY**

(4) Name of the candidate: **Krishna Das**

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party

Name and Designation



Derek O’Brien

National Working Committee Member

All India Trinamool Congress



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(for political parties to publish in the Newspapers, social media platforms& website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates
(As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS**
*Name of the Election: : **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 202**
Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**
(1) Name of the Constituency - **164 -Beliaghata Assembly Constituency**
(2) Name of the candidate – **Kunal Kumar Ghosh**

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1. Section 45 of the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, 2002 2. Sections 295A/298 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 3. Sections 186/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 4. Sections 420/406/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 5. Sections 120B/420/409 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 and Sections 4/6 of Prize Chits & Money Circulations Scheme Act 6. Sections 120B/420/409 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 and Sections 4/6 of Prize Chits & Money Circulations Scheme Act 7. Sections 409/420/406/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 8. Sections 420/120B/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 9. Sections 406/506/120Bof Indian Penal Code, 1860 and Section 14 Provident Fund &MISC Act
	b.	Case no.	1. ML 12/2024 2. PRC (WP) 60 of 2022 (arising out of P.S Case No. 77 of 2021, Nutan Bazar Police Station) 3. PRC (SP) 16 of 2022 (arising out of P.S. Case no. 77 of 2021, Khowai Police Station) 4. Special Case No. 06 of 2022 (arising out of PS Case No. 32 of 2017, Satragachi Police Station) 5. R.C. 04/S/ of 2014 6. Special Case No. 05 of 2023 (arising out of R.C. 06/S/ of 2014) 7. Special Case No. 137 of 2018 (arising out of PS Case No. 93 of 2013, Chandannagar Police Station) 8. G.R Case No. 3337 of 2013 (arising out of PS Case No. 122/2020, dated 18.12.2013,Electronic Complex Police Station) 9. P.S Case No. 932/2013 in Bhaktinagar Police Station.
	c.	Name of the Court	1. Learned Special Judge, CBI Court, 2, City Sessions Court at Calcutta 2. Learned J.M Court No.3, Udaipur, Gomati Dist., Tripura 3. Learned Magistrate 1st Class, Court No. 1, Khowai, Tripura 4. Learned Special Magistrate, M.P. & M.L.A, Court, Bidhannagar 5. Learned A.C.J.M, Alipore 6. Learned Special Judge,M.P. & M.L.A. Court, Bidhannagar 7. Learned Special Judge, M.P. & M.L.A Court, Bidhannagar 8. Learned Judicial Magistrate, Bidhannagar 9. Learned C.J.M Jalpaiguri
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No 3. No 4. No 5. No 6. No 7. No 8. Yes 9. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	13.05.2022 in Case No. Hastings 332 of 2014 in MP & MLA Court, Bidhannagar under Section 309 IPC
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	No Punishment was given to him
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate’s background as a social worker, combined with his extensive political career, has given him a deep connection to his roots and a strong commitment to social causes. This experience has provided him with a unique understanding of community needs, enabling him to drive meaningful change and effectively represent the voice of the people.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – **164 - BELIAGHATA ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCY**
(4) Name of the candidate: **Kunal Kumar Ghosh**

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation



Derek O’Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
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Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates

(As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

- (1) Name of the Constituency - 65 Nabagram(SC) Assembly Constituency
(2) Name of the candidate – Pronab Chandra Das

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under Sections: Sections 341/323/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no.	GR Case No. 2545/2019 (Arising out of P.S. Case Number – 225/2019, dated – 23/07/2019, Nabagram Police Station)
	c.	Name of the Court	Learned Judicial Magistrate Court at Lalbagh, Murshidabad.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	Yes, on 24.04.2024
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	N. A
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	N. A
	g.	Any other information required to be given	N. A
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an active public figure with consistent engagement in social and community-related issues. He has maintained a strong connection with the people and has been responsive to local concerns. His public conduct reflects accountability, transparency, and adherence to legal requirements. The candidate’s involvement in public life and his ability to represent the interests of the constituency form the basis of his consideration.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 65-NABAGRAM (SC),ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCY

(4) Name of the candidate: Pronab Chandra Das

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
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(As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

- (1) Name of the Constituency - 19 – Debgram-Fulbari Assembly Constituency
(2) Name of the candidate – Ranjan Sil Sharma

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under Sections: 1. Sections353/290/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 2. Sections 143/148/149/325/506 of he Indian Penal Code, 1860. 3. Sections 448/427/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no.	1. G.R Case No. 772/2009 (arising out of P.S. Case No. 232/2009, Siliguri Police Station). 2. G.R. Case No. 5025/2015 (arising out of P.S. Case No. 1718/2015, Bhaktinagar Police Station). 3. G.R. Case No. 1214/2009 (arising out of P.S. Case No. 317/2009, Bhaktinagar Police Station).
	c.	Name of the Court	1. Learned Judicial Magistrate 1st Court, Siliguri. 2. Learned Judicial Magistrate 2nd Court, Jalpaiguri. 3. Learned Judicial Magistrate 2nd Court, Jalpaiguri.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/ No)	1. Yes, On 04.03.2013 2. No 3. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	N.A
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	N.A
	g.	Any other information required to be given	N.A
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is very well known for his active social work. He has worked relentlessly for the development of people and has devoted all his efforts for which he is highly respected and loved by the people.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 19-DEBGRAM-FULBARI ASSEMBLY CONSTITU-
ENCY

(4) Name of the candidate: Ranjan Sil Sharma

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation



Derek O’Brien
National Working Committee Member
All India Trinamool Congress



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Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates

(As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 104- Naihati Assembly Constituency

(2) Name of the candidate – Sanat Dey

Sl.no.		
1.	Criminal antecedents	
i)	a.	Nature of the offences Offences alleged under: 1. Sections 448/323/354/427/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 2. Sections 448/427/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 3. Sections147/148/149/427/120B/307/109 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 and Sections 3/4 of E.S ,1908 4. Sections 341/323/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 5. Sections 341/323/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 6. Sections 143/323/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 7. Sections 341/323/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 8. Sections 147/148/149/427of Indian Penal Code, 1860 9. Sections 341/323/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 10. Sections 341/323/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 11. Sections 341/323/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860
	b.	Case no. 1. G.R. Case No. 5997 of 21 (arising out of FIR No. 287/ 2021, Naihati Police Station) 2. G.R. Case No. 5304 of 21 (arising out of FIR No. 261/ 2021, Naihati Police Station) 3. G.R. Case No. 3422 of 21 (arising out of FIR No. 175/ 2021, Naihati Police Station) 4. G.R. Case No. 8181 of 20 (arising out of FIR No. 633/ 2020, Naihati Police Station) 5. G.R. Case No. 5984 of 12 (arising out of FIR No. 358/ 2012, Naihati Police Station) 6. G.R. Case No. 5840 of 11 (arising out of FIR No. 55/ 2011, Naihati Police Station) 7. G.R. Case No. 3962of 10 (arising out of FIR No. 250/ 2010, Naihati Police Station) 8. G.R. Case No. 1777 of 10 (arising out of FIR No. 121/ 2010, Naihati Police Station) 9. G.R. Case No. 39(1)10 (arising out of FIR No. 06/ 2010, Naihati Police Station) 10. G.R. Case No. 4614 of 09 (arising out of FIR No. 343/ 2009, Naihati Police Station) 11. G.R. Case No. 3312 of 09 (arising out of FIR No. 322/ 2009, Naihati Police Station)
	c.	Name of the Court 1. Learned A.C.J.M at Barrackpore Sub Divisional Court 2. Learned A.C.J.M at Barrackpore Sub Divisional Court 3. Learned A.C.J.M at Barrackpore Sub Divisional Court 4. Learned 4thJ.M at Barrackpore Sub Divisional Court 5. Learned 4th J.M at Barrackpore Sub Divisional Court 6. Learned 3rd J.M at Barrackpore Sub Divisional Court 7. Learned 2nd J.M at Barrackpore Sub Divisional Court 8. Learned 1st J.M at Barrackpore Sub Divisional Court 9. Learned 6thJ.M at Sealdah Sub Divisional Court 10. Learned 3rd J.M at Barrackpore Sub Divisional Court 11. Learned 1st J.M at Barrackpore Sub Divisional Court
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No) 1. No 2. No 3. No 4. No 5. No 6. Yes 7. No 8. No 9. Yes 10. No 11. Yes
	e.	Date of conviction, if any Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words) The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.	
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words) Same as above.	

(3) Name of the Constituency – 104 -NAIHATI ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCY

(4) Name of the candidate: Sanat Dey

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation

Derek O’Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

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Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 111-Panihati Assembly Constituency

(2) Name of the candidate – Tirthankar Ghosh

Sl.no.	Criminal antecedents		
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1. Sections 341/186/283/506/120b/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 2. Sections 427/120b/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 and Sections 3/4 of Explosive Substances Act, 1968 3. Sections 341/325/379/427/506/323/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860
	b.	Case no.	1. 1. P.S.Case No. 838 of 2022, Dated – 21.10.2022 2. P.S. Case No. 243 of 2021, dated 19.04.2022 3. P.S. Case No. 46 of 2022, dated 28.01.2020
	c.	Name of the Court	1. 1. Learned A.C.J.M at Barrackpore 2. Learned A.C.J.M at Barrackpore 3. Learned A.C.J.M at Barrackpore
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No 3. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 111-PANIHATI ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCY

(4) Name of the candidate: Tirthankar Ghosh

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

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Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 216 - Kanthi Dakshin Assembly Constituency

(2) Name of the candidate – Tarun Kumar Jana

Sl.no.	Criminal antecedents		
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1. S e c t i o n s 147/148/149/333/307/326 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 2.Sections 186/323/506/509 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 3.Sections 147/148/149/379 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no.	1.G.R. Case No. 906/2010, (Arising out of P.S Case No. 272/2010, dated – 19/11/2010, Contai Police Station). 2.G.R. Case No. 949/2010, (Arising out of P.S Case No. 258/2010, dated – 9/11/2010, Contai Police Station). 3.G.R. Case No. 845/2010, (Arising out of P.S Case No. 241/2010, dated – 21/10/2010, Contai Police Station)
	c.	Name of the Court	1.Learned Asst. Session Judge 1st Court, Contai. 2.Learned ACJM Court 3.Learned ACJM.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No. 2. No. 3. No.
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 216- KANTHI DAKSHIN ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCY

(4) Name of the candidate: Tarun Kumar Jana

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation



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National Working Committee Member
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<u>Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates</u> <u>(As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)</u>			
Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS			
*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026			
Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL			
(1) Name of the Constituency - 184 – Domjur Assembly Constituency			
(2) Name of the candidate – Tapas Maity			

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1. Sections 147/148/323/379/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no.	1. G.R Case No. 5203/2012 (arising out of P.S. Case number 507/2012, Liluah Police Station).
	c.	Name of the Court	1. Learned 7th Judicial Magistrate, Howrah Court.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable

	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate’s experience as a social worker has given him a unique understanding of community needs, empowering him to drive positive change and effectively represent the community’s voice.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – **184 - DOMJUR ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCY**

(4) Name of the candidate: **Tapas Maity**

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
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(As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: : GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 213 - Kanthi Uttar Assembly Constituency

(2) Name of the candidate – Debasis Bhuniya

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1. Sections 149/326/307/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 2. Sections 149/327/325/354 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 3. Sections 147/148/149/323/341/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 4. Sections 143/341/323/325/506/ of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 5. Sections 149/364/302 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 6. Sections 379/427/149 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 7. Sections 148/149/323/354/364/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 8. Sections 149/448/427/329/354 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 9. Sections 149/323/379/427 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 10. Sections 149/325/307 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. Sections 25/27 of the Arms Act. 11. Sections 148/149/323/379/427 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 12. Sections 149/325/436/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 13. Sections 149/323/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 14. Sections 149/379/326/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 15. Sections 148/149/323/325/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no.	1. G.R No. 3211 arising of P.S. Case No. 3/11, Contai Police Station. 2. G.R No. 57/11 arising of P.S. Case No. 19/11, Contai Police Station. 3. G.R No. 134/10 arising of P.S. Case No. 20/10, Marishda Police Station. 4. G.R No. 186/10 arising of P.S. Case No. 47/10, Contai Police Station. 5. S.C. Case No. 522/2024, arising out of P.S. Case No. 197/10, Contai Police Station. 6. G.R No. 779/10 arising of P.S. Case No. 198/10, Contai Police Station. 7. S.C. Case NO. 544/24 arising of P.S. Case No. 229/10, Contai Police Station. 8. G.R No. 840/10 arising of P.S. Case No. 236/10, Contai Police Station. 9. G.R No. 845/10 arising of P.S. Case No. 241/10, Contai Police Station. 10. S.C. Case No. 148/10 arising of P.S. Case No. 246/09, Contai Police Station. 11. G.R No. 688/10 arising of P.S. Case No. 173/10, Contai Police Station. 12. G.R No. 914/10 arising of P.S. Case No. 266/10, Contai Police Station. 13. G.R No. 832/10 arising of P.S. Case No. 228/10, Contai Police Station. 14. G.R No. 917/10 arising of P.S. Case No. 273/10, Contai Police Station. 15. G.R No. 8/11 arising of P.S. Case No. 317/10, Contai Police Station.

	c.	Name of the Court	1. 1. Learned ACJM, Contai Court 2. Learned 1st Judicial Magistrate, Contai. 3. Learned ACJM, Contai Court 4. Learned 1st Judicial Magistrate, Contai 5. Learned ADJ 1st Court, Contai. 6. Learned ACJM, Contai Court 7. Learned ADJ 1st Court, Contai. 8. Learned ACJM, Contai Court 9. Learned ACJM, Contai Court 10. Learned ADJ 1st Court, Contai. 11. Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate, Contai. 12. Learned ACJM, Contai Court 13. Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate, Contai 14. Learned ACJM, Contai Court 15. Learned 1st Judicial Magistrate Court, Contai.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No. 2. No. 3. No. 4. No. 5. No. 6. No. 7. No. 8. No. 9. No. 10. No. 11. No. 12. No. 13. No. 14. No. 15. No.
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 213- KANTHI UTTAR ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCY

(4) Name of the candidate: Debasis Bhuniya

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation



Derek O’Brien
Member, National Working Committee,
All India Trinamool Congress

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 (for political parties to publish in the newspapers,
 social media platforms & website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: **ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS**

*Name of the Election: **GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026**

Name of State/UT: **WEST BENGAL**

(1) Name of the Constituency - **201-Goghat (SC) Assembly Constituency**

(2) Name of the candidate – **Nirmal Maji**

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: Sections 406/409/120B of Indian Penal Code, 1860
	b.	Case no.	Special Case No.72/22, (Arising out of Complaint case No.2022/2022, dated 13.06.2022).
	c.	Name of the Court	Learned A.D.J 3rd Court, (Special Court), Barasat, North 24 Parganas was pleased to transfer the case to Special Court of MP'S & MLA'S Mayukh Bhaban, Bidhannagar, Kolkata. But as on 02.04.2026 it is found that above mentioned case record is lying at office of Learned ADJ, 3rd Court (Special Court (Special Court), Barasat, North 24 Parganas.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere "winnability" at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – **201-Goghat (SC) Assembly Constituency**

(4) Name of the candidate: **Nirmal Maji**

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

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 Name and Designation


 Derek O'Brien
 National Working Committee Member
 All India Trinamool Congress

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<u>Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates</u>			
(As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)			
Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOLO CONGRESS			
*Name of the Election: GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026			
Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL			
(1) Name of the Constituency - 133-Kulpi Assembly Constituency			
(2) Name of the candidate – Barnali Dhara			
Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1.Sections 341/323/506/325/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 2.Sections 447/323/506/325/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860
	b.	Case no.	1.G.R. Case No. 105 of 2024 (arising out of FIR No.107/ 2024, P.S. Kulpi Police District) 2.G.R. Case No. 2783 of 2022 (arising out of FIR No. 339/ 2022, P.S. Kulpi)
	c.	Name of the Court	1.Learned 3rd J.M Court, Diamond Harbour 2.Learned 1st J.M Court, Diamond Harbour
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No

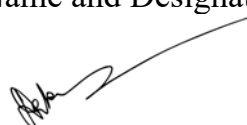
e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)	The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)	Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – **133-Kulpi Assembly Constituency**

(4) Name of the candidate: **Barnali Dhara**

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

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Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates

(As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 78 - Tehatta Assembly Constituency

(2) Name of the candidate – Dilip Kumar Poddar

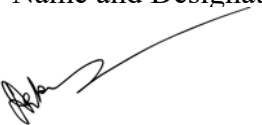
Sl.no.		
1.	Criminal antecedents	
i)	a.	Nature of the offences Offences alleged under: 1.Sections 147/148/149/325/326/427 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 2.Sections 147/148/149/324/325/337/338 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 3 Sections 147/148/149/447/323/324/325/326 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860.
	b.	Case no. 1.G.R. Case No. 322/2011, (Arising out of FIR No. 158/2011, Dated – 18.04.2011, Tehatta Police Station). 2.G.R Case No. 1254/1995, (arising out of FIR No. 92/1995, dated – 26.08.1995, Tehatta Police Station). 3. G.R. Case No. 1371/1987, (arising out of FIR No. 5/1987, Dated – 08.09.1987, Tehatta Police Station).
	c.	Name of the Court 1.Learned Judicial Magistrate Court, Tehatta, Nadia. 2.Learned Judicial Magistrate Court, Tehatta, Nadia. 3.Learned Judicial Magistrate Court, Tehatta, Nadia.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No) 1. No 2. Yes, on 01.12.1997 3. Yes, on 26.06.1989
	e.	Date of conviction, if any Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words) The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.	
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words) Same as above.	

(3) Name of the Constituency – 78 - TEHATTA ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCY

(4) Name of the candidate: Dilip Kumar Poddar

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation



Derek O'Brien
National Working Committee Member
All India Trinamool Congress

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(for political parties to publish in the newspapers, social media platforms & website of the party)

Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates

(As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 170- Howrah Uttar Assembly Constituency

(2) Name of the candidate – Gautam Chowdhury

Sl.no.		
1.	Criminal antecedents	
i)	a.	Nature of the offences Offences alleged under Sections: 1. Sections 147/148/186/323/325/332/427/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 2.Sections 147/148/149/325/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 3.Sections 341/323/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860. 4.Sections 147/149/323/506 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860 read withSection 9(b) the Indian Explosive Substance Act,
	b.	Case no. 1.P.S. No. 285/2020, dated 05.10.2020, Golabari police station. 2.P.S. No. 287/2020, dated 05.10.2020, Golabari police station. 3.P.S. No. 131/2019, dated 08.07.2019, Malipanchghora police station. 4.P.S. No. 637/2012, dated 20.09.2012, Golabari police station.
	c.	Name of the Court 1. Howrah Court 2. Howrah Court 3. Howrah Court 4. Howrah Court
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No) 1. Yes, on 28.02.2021 2. Yes, on 04.03.2021 3. Yes, on 31.08.2019 4. Yes, on 31.01.2013
	e.	Date of conviction, if any Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words) As a social worker, the candidate has demonstrated a deep commitment to community welfare, addressing issues and empowering individuals. His experience has equipped him with the empathy, understanding, and leadership skills necessary to effectively represent and serve the community's interests.	
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words) Same as above.	

(3) Name of the Constituency – 170- Howrah Uttar Assembly Constituency

(4) Name of the candidate: Gautam Chowdhury

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

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Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates

(As per the Commission's directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon'ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 188-Singur Assembly Constituency

(2) Name of the candidate – Becharam Manna

Sl.no.		
1.	Criminal antecedents	
i)	a.	Nature of the offences Offences alleged under: Sections 174(A)/147/146/145 of Eastern Railway Act .
	b.	Case no. CR. Case No. 46/25, (Arising out of Sheoraphully Case No 01/2025, dated 01.01.2025, Sheoraphully Police Station)
	c.	Name of the Court Learned A.C.J.M at Chandannagar
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No) NO
	e.	Date of conviction, if any Not Applicable

	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words) The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.	
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words) Same as above.	

(3) Name of the Constituency – 188-Singur Assembly Constituency

(4) Name of the candidate: Becharam Manna

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

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Name and Designation



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Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 142 - Magrahat Assembly Constituency

(2) Name of the candidate – Md. Samim Ahamed Molla

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1.Sections 341/323/325/506/34 of the Indian Penal Code, 1860..
	b.	Case no.	1.G.R. Case No. 1241/201 (arising out of FIR No. 190/2011, Diamond Harbour Police Station)
	c.	Name of the Court	1.Learned ACJM Court Diamond Harbour.
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is a legal expert deeply committed to community welfare, he has consistently championed the cause of the underprivileged, leveraging his expertise, strong communication skills, and accessibility to drive meaningful change and effectively represent the community’s interests.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 142 - Magrahat Assembly Constituency

(4) Name of the candidate: Md. Samim Ahamed Molla

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation



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Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 200- Arambagh (SC) Assembly Constituency

(2) Name of the candidate – Mita Bag

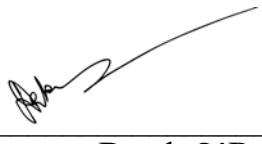
Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1.Sections 448/506/34 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 2.Sections 365/506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860
	b.	Case no.	1.G.R. Case No. 772 of 2016 (arising out of PS Case No. 376/2016, dated 29.04.2016, Arambagh Police Station) 2.G.R. Case No. 1888of 2016 (arising out of PS Case No. 949/2016, dated 06.10.2016, Arambagh Police Station)
	c.	Name of the Court	1. Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate 2. Learned 3rd Judicial Magistrate
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. Yes, 15/02/2018 2. Yes, 21/03/2018
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. She serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. Her accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make her a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 200- Arambagh (SC) Assembly Constituency

(4) Name of the candidate: Mita Bag

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
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Information regarding individuals with pending criminal cases, who have been selected as candidates, along with the reasons for such selection, as also as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (As per the Commission’s directions issued in pursuance of the Order dated 13.02.2020 of the Hon’ble Supreme Court in contempt petition (C) no. 2192 of 2018 in WP(C) No. 536 of 2011)

Name of Political Party: ALL INDIA TRINAMOOL CONGRESS

*Name of the Election: GENERAL ELECTION TO THE LEGISLATIVE ASSEMBLY OF WEST BENGAL 2026

Name of State/UT: WEST BENGAL

(1) Name of the Constituency - 101- Ashoknagar Assembly Constituency

(2) Name of the candidate – Narayan Goswami

Sl.no.			
1.	Criminal antecedents		
i)	a.	Nature of the offences	Offences alleged under: 1.Sections 147/148/149/447/379/ 506 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 2.Section 188 of Indian Penal Code, 1860 3.Sections 341/323/354B/341 of Indian Penal Code, 1860
	b.	Case no.	1. 196/2000 2. 173/2011 3. 1022/2013
	c.	Name of the Court	1. Learned A.C.J.M at Basirhat 2. Learned A.C.J.M at Basirhat 3. Learned A.C.J.M at Basirhat
	d.	Whether charges have been framed or not (Yes/No)	1. No 2. No 3. No

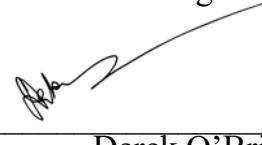
	e.	Date of conviction, if any	Not Applicable
	f.	Details of punishment undergone, if any	Not Applicable
	g.	Any other information required to be given	Not Applicable
2.	The reasons for the selection of the candidate. Selection shall be with reference to the qualifications, achievements and merit of the candidate, and not mere “winnability” at the polls (not more than 100 words)		The candidate is an experienced grassroots political worker with strong public engagement. He serves as a voice for underprivileged and marginalized communities. His accessibility, close connection with the community, and consistent commitment to public service make him a suitable candidate for legislative responsibilities.
3.	Reasons as to why other individuals without criminal antecedents could not be selected as candidates (not more than 100 words)		Same as above.

(3) Name of the Constituency – 101- ASHOKNAGAR ASSEMBLY CONSTITUENCY

(4) Name of the candidate: Narayan Goswami

* In the case of election to Council of States or States or election to Legislative Council by MLAs, mention the election concerned in place of name of Constituency.

Signature of office bearer of the Political Party
Name and Designation



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